Contents

Review preview status

This is a review preview, not a finished grammar. It is an assembled draft of the current Tedim grammar sections. Several domains remain incomplete, and end-of-section caveats remain visible while the draft is still under review.

Abbreviations

Standard Leipzig Glossing Abbreviations

1	first person	IMP	imperative
2	second person	INCL	inclusive
3	third person	INS	instrumental
ABIL	abilitative	INTENS	intensive
ABL	ablative	IRR	irrealis
ALL	allative	ITER	iterative
APPL	applicative	LOC	locative
CAUS	causative	NEG	negative
COM	comitative	NMLZ	nominalizer
COMPL	completive	PFV	perfective
CONT	continuative	PL	plural
CVB	converb	POSS	possessive
DAT	dative	PROSP	prospective
DIMIN	diminutive	PROX	proximal
ERG	ergative	Q	question particle
EXCL	exclusive	RECIP	reciprocal
EXP	experiential	REFL	reflexive
GEN	genitive	REL	relativizer
HAB	habitual	RES	resultative
HORIZ	horizontal	SG	singular
IMM	immediate	TOP	topic

Tedim Chin-Specific Conventions

1SG→3	first singular acting on third person
2→1	second person acting on first person
3→1	third person acting on first person
AG	agent (nominalizer)
AUG	augmentative (big/great)
DIST	distal/anaphoric demonstrative
DOWN	downward directional
HAB.CONT	habitual continuative
I	verb form I (citation form)
II	verb form II (dependent form)
MORE	comparative (more X)
NEG.ABIL	negative abilitative (cannot)
PROX	proximal demonstrative
TOWARD	goal directional
UP	upward directional

Verb Forms: Tedim Chin verbs have two conjugation forms. I (Form I) is the citation/independent form; II (Form II) appears in dependent clauses and certain constructions.

1 Phonology and tone

1.1 Phonology and tone

The current phonology and tone section is deliberately cautious: the literature supports a modest segmental summary, practical spelling is only indirect evidence, and the tone-sensitive *-a* distinction remains blocked.

1.1.1 Overview of phonology and tone in Tedim

Tedim phonology can be printed cautiously from the literature as a modest segmental summary, an orthography note, and a three-tone system that is not marked in ordinary spelling. This section stays narrow: it prints what the literature supports now, keeps orthography in its proper place as indirect evidence, and leaves the tone-sensitive *-a* distinction unresolved (Henderson, 1965, pp. 9-13; Cing, 2017, pp. 25-26, 37, 57-60).

The Bible orthography is useful for locating lexical items in context, but the tone contrast itself is taken from the phonological literature, since tone is not consistently represented in ordinary printed spelling.

Orientation table

Area	Conservative claim	Evidence status	Caveat
Consonants	The literature supports a small, stable consonant inventory with stops, aspirates, fricatives, nasals, a lateral, and glottal material.	literature-backed	Not a full phoneme table.
Vowels	The literature supports a conservative vowel summary with length contrasts and related spelling variation.	literature-backed	Do not treat orthographic doubling as a full phonological transcript.

Area	Conservative claim	Evidence status	Caveat
Syllable shape	Tedim syllables are safely summarized as a mostly simple CV/CVC system with limited codas.	literature-backed	This is an orientation, not a full phonological derivation.
Orthography	Practical spelling is useful for segmental orientation, but it does not mark tone.	orthography-backed	Orthography is indirect evidence, not direct proof.
Tone	Tedim is described as a three-tone language in the literature.	literature-backed	The present section does not solve sandhi or every morpheme-level assignment.
-a	The tone-sensitive *-a* case distinction remains unresolved in the current corpus layer.	blocked	Keep the high/low distinction blocked.

Segmental phonology The segmental literature converges on a conservative summary rather than a maximal phoneme chart. Henderson describes a relatively small initial-consonant system and a limited final set, while ZNC gives a modernized IPA-based account with a conservative vowel inventory and a simple syllable template (Henderson, 1965, pp. 9-13; Cing, 2017, pp. 25-26, 37). That is enough for a grammar-facing orientation, but not enough to pretend the segment inventory is fully settled in the present section.

Orthography and syllable shape Practical Tedim spelling is useful because it reflects familiar segmental contrasts, yet it remains a spelling system. Henderson explicitly notes that tone is not marked in orthography, and vowel length is only occasionally shown by doubling. The safest print claim is therefore that orthography helps orient the reader to segments and syllable shape, but cannot by itself prove a phonological analysis (Henderson, 1965, pp. 9-11, 13; Cing, 2017, pp. 25-26).

Tone status The tone literature supports a three-tone analysis, with tone contrastive in lexical items and with analytical transcription marking tone more explicitly than practical orthography does. The present section can therefore print a short tone-status summary: Tedim has three tones, tone is not marked in ordinary spelling, and tone interacts with morphology in ways that belong partly in other sections (Henderson, 1965, p. 13; Cing, 2017, pp. 57-60).

Bible-attested minimal and near-minimal sets

Form as printed in the Bible	Tone-marked or phonological form from the literature	Meaning	Bible source	Evidence type	Caveat
ta / *-ta* (as in *nungta*)	lexical high-tone *ta* vs grammatical low-tone *-ta* in the literature	child / PFV	Genesis 11:30; Matthew 4:4	supporting_bible_attestation + literature_backed_tone_claim	*nungta* is analyzed as *nung-ta* in the corpus layer; this row is supporting evidence, not a strict minimal pair.

Form as printed in the Bible	Tone-marked or phonological form from the literature	Meaning	Bible source	Evidence type	Caveat
thei / *-thei* (as in *lutthei*)	lexical high-tone *thei* vs grammatical low-tone *-thei* in the literature	know / ABIL	Genesis 4:9; Matthew 7:21	near_minimal_pair + literature_backed_tone_claim	Bible attests both forms, but tone interpretation remains literature-backed.
hi / *hi* (as in *na hi hi*)	lexical high-tone *hi* vs grammatical low-tone *hi* in the literature	be / DECL	Genesis 16:13	homographic_lexical_grammatical_contrast + literature_backed_tone_claim	Orthography is identical, so role and tone are interpreted from context plus literature.

True orthography-identical tone minimal pairs are limited in the current source-resolved Bible layer, so near-minimal sets are used where needed and labeled explicitly. The `ta / -ta` row is kept as supporting Bible attestation rather than strict minimal-pair evidence.

Short Bible examples

(1.1) *lutthei* *ding* *uh* *hi*
enter-ABIL IRR 2/3PL DECL
'they will be able to enter' (Matthew 7:21)

(1.2) *na* *hi* *hi*
2SG DECL DECL
'you are' (Genesis 16:13)

These examples show Bible attestation of the forms in context. The tone assignment remains literature-backed, because ordinary Bible spelling does not mark tone contrast reliably. Short Bible examples are printed in ordinary Bible spelling, and tone-marked forms are restricted to the literature column in the table above.

The blocked -a issue The main unresolved issue is the tone-sensitive *-a* distinction. The literature distinguishes high-tone and low-tone values, but the current corpus spelling does not preserve tone, so this contrast cannot be recovered safely. For present purposes, the right grammar-facing decision is to keep *-a* blocked and describe the issue explicitly as unresolved rather than flattening it into a single case marker (Cing, 2017, pp. 57-60).

Boundaries with stem alternation, TAM, *-pih*, and verb paradigms Tone interacts with stem alternation, TAM / aspect / modal, *-pih* 'with / accompanying', and verb paradigms, but those are better printed in their own sections. This section therefore only marks the boundary: it does not attempt to sort out the full tone-sensitive behavior of suffixes or other unresolved tone-sensitive material that stays outside this section.

Deferred material A full phoneme table, a full tone-sandhi account, and a complete tone analysis remain deferred. The `ta / -ta` contrast remains caveated as supporting evidence rather than as a strict minimal pair.

What can be printed now What can be printed now is a short segmental orientation, an orthography caveat, a three-tone status summary, two or three Bible-attested minimal or near-minimal sets with literature-backed tone interpretation, and a blocked -a warning.

2 Deixis, pronouns, and nominal domain

2.1 Demonstratives / deixis

The current demonstrative evidence is strongest for core *hih* 'this' and *tua* 'that / the aforementioned', plus plural *hihte* 'these' and *tuate* 'those', while *hi* and exact *hih ciangin* 'when this / when doing thus' remain boundary material.

2.1.1 Overview of demonstratives and deixis in this section

This section treats the demonstrative core *hih* 'this' and *tua* 'that / the aforementioned', their plural forms, and a small set of constructional extensions. It leaves copular and sentence-final material around *hi* 'be / DECL / copula-like', and broader discourse-structure analysis, to other sections.

The basic two-way contrast is stable in both corpus and literature (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). A standing caveat is that Bible usage is dominated by *tua* 'that / the aforementioned', while the literature often cites *huā* 'distal demonstrative'; the relation is plausible but not settled here.

Raw occurrence counts are not treated as grammar facts in this section.

Current demonstrative inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
hih	proximal demonstrative	identificational and adnominal	stable	overlaps with *hi*-related material only at the boundary
tua	distal/anaphoric demonstrative	adnominal and discourse-linking	stable	broader discourse functions remain outside this section
hihte	proximal plural demonstrative	pronominal and NP-linked	stable	treated as DEM + *-te*
tuate	distal plural demonstrative	pronominal and NP-linked	stable	treated as DEM + *-te*
hih bangin	manner/deictic construction	instruction or quoted manner	stable with caveat	interface with clause-linkage uses of *bangin*
tua bangin	manner/discourse resumptive construction	anaphoric summary or continuation	stable with caveat	interface with clause-linkage uses of *bangin*
tua ciangin	temporal/discourse linker	event sequencing ('then')	stable	boundary with clause-linkage chapter
tua ahih ciangin	discourse-temporal bridge	inferential/transition frame	stable with caveat	boundary with clause-linkage and discourse domains

Core demonstratives: hih and tua The core contrast is between *hih* 'this' and *tua* 'that / the aforementioned'. In controlled examples, *hih* is robust in proximal or presentational contexts, while *tua* regularly tracks already activated or discourse-linked referents.

(2.3)	*Híh*	*pèn*	*Adam'*	*suanlekhakte'*	*laibu*	*àhì*	*hì.*
	PROX	TOP	ADAM.POSS	genealogy-PL.POSS	book	be.3SG	DECL

‘This is the book of the generations of Adam.’ (Genesis 5:1)

Matthew 1:21 provides a Gospel comparandum with adnominal *tua* ‘that / the aforementioned’.

(2.4)

túa	*tá-pà*	*ìn*	*àmà*	*mì-tè*	*à*	*màwh-ná*	*ùh*	*pàn-ìn*	*honkhia*	*dìng*
DIST	child-male	ERG	3SG.POSS	person-PL	3SG	err-NMLZ	2/3PL	ABL-ERG	deliver	IRR
àhìh	*màn-ìn*									
be.3SG.REL	reason-ERG									

‘Because that child will save his people from their sins.’ (Matthew 1:21)

Plural demonstratives Plural forms are straightforwardly built on demonstrative stems plus *-te* ‘plural’. The controlled evidence supports both *hihte* ‘these’ and *tuate* ‘those’ as regular plural demonstrative forms.

(2.5)

Híh-tè	*pèn*	*à*	*ínn-kúan,*	*à*	*kam*	*pau,*	*à*	*léi-tāng,*	*à*	*mì-nām-ìn*
PROX-PL	TOP	3SG	house-family	3SG	mouth	speak	3SG	land-earth	3SG	person-tribe-ERG
Ham'	*suanlekhak-tè*	*àhì*	*hì.*							
HAM.POSS	genealogy-PL	be.3SG	DECL							

‘These are the descendants of Ham by their families, languages, lands, and nations.’ (Genesis 10:20)

Luke 6:14 gives a Gospel comparandum with distal plural *tuate* ‘those’.

(2.6)

Túa-tè	*ìn:*	*Simon*	*peter*	*cí-in*	*mīn*	*à*	*phuah*	*pà.*
DIST-PL	ERG	SIMON	PETER	say-QUOT	name	3SG	thunder	father

‘Those were: Simon (called Peter)...’ (Luke 6:14)

Adnominal and pronominal uses The same demonstrative forms can modify nouns or stand independently. Adnominal use is clear in forms such as *hih mite* ‘these people’, while pronominal use is clear in standalone predicate frames.

(2.7)

Híh	*mì-tè*	*kà*	*mú*	*zò*	*hì.*
PROX	person-PL	1SG	see.I	south	DECL

‘I have seen these people.’ (Exodus 32:9)

Matthew 12:49 gives a Gospel pronominal comparandum.

(2.8)

Híh-tè	*pèn*	*kà*	*nù*	*lè*	*kà*	*sanggam-tè*	*àhì*	*ùh*	*hì.*
PROX-PL	TOP	1SG	female	and	1SG	brother-PL	be.3SG	2/3PL	DECL

‘These are my mother and my brothers.’ (Matthew 12:49)

Discourse and temporal deixis Discourse-temporal uses are centered on *tua ciangin* ‘then / at that time’ and *tua ahih ciangin* ‘when that was so / then’. These constructions are treated here as demonstrative-linked discourse frames, while fuller subordination analysis is left to clause linkage.

(2.9)

túa	*cìang-ìn*	*khuavak*	*ōm*	*pah*	*hì.*
DIST	then-ERG	light	exist	do.so	DECL

‘Then light appeared at once.’ (Genesis 1:3)

Matthew 28:19 gives a Gospel comparandum for *tua ahih ciangin*.

(2.10)

Túa	*àhìh*	*cìang-ìn*	*nòtè*	*pái*	*ùn-lá.*
DIST	be.3SG.REL	then-ERG	2PL.PRO	go	PL.IMP-and

‘When that is so, you must go...’ (Matthew 28:19)

Manner constructions with bangin Manner constructions with *bangin* 'like / as' are productive with demonstrative bases: *hih bangin* 'like this / thus' and *tua bangin* 'like that / thus'. These are kept in this section because the demonstrative base remains constructionally active.

(2.11) *híh bàng-ìn nà ngen ùn*
PROX like-ERG 2SG pray IMP.PL
'Pray like this.' (Matthew 6:9)

Exodus 14:30 gives a controlled Old Testament comparandum with *tua bangin*.

(2.12) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:dem-tua-bangin: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Topa ìn túa bàng-ìn Egypt mite' khutsung pàn-ìn Israel-té honkhia hì.
Lord ERG DIST like-ERG EGYPT person-PL.POSS palm ABL-ERG ISRAEL-TE deliver DECL

'Thus the Lord saved Israel from the hand of the Egyptians.' (Exodus 14:30)

Deferred forms: *hi* 'be / DECL / copula-like' and *hih ciangin* 'when this / when doing thus' *Hi* is kept as deferred boundary material. In current evidence it overlaps heavily with copular, auxiliary, and sentence-final-particle behavior, so it is not promoted as a stable demonstrative row here.

Hih ciangin 'when this / when doing thus' is also deferred. Current controlled evidence does not support it as a stable temporal demonstrative counterpart to *tua ciangin*, and many apparent hits overlap with non-demonstrative verbal material.

Boundary with interrogatives and quantifiers Forms such as *kua* 'who', *bang* 'what', *kuamah* 'nobody', and *bangmah* 'nothing' belong primarily to interrogative and quantifier/negative-indefinite domains, so they are not expanded in this section.

Deferred material Several issues remain outside the present account. These include the full *hi* system across copular and sentence-final uses, full discourse-structural deixis, and the unresolved scope of Bible *tua* versus literature *huā*.

2.2 Pronouns / clusivity

The current pronoun evidence is strongest for independent forms such as *kei* 'I / me', *nang* 'you.SG', and *amah* 'he / she / it', while first-plural clusivity (*eite* 'we' / *kote* 'we.EXCL') and participant-oriented prefixes (*hong-* 'participant-oriented venitive-like marker', *kong-* 'participant-oriented directive-like marker') remain tightly controlled boundary material.

2.2.1 Overview of Tedim pronouns

Tedim pronoun evidence supports a stable person/number contrast in independent forms: *kei* 'I / me', *nang* 'you.SG', *amah* 'he / she / it', *note* 'you.PL', and *amaute* 'they'. First-person plural forms are not a single settled series: *kote* 'we.EXCL' is secure in controlled addressed-dialogue contexts, while *eite* 'we' has clear inclusive uses but also contexts that keep its global clusivity value under review. This section therefore keeps a strict distinction between independent pronouns, possessive prefixes, and verbal agreement prefixes instead of collapsing them into one paradigm (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.2.2 Pronoun inventory

Domain	Controlled forms	Function	Status	Notes
independent singular	*kei*, *nang*, *amah*	free pronoun heads for 1SG, 2SG, 3SG	core	clause role and case-marking details remain separate
independent plural	*note*, *amaute*	free pronoun heads for 2PL, 3PL	core	stable number contrast
first-person plural series	*eite*, *kote*	free 1PL pronoun series	core with caveat	*kote* is secure as exclusive; *eite* remains mixed in broader discourse
possessive prefixes before nouns	*ka-*, *na-*, *a-*, *i-*	possessor marking on noun hosts	core with caveat	overlaps with wider prefix/agreement routing
verbal person-prefix rows (cross-reference)	*kanei*, *ka-nei*, *kainn*, *ka-inn*	host-sensitive agreement vs possession routing	boundary	analyzed fully in prefix/agreement section
emphatic pronouns	*keimah*, *nangmah*	emphatic or contrastive pronouns	supporting	discourse scope still broader than this section
reflexive/reciprocal prefix	*ki-*, *ki-gawm*	reflexive or reciprocal verbal marking	boundary	belongs with valency and clause structure interfaces
negative-indefinite overlap	*kuamah*, *bangmah*	quantifier-negation interface	boundary	treated with quantifiers and negation sections

2.2.3 Independent personal pronouns

Independent pronouns behave as full noun-phrase heads and can be discussed without reanalyzing prefixal agreement. The clearest formal anchors here are third-person singular *amah* 'he / she / it' and second-person plural *note* 'you.PL'.

(2.13) *àmàh pèn mì-hìng khèmpeuh' nù àhì hì.*
3SG.PRO TOP person-kind all.POSS female be.3SG DECL
'She was the mother of all living people.' (Genesis 3:20)

Matthew 5:13 supplies a Gospel comparandum with second-person plural *note* 'you.PL'.

(2.14) *Nòtè pèn léi-tùng mì-tè à dìng-ìn cí tàwh nà kī-bàng ùh hì.*
2PL.PRO TOP land-on person-PL 3SG IRR-ERG say COM 2SG REFL-same 2/3PL DECL
'You are like salt for the people of the world.' (Matthew 5:13)

2.2.4 First-person plural forms and clusivity

The first-person plural contrast is real, but asymmetric in present evidence. *Kote* 'we.EXCL' is stable in controlled addressed-dialogue contexts where the hearer is excluded. *Eite* 'we' has clear inclusive uses, but it is not forced into a single global clusivity label across every context. The shorter *ei* series remains part of the same unresolved area.

(2.15) *Bàng hàng hìam cìh lèh eite beh khàt ì-hí hì.*
like reason Q say.NOM and 1PL.PRO tribe one 1PL.INCL-be DECL
'Because we are one kin-group.' (Genesis 13:8)

Genesis 34:9 provides the complementary row with *kote* 'we.EXCL'.

(2.16) *Kòtè tàwh kī-ten-ná hòng bāwl ùn.*
1PL.PRO COM REFL-marry-NMLZ 3→1 make IMP.PL
'Arrange intermarriage with us.' (Genesis 34:9)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

2.2.5 Second- and third-person forms

Second- and third-person forms are the least controversial part of the independent system. *Nang* 'you.SG' and *note* 'you.PL' provide the second-person contrast, while *amah* 'he / she / it' and *amaute* 'they' provide the third-person contrast. These rows support a straightforward person/number description without forcing a full case-marked or discourse-pragmatic paradigm.

2.2.6 Pronouns and possession

Possessive constructions reuse person-marking material but are not identical to independent pronouns. The core possessive prefixes are *ka-* 'first-person singular possessive', *na-* 'second-person singular possessive', *a-* 'third-person possessive', and *i-* 'first-person plural possessive'. Forms such as *ka pa* 'my father' and *na pa* 'your father' are possession patterns, not free pronouns.

(2.17) *Nà pa' ínn-àh kòtè' giah nàdìng à áwng dìng hìam?*
2SG male.POSS house-LOC 1PL.PRO.POSS camp PURP 3SG open IRR Q
'Is there room in your father's house for us to stay?' (Genesis 24:23)

Luke 2:49 supplies a Gospel comparandum with first-person singular possessive *ka-* on a nominal host.

(2.18) *Kà Pa' ínn sùng-àh kà ōm dìng lamtak théi lò nà hì ùh hìam?*
1SG male.POSS house inside-LOC 1SG exist IRR know know NEG 2SG DECL 2/3PL Q
'Did you not know that I should be in my Father's house?' (Luke 2:49)

Genesis 3:20 also provides third-person possessive *a-* in a simple possessed noun phrase.

(2.19) *Mipa ìn à zi' mīn pèn Eve, cí hì.*
man ERG 3SG wife.POSS name TOP EVE say DECL
'The man called his wife's name Eve.' (Genesis 3:20)

2.2.7 Independent pronouns versus prefix/agreement marking

Verbal person-prefix rows are not treated here as independent pronouns. Forms such as *kanei* 'I have' and segmented *ka-nei* '1SG-have' belong to agreement-before-verbal-host analysis, while *kainn* 'my house' and segmented *ka-inn* '1SG.POSS-house' belong to possession-before-nominal-host analysis. The prefix/agreement section carries that host-sensitive routing analysis in full; this section keeps only the pronoun-side contrast explicit.

2.2.8 Pronouns with case and relator marking

Pronouns can appear with case-like and relator-like material, but this section keeps that evidence narrow. Controlled rows such as *kei tawh* 'with me' and *ama kiangah* 'at his side / to him' show that pronouns participate in NP-final marking and relator-governed phrases. The full case system and relator/postposition structure remain in their dedicated sections.

2.2.9 Emphatic pronouns in -mah

The emphatic suffix *-mah* ‘self / emphatic’ yields pronoun forms such as *keimah* ‘I myself’ and *nangmah* ‘you yourself’. These forms are pronominally transparent, but their discourse functions are broader than simple person/number contrast.

(2.20) *Kèimah gìm hòng kī-pìak-ná, kà thùak zàwh dìng hì lò hì.*
1SG.PRO suffering 3→1 REFL-give.to-NMLZ 1SG suffer able IRR DECL NEG DECL
‘My punishment is more than I can bear.’ (Genesis 4:13)

Matthew 8:22 supplies a Gospel comparandum with emphatic *nangmah* ‘you yourself’.

(2.21) *Nangmah ìn kèi hòng zúi ìn.*
2SG.PRO ERG NEG 3→1 follow ERG
‘You yourself, follow me.’ (Matthew 8:22)

2.2.10 Reflexive and reciprocal ki- boundary

The prefix *ki-* ‘reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like’ is a boundary topic between pronominal participant structure and broader valency behavior. The controlled reciprocal anchor is *ki-gawm* ‘join together’.

(2.22) *à zi tàwh kī-gawm à, àmau tegel pum khàt à bàng ùh hì.*
3SG wife COM REFL-seize 3SG 3PL.PRO both body one 3SG like 2/3PL DECL
‘He is joined with his wife, and the two become one body.’ (Genesis 2:24)

Matthew 19:5 supplies a Gospel row with the same reciprocal predicate *ki-gawm*.

(2.23) *à zi tàwh kī-gawm dìng à, àmau tegel pumkhat à bàng dìng ùh hì.*
3SG wife COM REFL-seize IRR 3SG 3PL.PRO both body 3SG like IRR 2/3PL DECL
‘He will be joined with his wife, and the two will become one body.’ (Matthew 19:5)

2.2.11 Participant-oriented hong- and kong- boundary

The prefixes *hong-* ‘participant-oriented venitive-like marker’ and *kong-* ‘participant-oriented directive-like marker’ are kept as boundary material here. They are person-sensitive and pronoun-adjacent, but their full distribution belongs with prefix/agreement and object-prefix or inverse-like analysis.

(2.24) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:hong-prefix: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Topa àw, cí-kin nà gil-kial hòng mú-ìn àn hòng pía kà hì ùh hìam?
Lord voice say-half 2SG bowels 3→1 see-ERG 3PL.POSS 3→1 give 1SG DECL 2/3PL Q

‘Lord, when did we see you hungry and give you food?’ (Matthew 25:37)

Genesis 41:41 provides an Old Testament comparandum for *kong-* in the same participant-oriented domain.

(2.25) *Egypt gàm khèmpeuh à ùk dìng-ìn nàng kòng kòih khin-zò hì.*
EGYPT land all 3SG rule IRR-ERG 2SG.PRO 1SG→3 put COMPL-COMPL DECL
‘I have placed you over all the land of Egypt.’ (Genesis 41:41)

2.2.12 Boundary with demonstratives, interrogatives, quantifiers, and wider agreement

This section does not analyze demonstratives such as *hih* ‘this’ and *tua* ‘that’, interrogatives such as *kua* ‘who’, or full quantifier-negation rows such as *kuamah* ‘nobody’ and *bangmah* ‘nothing’. It also does not replace the wider agreement chapter. These forms are referenced only to keep pronouns connected to neighboring domains without collapsing those analyses into one section.

2.2.13 Deferred questions

Several issues remain outside the present account. This section does not yet settle the full pronoun paradigm, all case-marked pronoun forms, the full relation between independent pronouns and verbal prefixes, the full possessive-prefix system, all emphatic or discourse-pragmatic uses, all clusivity contexts, or the full interaction between pronouns, negation, and clause type.

2.3 NP structure / possession

The current evidence supports demonstrative-before-noun order alongside noun-plus-postnominal numeral and quantifier patterns, with possession kept as a cautious boundary subsection.

2.3.1 Overview of noun phrase structure

The present evidence supports a modest but coherent set of noun phrase observations. Demonstrative material can precede nouns, as in *hih* 'this' *mite* 'people' 'these people'. Numerals and quantifier-like forms follow nouns in the clearest examples: *mi* 'person' *khat* 'one' 'one person', *ni* 'day' *li* 'four' 'four days', *mi* 'person' *khempeuh* 'all' 'all people', and *mi* 'person' *tampi* 'many' 'many people'. Possession shows possessor-before-possessed order in secure examples such as *na* 'your' *pa'* 'father' *inn-ah* 'in / into the house' 'your father's house' and *a* 'his' *zi'* 'wife' *min* 'name' 'his wife's name'.

This description remains narrow: the section does not offer a complete NP template, full possession paradigm, or comprehensive analysis of demonstratives, numerals, or quantifiers. The numerals and quantifiers sections already carry fuller treatment of those systems. The present section coordinates with those analyses by using their examples only to support modest claims about noun phrase word order.

2.3.2 NP pattern inventory

Pattern	Example form	Function	Status	Boundary notes
demonstrative + noun	*hih* 'this' *mite* 'people'	proximal demonstrative before a plural noun	core	demonstrative system is fuller in the dedicated section
noun + numeral	*ni* 'day' *li* 'four'	counted noun followed by a numeral	core	numeral formation belongs to the numerals section
noun + numeral	*kum* 'year' *sawm* 'ten' *le* 'and' *nih* 'two'	counted noun followed by a compound numeral	core	compound numeral analysis belongs to the numerals section
noun + numeral / indefinite	*mi* 'person' *khat* 'one'	noun with numeral or indefinite-like modifier	core with caveat	overlaps with numerals and indefinite boundaries
noun + universal quantifier	*mi* 'person' *khempeuh* 'all'	noun followed by total quantifier	core	quantifier semantics belong to the quantifiers section
noun + partitive quantifier	*mi* 'person' *pawlkhat* 'some group / some'	noun followed by existential or partitive-like form	core with caveat	grouping semantics are caveated in the quantifiers section
noun + quantity	*mi* 'person' *tampi* 'many'	noun followed by quantity modifier	core with caveat	borders on broader degree modification

Pattern	Example form	Function	Status	Boundary notes
possessor + possessed	*na* 'your' *pa'* 'father' *inn-ah* 'in / into the house'	pronominal possessor with possessed noun phrase	core with caveat	overlaps with possessive prefixes, apostrophe marking, and case marking
possessor + possessed	*a* 'his' *zi'* 'wife' *min* 'name'	possessive chain with possessor-before-possessed order	core with caveat	does not settle full possession paradigms
full-NP possessor + possessed	*Topa'* 'Lord' *inn* 'house'	full noun phrase possessor before possessed noun	boundary	apostrophe marking and genitive analysis remain unsettled

2.3.3 Demonstratives and nouns

The clearest anchor for demonstrative-noun order is *hih* 'this' *mite* 'people' 'these people', where the demonstrative precedes the noun. This pattern is narrower than a full theory of determiner position, which remains in the dedicated demonstratives section. The present section uses this NP-order evidence to show that demonstrative modification patterns differently from the postnominal numeral and quantifier patterns below.

(2.26) *híh* *mì-tè*
PROX person-PL
'these people' (Exodus 5:5)

While Matthew 6:2 contains *a* 'his' *hih* 'this' *mite* 'people' in a larger phrase, that usage is embedded in relative-like material and is therefore less clean as a simple adnominal demonstrative pattern. The OT phrase above remains the better controlled example for this NP-order subsection.

No equally clean Gospel possession row was found for this subsection.

2.3.4 Numerals and nouns

The numerals section provides a fuller analysis of numeral formation and semantics. In the present section, the relevant observation is narrower: noun-plus-numeral order is consistent across examples. *Ni* 'day' *li* 'four' places the noun before the numeral, as does *kum* 'year' *sawm* 'ten' *le* 'and' *nih* 'two'. This pattern holds even when numerals are compound. At the same time, *mi* 'person' *khat* 'one' remains an explicit boundary row, since indefinite-like versus purely numeral interpretation for *khat* 'one' is discussed in both the numerals and quantifiers sections.

(2.27) *nì* *li*
day four
'four days' (John 11:39)

(2.28) *kúm* *sàwm* *lè* *nìh*
year ten and two
'twelve years' (Matthew 9:20)

Gospel sources provide the cleanest examples for this construction in the current evidence base.

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used for this construction.

2.3.5 Quantifiers and nouns

The quantifiers section provides a fuller discussion of total, existential-like, and negative-licensed quantifier material. Here the relevant point is narrower: quantifier forms follow the noun in the clearest examples. *Mi* 'person' *khempeuh* 'all' shows noun-plus-quantifier order for universal quantification. *Mi* 'person' *pawlkhat* 'some group / some' and *mi* 'person' *tampi* 'many' show the same pattern for existential and quantity expressions.

(2.29) *mì* *khèmpeuh*
person all
'all people' (Luke 2:1)

(2.30) *mì* *pàwl-khàt*
person some-one
'some people' (Matthew 2:1)

(2.31) *mì* *tampi*
person many
'many people' (Mark 6:34)

These examples support noun-plus-quantifier order. Each quantifier retains its own semantic caveats from the quantifiers section, but they serve here as NP-order evidence.

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used for this construction.

2.3.6 Possession

Possession is now visible enough to include in this section, but it remains less fully developed than the NP-order material above. The safest claim is that checked possession rows show possessor-before-possessed order in noun phrases. They do not yet justify a full paradigm of possessive prefixes, a complete treatment of apostrophe marking, or a settled theory of alienability.

(2.32) *nà* *pa'* *ínn-àh*
2SG male.POSS house-LOC
'in thy father's house' (Genesis 24:23)

(2.33) *à* *zi'* *mīn*
3SG wife.POSS name
'his wife's name' (Genesis 3:20)

These examples support possessor-before-possessed order. Related anchors such as *ka* 'my' *pa* 'father' and *Topa'* 'Lord' *inn* 'house' are controlled but do not yet enlarge the paradigm enough for a full possession system. Overlap with pronouns, possessive prefixes, genitive marking, case marking, and relators remains explicit in the deferred material section.

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

2.3.7 Boundary with numerals and quantifiers

The numerals and quantifiers sections remain the primary analyses for their own categories. In this section, *khat* 'one' is used only as an NP-order boundary form in *mi* 'person' *khat* 'one', while numeral formation and ordinal analysis remain in the numerals section. Likewise, *khempeuh* 'all', *pawlkhat* 'some group / some', and *tampi* 'many' are used here to show noun-plus-quantifier order, not to reopen quantifier semantics.

2.3.8 Boundary with pronouns, prefix/agreement, case, and relators

Possession in this section intersects with several neighboring domains. Pronoun and prefix/agreement material remains responsible for fuller analysis of possessive prefixes and person-marking overlap. Case marking remains responsible for phrase-edge closure in rows such as *na* 'your' *pa'* 'father' *inn-ah* 'in / into the house'. Relator and postposition analysis remains responsible for rows such as *Topa'* 'Lord' *tungah* 'on', where possession-like morphology meets relational syntax.

2.3.9 Deferred material

This section does not yet settle a complete noun phrase template, a full possession paradigm, or the complete systems of demonstratives, numerals, and quantifiers. More specifically, several important domains remain explicitly deferred.

The possessive-prefix system is not fully normalized here; the prefix/agreement section handles the overlap between possessive and agreement marking. The exact status of apostrophe marking in possessor-possessed relations such as *Topa'* 'Lord' *inn* 'house' and *Topa'* 'Lord' *tungah* 'on' remains unsettled, as does the relation between genitive-like reading and apostrophe-marked patterns. *Topa'* 'Lord' *tungah* 'on' itself is primarily a relator/postposition boundary row rather than core possession. Recursive or chained possessive structures such as *a* 'his' *pa'* 'father' *inn* 'house' are deferred as more complex possession phenomena. Nominalization boundary cases such as *ka* 'my' *suahna* 'birth-NMLZ' *leitang* 'land' belong partly to nominalization and broader noun-headed syntax.

The full systems of demonstratives, numerals, and quantifiers remain in their dedicated sections; this section uses those systems only as NP-order evidence.

2.4 Noun domain

The noun-domain evidence is strongest for simple stems such as *gam* 'land / country' and *aksi* 'star', for plural *-te*, and for nouns that remain visible as heads inside larger phrases.

2.4.1 Overview of the noun domain

Tedim noun-domain evidence supports a modest but coherent set of claims. Simple lexical nouns such as *gam* 'land / country' and *aksi* 'star' are securely attested. The plural marker *-te* is visible on nouns such as *aksi-te* 'stars' and *mite* 'people'. Human noun *mi* 'person' remains central in larger noun phrases, including *mi khat* 'one person / a person', *mi khempeuh* 'all people', *mi pawlkhat* 'some people', and *mi tampi* 'many people'. Nonhuman heads such as *ni* 'day' and *kum* 'year' also remain visible in counted phrases. Transparent compounds exist, but only some are stable enough for grammar prose. Proper names and title-like forms belong on the noun map too, though they are kept separate from productive noun morphology. The noun domain overlaps with NP structure, quantification, and nominalization, so those interfaces remain explicit rather than collapsed (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.4.2 Noun-domain inventory

Form or pattern	Function	Status	Notes
gam	simple common noun 'land / country'	core	ordinary lexical noun
aksi	simple common noun 'star'	core	visible in simple and possessed phrases
aksi-te	plural noun 'stars'	core	visible plural marking on a simple noun
mi	human noun 'person'	core	central noun head in NP, numeral, and quantifier phrases

Form or pattern	Function	Status	Notes
mite	human plural noun ‘people’	core	plural human noun; demonstrative ordering belongs elsewhere
minam	transparent compound ‘nation’	core with caveat	compound transparency still needs boundary control
thugen	transparent compound ‘speech’	core with caveat	still more lexical than the simple stems
sanggam	lexicalized compound / boundary noun	boundary	opaque or lexicalized compound
singnai	transparency-boundary compound	boundary	etymology still unsettled
kholhna	nominalization-boundary noun	boundary	overlaps with nominalization
Abraham	proper name	boundary	proper-name syntax remains separate
Topa	title-like noun	boundary	lexical title, not a transparent productive derivation

2.4.3 Simple lexical nouns

The safest simple-stem anchors are *gam* and *aksi*. *Gam* ‘land / country’ is a basic common noun, and *aksi* ‘star’ stays visible even when it occurs in a possessed phrase. These rows are enough to show that ordinary lexical nouns are directly attested before the analysis moves on to plural marking and larger noun phrases.

(2.34) *gàm sùng*
land inside
‘in the land’ (Genesis 2:5)

(2.35) *àmà aksi*
3SG.POSS star
‘his star’ (Matthew 2:2)

2.4.4 Human noun mi

Mi ‘person’ is the central human noun in the nominal domain. It appears as a bare noun and as the head of larger nominal expressions such as *mi khat* ‘one person / a person’, *mi khempeuh* ‘all people’, *mi pawlkhat* ‘some people’, and *mi tampi* ‘many people’. The noun-domain point is simply that *mi* remains visibly nominal across these environments; the fuller numeral and quantifier analyses stay in their own sections.

(2.36) *mì khàt*
person one
‘a man / one person’ (Genesis 32:24)

(2.37) *mì khèmpeuh*
person all
‘all people’ (Luke 2:1)

2.4.5 Plural marking with -te

Plural marking with *-te* is visible on simple nouns and human nouns. *Aksi-te* ‘stars’ is the clearest nonhuman anchor, while *mite* ‘people’ shows the same plural marker in the human domain. That is enough for a cautious noun-domain plural claim, but not for a full plural system. Broader questions about distributive readings, plurality outside simple noun stems, and interaction with quantification remain separate.

(2.38) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:noun-aksi-te: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

aksi-tè
star-PL

'stars' (Genesis 1:16)

(2.39) *híh* *mì-tè*
PROX person-PL
'these people' (Exodus 5:5)

No equally clean Gospel plural example is currently used for this construction.

2.4.6 Compounds

Compounds are included only where their structure remains readable. *Minam* 'nation' is transparent enough to keep as a controlled compound anchor, and *thugen* 'speech' is another useful compound because its two stems are still visible. These forms show that noun compounding exists, but the section does not turn compound transparency into a full typology. Opaque or boundary-heavy compounds such as *sanggam*, *singnai*, and *kholhna* remain deferred.

(2.40) *mì-nam* *khàt*
person-kind one
'one nation' (Genesis 11:6)

(2.41) *Lamek'* *zi-tè* *àw,* *kà* *thù-gēn* *ngái* *ùn.*
LAMEK.POSS wife-PL voice 1SG speech listen.I IMP.PL
'O wives of Lamech, hear my speech.' (Genesis 4:23)

No equally clean Gospel compound example is currently used here.

2.4.7 Proper names and titles

Proper names are distinct from productive noun morphology. Abraham behaves like an ordinary noun in case-marked environments, but the noun domain only needs the narrow claim that proper names are nominal and not a separate noun-class system. Title-like *Topa* 'Lord' belongs beside proper names, but it is lexicalized and title-like rather than a transparent derivation.

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used here; the subsection keeps one formal example because the clearest raw genitive phrase is *Abraham' suan* in Matthew 1:1, while the Old Testament proper-name rows are more boundary-heavy or title-like than this narrow claim needs.

(2.42) *Abraham'* *suan* *David*
ABRAHAM.POSS plant DAVID
'David, descendant of Abraham' (Matthew 1:1)

The proper-name report shows *Topa* with regular case forms, but that is exactly why it stays boundary-only here rather than becoming a productive noun pattern.

2.4.8 Boundary with NP structure and nominalization

Nouns remain visible inside larger NP structures, but this section does not reopen the numeral or quantifier analyses. *Mi* as a noun head in *mi khat*, *mi khempeuh*, *mi pawlkhat*, and *mi tampi* belongs to those larger structures, while the noun-domain claim here is only that *mi* remains a lexical noun. Nonhuman heads such as *ni* and *kum* also remain visible in counted phrases like *ni li* 'four days' and *kum sawm le nih* 'twelve years'. Nominalized nouns belong with the nominalization section, so *kholhna* and other *-na*-looking forms are not promoted here. Proper-name syntax and title morphology remain separate from the noun inventory, and the full relation between nouns and NP structure is therefore only partially addressed here.

2.4.9 Deferred material

This section does not yet settle full noun classification, the full plural system, classifier-like nouns, complete compound typology, nominalized nouns, proper-name syntax, title morphology, or the full relation between nouns and NP structure. It therefore keeps lexical nouns, plural marking, compounds, proper names, and titles visible but separate so the noun domain remains controlled.

2.5 Case marking

The current case evidence centers on *-ah* 'locative / goal-like' and *-in* 'ergative / agentive', while *-pan* 'source / ablative', *-panin* 'source / departure', and *-tawh* 'with' remain more cautious oblique extensions.

2.5.1 Overview of case-like marking

The current evidence supports a modest but coherent picture of postnominal case-like marking in Tedim. The clearest claims concern locative or goal-like *-ah* 'locative / goal-like' and clause-level agentive or ergative *-in* 'ergative / agentive'. The same section also supports more cautious discussion of source marking with *-pan* 'source / ablative' and *-panin* 'source / departure', plus accompaniment or material-extension uses of *-tawh* 'with', but those markers remain more boundary-heavy because they overlap with relator nouns, postpositions, or broader semantic extension.

The safest current prose therefore treats case marking as an NP-final domain rather than as a fully settled paradigm of discrete suffixes. Plain noun-plus-case rows such as *khua-ah* 'in the town' and clause-level agent rows such as *Kain in* 'Cain as agent' are secure enough to print. Relator-hosted forms such as *lakpan* 'from among' and *David khuapi sungah* 'in the city of David' are also real, but they should not be collapsed into a bare suffix inventory. Apostrophe-marked possession can host the same NP-final marking, yet the apostrophe itself remains a boundary issue rather than a settled genitive case marker in this section.

The Gospel search was productive enough to keep the section from becoming OT-only. The current manually reviewed supplement adds usable Gospel support for *Herod in* 'Herod as agent', *keima inn-ah* 'into my house', *David khuapi sungah* 'in the city of David', and *lakpan* 'from among'. The possessive-boundary example remains OT-led, because no equally compact Gospel row was as clean under the current control standard.

2.5.2 Current case-marking inventory

Marker or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
-ah	locative or goal-like NP-final marking	*khua-ah*, *inn-ah*	well-supported	must stay distinct from deferred tone-sensitive *-a* and from relator-hosted spatial phrases

Marker or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Status in this draft	Main boundary issue
-in	clause-level ergative or agentive marking	*Kain in*, *Herod in*	well-supported	raw *-in* extraction overgenerates forms such as *ciangin*
possessor phrase plus *-ah*	possessed NP closed by case-like marking	*na pa' inn-ah*	supported with caveat	does not settle the apostrophe or genitive analysis
-pan	source marking, often on a relator host	*lakpan*	supported with caveat	current clean evidence is relator-hosted rather than a broad bare-suffix paradigm
-panin	source or departure marking	*inn panin*	supported with caveat	internal structure remains under review
-tawh	accompaniment, with material or instrumental extension	*kei tawh*, *leivui tawh*	supported with caveat	accompaniment should not be flattened together with material-extension use
relator noun plus case	spatial relational phrase closed by case-like marking	*David khuapi sungah*, *tungah*, *kiangah*	supported with caveat	belongs jointly with the relators / postpositions section rather than a suffix-only list

2.5.3 Locative and goal marking with -ah

The clearest present claim is that *-ah* is a locative or goal-like case marker at the right edge of the noun phrase. The primary checked control is plain noun-plus-locative *khua-ah*, while the new source-balance supplement adds a compact Gospel goal-like example with *keima inn-ah*. This is enough to describe *-ah* as marking location and destination-like relations without forcing a sharper split among locative, allative, and general oblique labels than the current evidence can support.

The section also keeps one important negative control explicit. The current evidence does **not** justify collapsing deferred *-a* material into *-ah*. The source inventory and case background notes both keep tone-sensitive or otherwise ambiguous *-a* questions unresolved, so the description remains narrower than a full locative or allative chapter.

(2.43) *khùa-àh*
town-LOC
'in the town' (Genesis 11:28)

(2.44) *kèima ínn-àh*
1SG.self house-LOC
'into my house' (Matthew 8:8)

These two rows together support the safest present wording. *khua-ah* keeps the simple noun-plus-case pattern visible, while *keima inn-ah* shows that the same marker naturally appears in a Gospel clause with motion toward a location. That is enough for cautious the present discussion, but not yet enough to decide whether every *-ah* token should be described as specifically locative, allative, or more generally oblique.

2.5.4 Agentive, ergative, or instrumental marking with -in

The present section supports an agentive or ergative analysis of *-in* more clearly than it supports any broader instrumental analysis. Genesis 4:3 remains the primary checked anchor because *Kain in* is the cleanest controlled row. The new supplement adds Matthew 2:4 *Herod in* as a manually reviewed Gospel support example, which helps show that the pattern is not confined to one OT narrative window.

At the same time, this section does not claim a complete ergative system. It also does not promote a general instrumental *-in* category. The most important control here is still the homograph problem: raw searches for *-in* overgenerate forms such as *ciangin* 'when', so only checked clause-level noun phrase rows are promoted into the grammar prose.

(2.45) *Kain ìn*
KAIN ERG
'Cain as transitive subject' (Genesis 4:3)

(2.46) *Herod ìn*
HEROD ERG
'Herod as transitive subject' (Matthew 2:4)

These examples are intentionally compact. They are not meant to reopen the full alignment chapter. They only show that a noun phrase can bear checked *-in* marking in a clause with a transitive predicate, and that this is stronger evidence than any uncontrolled *-in* string would be.

2.5.5 Other controlled oblique markers

The section still retains a small set of other controlled case-like markers, but they are best treated more cautiously than *-ah* and *-in*. Source marking with *-pan* and *-panin* is real enough to describe, especially in rows such as *lakpan* 'from among' and *inn panin* 'from the house', yet the cleanest *-pan* example is relator-hosted and the internal structure of *-panin* remains under review. Likewise, *-tawh* remains part of the section because *kei tawh* 'with me' is a clean accompaniment row and *leivui tawh* 'with dust' shows a material or instrument-like extension, but that semantic split needs to stay explicit.

This means the section can already mention *-pan*, *-panin*, and *-tawh* in the current inventory, but it should not yet present them as a fully normalized oblique subsystem. For the present pass, they remain controlled supporting material rather than the center of the case-marking chapter.

(2.47) *ínn pàn-ìn*
house ABL-ERG
'from the house' (Genesis 12:1)

(2.48) *kèi tàwh*
1SG.PRO COM
'with me' (Genesis 14:24)

(2.49) *leivui tàwh*
dust COM
'with dust' (Genesis 2:7)

These rows keep the oblique material concrete. *Inn panin* 'from the house' shows source marking without a relator host, while *kei tawh* 'with me' and *leivui tawh* 'with dust' show that *-tawh* covers both accompaniment and material-extension uses.

No equally clean Gospel source or accompaniment row is currently used here, so the subsection stays OT-led while the broader oblique inventory remains cautiously delimited.

2.5.6 Genitive / possessive boundary

The clearest way to discuss genitive or possessive boundary material at present is to show that an already possessed noun phrase can host case-like marking at its right edge. Genesis 24:23 gives the compact row *na pa' inn-ah* 'in your father's house', which is already reused in the normalized NP structure / possession section. Here it serves a narrower purpose: it shows that case-like marking closes the larger noun phrase rather than attaching only to a simple underived noun stem.

(2.50) *nà pa' ínn-àh*
2SG male.POSS house-LOC
'in thy father's house' (Genesis 24:23)

This is enough to justify a boundary note, but not enough to settle the apostrophe analysis. The present section therefore does not settle whether the apostrophe material should be treated as a genitive suffix, a possessive linker, or an orthographic boundary convention. It only records that possessed noun phrases can participate in the same case-closing pattern that appears elsewhere in the nominal domain. The fuller discussion of possessive structure remains with the normalized NP structure / possession section.

No equally good Gospel example of a possessed noun phrase with case-like closure is currently used here, so the subsection stays with the compact OT example while the wider possession discussion remains elsewhere.

2.5.7 Case marking and relators/postpositions

The boundary with relators and postpositions is now one of the main editorial points of the section. Forms such as *sungah* 'inside / in', *tungah* 'on / upon', *kiangah* 'beside / near', and *lakpan* 'from among' are not noise, but neither are they simple proof that Tedim can be described by a suffix-only case list. The relational host matters: *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on top', *kiang* 'side / vicinity', and *lak* 'among' contribute spatial content before locative or source marking is added.

(2.51) *David khùa-pì sùng-àh*
DAVID village-big inside-LOC
'in the city of David' (Luke 2:11)

(2.52) *lak-pàn*
midst-ABL
'from among' (Matthew 5:19)

These rows belong here because they are case-like and NP-final. They also belong with the relators / postpositions section because the relational noun is part of the grammar, not just a carrier for a suffix. That is why forms such as *tungah* or *lakpan* should not be collapsed into case marking without careful evidence control. The best current solution is to let the two sections meet at the boundary rather than pretending the boundary does not exist.

No equally clean Old Testament example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Gospel anchors.

2.5.8 Case marking and argument structure

The normalized case section can now say one modest thing about argument structure: checked *-in* rows such as *Kain in* 'Cain as agent' and *Herod in* 'Herod as agent' show case-marked noun phrases functioning as clause-level agents, while locative or goal-like rows such as *inn-ah* 'in / into the house' show noun phrases entering the clause as spatial arguments or adjuncts. That is enough to connect the nominal domain to clause structure without reopening the full alignment or valency chapter.

The present section therefore cross-references the transitivity section rather than replacing it. The transitivity section remains the place for fuller discussion of argument frames, lexical valency, and broader alignment questions. Case marking only contributes the controlled NP-final marking side of that picture here.

2.5.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several important topics remain explicitly deferred.

- A full case paradigm is still deferred; the present evidence is not yet enough for a full case paradigm.
- The ergative versus instrumental distinction for *-in* is not settled here.
- The finer split among locative, dative, allative, and general oblique functions is still under review.
- Tone-sensitive *-a* material remains blocked rather than being collapsed into *-ah*.
- Apostrophe or genitive analysis remains unresolved and stays shared with the NP structure / possession section.
- Possessive noun phrase overlap remains explicit, especially where possessed NPs then take *-ah*.
- Relator-noun and postposition structure remains shared with the relators / postpositions section.
- Full alignment and argument-structure claims remain shared with the transitivity section.
- *-panin* remains a controlled source-marking row without a fully settled internal analysis.
- *-tawh* remains split between accompaniment and material or instrumental extension.
- Analyzer-noisy or raw report-only marker rows are not promoted into the present discussion.
- Raw generated-report counts and broad analyzer output are not treated as grammar facts in this section.

2.5.10 Summary

The case-marking section can now support a fuller description than the earlier narrow section allowed. Current evidence safely supports clause-level *-in*, locative or goal-like *-ah*, a boundary note on possessed noun phrases such as *na pa' inn-ah*, and a controlled interface with relator-hosted forms such as *David khuapi sungah* and *lakpan*. Source marking with *-pan* and *-panin*, along with *-tawh*, remains usable but secondary and caveated. The result is a real grammar section with explicit limits, not a claim that the full Tedim case system has already been finished (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.6 Relators / postpositions

The current evidence supports relational nouns such as *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on / upon', *kiang* 'beside / near', and *lak* 'among / midst', together with postpositional source patterns that close the larger phrase.

2.6.1 Overview of relators and postpositions

Tedim uses relational nouns and postpositional expressions to encode spatial and other relations, and case-like marking often appears at the right edge of the resulting phrase. The clearest current relator stems are *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on / upon', *kiang* 'beside / near', *lak* 'among / midst', and the more cautious *pualam* 'outside'. Related forms such as *laizang* 'middle / midst' point to the same semantic field, but the present section keeps its main discussion on the better-controlled relator stems (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

The main descriptive point is therefore structural rather than terminological. A form such as *sung* 'inside' or *kiang* 'beside / near' contributes spatial content of its own, while the phrase may still close with case-like material such as *-ah* 'locative / goal-like' or with source-marking *pan* 'from' and *panin* 'from'. This is why the relator section and the case-marking section overlap without collapsing into each other.

2.6.2 Current relator / postposition inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
sung	interior relation	*David khuapi sungah*	well supported	most often appears with phrase-edge marking
tung	surface or superposed relation	*tua tui tungah*	supported with caveat	some uses remain close to broader oblique or abstract extensions
kiang	side, vicinity, or adjacency	*mipa kiangah*	supported with caveat	also overlaps with recipient-like and source-like uses
lak	among or amidst	*numeite lak panin*	well supported	source marking may be written as a separate form or a tighter unit
pualam	exterior or outside space	*kongkhak pualam*	cautious support	more lexical-nominal than the core four relator anchors
sungah	interior phrase closed by *-ah*	*David khuapi sungah*	well supported	shared with the case-marking discussion of phrase-edge *-ah*
tungah	surface relation closed by *-ah*	*tua tui tungah*	well supported	the relator stem and the edge marker both contribute meaning
kiangah	adjacency relation closed by *-ah*	*mipa kiangah*	supported with caveat	also touches recipient-like use in larger clause structure
lakpan / lak panin	source from an interior set	*lakpan*, *numeite lak panin*	well supported	fused and separated spellings both belong at the relator or case boundary
NP + tawh	accompaniment or associative postposition	*kei tawh*	supporting boundary pattern	shared with accompaniment and material-extension uses discussed under case marking

2.6.3 Spatial relator nouns

The clearest first point is that Tedim has spatial relator nouns, not only bare suffixes. In the current evidence, bare spatial use is especially easy to see with *pualam* 'outside', while the other stems frequently occur with additional edge marking. That asymmetry is itself informative: the relational noun remains visible even when another marker closes the phrase.

(2.53) *kòng-khàk* *pualam*
1SG→3-limit outside
'outside the door' (Mark 2:2)

(2.54) *khùa-pì pualam*
village-big outside
'outside the city' (Genesis 24:11)

These examples keep the relator stem visible without forcing a larger claim about every spatial noun in the language. The same evidence domain also supports discussion of *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on / upon', *kiang* 'beside / near', and *lak* 'among / midst', but those stems are most naturally illustrated below in phrases where a case-like or source-marking element closes the larger expression.

2.6.4 Relator plus case-like marking

When case-like marking is added, forms such as *sungah* 'inside / in', *tungah* 'on / upon', *kiangah* 'beside / near', and *lakpan* 'from among' show that the relational noun and the final marker both contribute to the construction. The resulting forms are real grammatical units, but the present evidence does not support treating them as if the relator had disappeared and only a suffix remained.

(2.55) *David khùa-pì sùng-àh*
DAVID village-big inside-LOC
'in the city of David' (Luke 2:11)

(2.56) *túa tùi tùngàh*
DIST water on-LOC
'upon the water' (Genesis 1:2)

(2.57) *mipa kìang-àh*
man beside-LOC
'to the man / beside the man' (Genesis 2:19)

(2.58) *lak-pàn*
midst-ABL
'from among' (Matthew 5:19)

The examples are deliberately compact, because the descriptive issue is compact as well. *David khuapi sungah* and *tua tui tungah* show interior and surface relations closed by *-ah*, while *mipa kiangah* shows that adjacency expressions behave in the same way. *Lakpan* then shows that source marking can be hosted by the relator itself rather than by a simple noun stem.

2.6.5 Postpositional phrase structure

The current evidence also supports a modest structural claim about postpositional phrases. A relator or postposition follows the noun phrase that supplies its semantic anchor, and the whole sequence can then carry the source-like meaning of *pan* 'from' or *panin* 'from'. This is clearest when the noun phrase before the relator is larger than a single bare noun.

(2.59) *Pà kìang pàn-ìn*
father beside ABL-ERG
'from the Father' (John 6:45)

(2.60) *numei-tè lāk pàn-ìn*
woman-PL among ABL-ERG
'from among the women' (Exodus 2:7)

These examples keep the structural claim modest. The section does not claim a single uniform analysis for every spelling alternation or every source-marking form. It only shows that the relational element is phrase-medial rather than invisible, because the noun phrase comes first and the postpositional or case-like material closes the expression afterward.

2.6.6 Case-marking boundary

The boundary with case marking remains explicit. Forms such as *sungah*, *tungah*, *kiangah*, and *lakpan* are shared with the case-marking section because both pieces of the construction matter: the relator contributes the spatial relation, and the final marker contributes locative or source-like closure. The case-marking section therefore remains responsible for the edge-marking side of the analysis, while the present section explains why the relational host is still grammatically visible.

This division of labor matters especially for *-ah*, *pan*, and *panin*. A phrase like *David khuapi sungah* is not just a bare locative suffix attached to *khuapi*, and *lakpan* is not just a bare ablative suffix detached from *lak*. The relator and the phrase-edge marker work together.

2.6.7 Possession and NP-structure boundary

The relator or postposition can follow a larger noun phrase rather than a simple stem. This is already visible in *David khuapi sungah* 'in the city of David', in kin-based phrases such as *Pa kiang panin* 'from the Father', and in possessed noun phrases such as *Faro' inn sungah* 'in Pharaoh's house'. The structure is therefore phrase-closing rather than stem-bound.

The present section stops there. Fuller discussion of possessive marking and noun-phrase architecture remains with the NP structure / possession section, but that section and the present one now meet at a clear grammatical boundary.

2.6.8 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *nuai* and *mai* remain possible spatial nouns, but the current section does not promote them as core relator anchors.
- *tawhin* is still too sparse and too instrument-like to stand beside *pan*, *panin*, or *tawh* in the present account.
- The exact relation between tighter spellings such as *lakpan* and separated spellings such as *lak panin* remains open.
- Wider recipient-like uses around *kiang* still belong partly with clause structure and partly with case marking.
- Compound spatial nouns such as *laizang* remain relevant background, but they are not the center of the present section.

2.6.9 Summary

The current evidence supports a grammar-facing account of Tedim relators and postpositions. Spatial relations are carried by visible relational nouns such as *sung* 'inside', *tung* 'on / upon', *kiang* 'beside / near', *lak* 'among / midst', and cautiously *pualam* 'outside', while postpositional and case-like material closes the larger phrase. The result is a relational system whose structure is clearer once the relator and the phrase-edge marker are described together rather than forced into a suffix-only inventory (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

2.7 Numerals

The current numeral evidence supports a decimal system with basic cardinals, counted noun phrases, and *-na* ordinals, while larger-number and classifier-like material remain explicit boundary notes.

2.7.1 Overview of the numeral system

Tedim numerals are organized around a decimal structure in which *khat* 'one', *nih* 'two', and *kua* 'nine' combine with base terms such as *sawm* 'ten' and *za* 'hundred' (Cing, 2017; Henderson, 1965). Larger units such as *sing* 'thousand' and *tul* 'ten thousand' are also recognized in the system, although the clearest examples in this section remain in the lower ranges plus selected large-number biblical expressions.

The evidence in hand supports a cautious but substantive description: basic cardinals, compound numerals, noun-plus-numeral order, *-na* ordinals, and at least one occurrence-counting expression are all securely attested in formal examples.

2.7.2 Cardinal inventory

Value	Numeral	Notes
1	*khat*	cardinal, with indefinite-like overlap in some noun phrases
2	*nih*	basic cardinal
3	*thum*	basic cardinal
4	*li*	basic cardinal
5	*nga*	basic cardinal
6	*guk*	basic cardinal
7	*sagih*	basic cardinal
8	*giat*	basic cardinal
9	*kua*	numeral 'nine' in explicitly numeral environments
10	*sawm*	decimal base 'ten'
100	*za*	decimal base 'hundred'
1,000	*sing*	larger numeral unit
10,000	*tul*	larger numeral unit

The table summarizes the core inventory without forcing a full paradigm of every possible constructional variant.

2.7.3 Compound numerals

Compound numerals are straightforwardly visible in both Old Testament and Gospel examples.

(2.61) *kúm sàwm-kua*
year ten-nine
'ninety years' (Genesis 5:9)

(2.62) *kúm sàwm lè nìh*
year ten and two
'twelve years' (Matthew 9:20)

(2.63) *kúm zā-kua lè kúm sàwm-gùk lè kua*
year hundred-nine and year ten-six and who
'nine hundred sixty and nine years' (Genesis 5:27)

These examples support a decimal-compositional analysis for tens and larger expressions. The Genesis 5:27 line is structurally numeral despite analyzer irregularities in the final token gloss.

2.7.4 Noun-plus-numeral word order

The strongest current examples show counted nouns preceding numerals.

(2.64) *kúm nìh*
year two
'two years' (Genesis 11:10)

(2.65) *nì sagih*
day seven
'seven days' (Genesis 7:10)

(2.66) *nì li*
day four
'four days' (John 11:39)

These data justify a conservative claim that noun-plus-numeral order is well supported in the best current examples.

2.7.5 Ordinals and the *-na* boundary

Ordinal formation with *-na* is securely attested.

(2.67) *nìh-ná*
two-NMLZ
'second' (Genesis 7:11)

Here *-na* marks ordinal derivation; this use should not be collapsed with the broader nominalizing functions of *-na* elsewhere in the grammar.

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

2.7.6 Multiplicative and counting expressions

Occurrence counting is represented by *sawmvei* 'ten times'.

(2.68) *sàwm-véi*
ten-times
'ten times' (Genesis 31:7)

This expression is retained in the fused form *sawmvei*; it is not rewritten here as a different segmentation.

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

2.7.7 Ambiguity controls: *kua* and *khat*

Numeral interpretation still requires constructional control in two high-risk areas.

Form	Numeral-side interpretation	Competing interpretation	Caution
kua	'nine' in numeral compounds such as *sawmkua* and larger arithmetic frames	interrogative 'who'	treat as numeral only in clearly numeral constructions

Form	Numeral-side interpretation	Competing interpretation	Caution
khat	cardinal 'one'	indefinite-like NP uses	do not overgeneralize indefinite-like uses as pure numeral syntax

(2.69) *mì* *khàt*
person one
'a man' / 'one person' (Genesis 32:24)

The interrogative control remains explicit: **Hihte kua ahi hiam?** is a *kua* 'who' clause, not numeral evidence.

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

2.7.8 Deferred and boundary material

This section does not yet settle the full classifier system, full quantification patterns, the full range of indefinite-like uses of *khat*, all interrogative-side *kua* behavior, or broader NP syntax. It therefore keeps numeral claims narrow where overlap with quantifiers, NP structure, and clause-level interpretation remains unresolved.

2.8 Quantifiers

The current quantifier evidence centers on *khempeuh* 'all', *pawlkhat* 'some people', *kuamah* 'nobody', *bangmah* 'nothing', and noun-plus-quantifier phrases such as *mi tampi* 'many people'.

2.8.1 Overview of quantification in Tedim

The safest current analysis supports a small set of quantifier domains rather than a single neat paradigm. Universal quantification is clearest with *khempeuh* 'all'. Existential and partitive-like quantification is visible with *pawlkhat* 'some group / some', but this remains construction-sensitive. Negative quantification is clearest with *kuamah* 'nobody' and *bangmah* 'nothing / anything' in clauses licensed by negation. Quantity expressions are represented by *tampi* 'many', especially in noun phrases such as *mi* 'person' *tampi* 'many' 'many people' and in degree-like expressions such as *tampi* 'many' *tak* 'truly' 'very many / exceedingly' (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

Quantification therefore overlaps with numeral interpretation, noun phrase structure, and negation. The section keeps those interfaces explicit instead of collapsing them into one category.

2.8.2 Quantifier inventory

Form	Provisional function	Current status	Notes
khempeuh	universal / total quantifier	core	strongest universal anchor
pawlkhat	existential / partitive-like quantifier	core with caveat	grouping and partitive nuance remains important
kuamah	negative quantifier (human)	core with caveat	requires clear negation licensing
bangmah	negative quantifier (nonhuman)	core with caveat	requires clear negation licensing; has bang-family overlap outside this use
tampi; *mi tampi*	quantity expression	core with caveat	overlaps with broader degree-modification behavior

Form	Provisional function	Current status	Notes
khat in *mi khat*	numeral / indefinite boundary form	boundary	kept explicitly tied to numeral overlap
peuhpeuh	free-choice or distributive-looking form	deferred boundary	not yet stabilized as core quantifier evidence
tawm	low-quantity edge form	deferred boundary	current evidence remains too noisy for promotion
zaw	comparative edge form	boundary	visible, but not part of a full comparison analysis
mahmah	intensifier edge form	boundary	visible, but not part of a full intensifier analysis

2.8.3 Universal quantification

Khempeuh 'all' is the clearest total-quantifier anchor in the present evidence.

(2.70) *vàn-tùng léi-tùng lè à sùng-à ōm-tè khèmpeuh*
sky-on land-on and 3SG inside-3SG exist-PL all
'the heavens and the earth, and all that was in them' (Genesis 2:1)

(2.71) *mì khèmpeuh*
person all
'all people' / 'everyone' (Luke 2:1)

Together these examples support a conservative claim: universal quantification is clearly available in noun phrase contexts, and *khempeuh* 'all' can be treated as the central form for this function.

2.8.4 Existential / partitive-like quantification

Pawlkhat is the main existential or partitive-like form, but the interpretation remains construction-sensitive.

(2.72) *pàwl-khàt*
some-one
'one group' / 'one company' (Genesis 32:8)

(2.73) *mì pàwl-khàt*
person some-one
'some people' (Matthew 2:1)

(2.74) *mì khàt*
person one
'a man' / 'one person' (Genesis 32:24)

These examples justify a cautious description: *pawlkhat* 'some group / some' supports partitive-like or grouped existential readings, while *mi* 'person' *khat* 'one' remains boundary material between numeral and indefinite-like interpretation.

2.8.5 Negative quantifiers and negation

Kuamah and *bangmah* are treated as quantifiers only where clause-level negation licenses them.

(2.75) *kuamah mú lò*
nobody see.I NEG
'he saw nobody' / 'he saw no man' (Exodus 2:12)

(2.76) *bangmah ōm lò hì*
nothing exist NEG DECL
'there is nothing' / 'nothing exists' (Genesis 39:9)

(2.77) *kuamah ìn bangmah híh théi lò hì*
nobody ERG nothing PROX know NEG DECL
'nobody can do anything' (John 3:27)

The section therefore aligns with the negation analysis without duplicating it: negative quantifier interpretation depends on explicit negation licensing, and bang-family material outside that environment is kept separate from this core description.

2.8.6 Quantity expressions

Quantity is represented by *tampi* 'many', both in degree-like expression and in noun phrase quantification.

(2.78) *tampi tak*
many truly
'very many' / 'exceedingly' (Genesis 17:2)

(2.79) *mì tampi*
person many
'many people' (Mark 6:34)

These rows support a narrow claim: quantity expressions are clearly available, but they overlap with broader degree and modification systems that are not resolved here.

2.8.7 Boundary with numerals

The numerals section remains the primary analysis for counting and ordinal material. In this section, *khat* 'one' is kept primarily on the numeral side unless context clearly supports an indefinite-like reading, and *pawlkhat* 'some group / some' is not reduced to a simple compositional reading of 'one' plus an unspecified element. Ordinal and counting constructions are therefore not absorbed into quantifier analysis.

2.8.8 Boundary with NP structure and negation

Noun-plus-quantifier patterns such as *mi* 'person' *khempeuh* 'all' 'all people', *mi* 'person' *pawlkhat* 'some group / some' 'some people', and *mi* 'person' *tampi* 'many' 'many people' also belong to the NP structure domain. Likewise, negative quantifiers belong partly to the negation domain because their interpretation is licensed by clause-level negation. The present section therefore coordinates with NP structure and negation without absorbing their full analyses.

2.8.9 Deferred material

This section does not yet settle full free-choice quantification, all indefinite uses, intensifier systems, comparative and degree morphology, or the complete NP template. *Peuhpeuh* 'every, each', *tawm* 'few', *zaw* 'comparative edge', and *mahmah* 'very, truly' remain visible as boundary or deferred material while core quantifier claims are kept narrow.

3 Predicate structure and verbal morphology

3.1 Stem alternation

The current stem-alternation evidence supports a controlled Form I / Form II contrast around *mu / muh* 'see', *ne / nek* 'eat', and *nei / neih* 'have', while promoted caveated pairs, one-sided controls, and blocked rows remain explicit boundaries.

3.1.1 Overview of stem alternation

Tedim verbal morphology shows stem alternation that is grammatically relevant in current corpus evidence. This section uses the repository's established terms **Form I / Form II**, alongside **Stem 1 / Stem 2** where needed for compatibility with earlier literature descriptions (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). The present account is deliberately controlled: it describes secure alternation evidence and its grammatical environments, but it does not claim that the full verb-stem paradigm is already complete.

The strongest claim is structural rather than historical. Form I is clearest in many finite main-clause predicates, while Form II is strongly represented in dependent, nominalized, and constructionally bound environments. The evidence supports this contrast in specific pairs; it does not support reducing every verb to one mechanical rule.

3.1.2 Stem alternation inventory

Lexical meaning	Form I	Form II	Diagnostic environment	Source	Status
see	*mu*	*muh*	finite predicate vs dependent/attributive environments	Genesis 1:4; Genesis 19:1	core
eat	*ne*	*nek*	same-verse finite vs temporal dependent contrast	Genesis 2:17	core
have	*nei*	*neih*	finite predicate vs nominal/attributive expression	Genesis 11:30; 2 Samuel 23:8	core
hear / listen	*za*	*zak*	dependent temporal environment with *ciangin*	Genesis 24:52	supported with caveat
give	*pia*	*piak*	paired contrast in one speech turn	Genesis 3:12	supported with caveat
leave / forsake	*nusia*	*nusiat*	clause-linking environment with *kipan*	Deuteronomy 2:14	supported with caveat
know / be able	*thei*	*theih*	modal and nominalized concentration	Genesis 2:17 and related constructions	needs further control
be born / arise	*piang*	*pian*	mostly derived or purposive environments	Genesis 10:29 and related constructions	needs further control

3.1.3 Core alternation patterns

Current evidence supports several stem-shape pathways, but the system should not be forced into a single exhaustive typology at this stage. In running prose, the clearest non-core expansions are *za / zak* 'hear / listen', *pia / piak* 'give', *nusia / nusiat* 'leave / forsake', and *piang / pian* 'be born / arise'.

Pattern	Representative pairs	What current evidence supports	What remains open
final *-h* alternation	*mu / muh* 'see', *nei / neih* 'have', *thei / theih* 'know / be able'	stable Form I/Form II contrast is visible	conditioning is uneven across lexical families
final *-k* alternation	*ne / nek* 'eat', *za / zak* 'hear / listen', *pia / piak* 'give'	alternation is grammatically real in controlled clauses	lexical and constructional spread differs by verb
final *-t* or extended-shape alternation	*nusia / nusiat* 'leave / forsake', *sawlkhia / sawlkhiat* 'send out'	alternating stem shapes appear in clause-linked and non-final environments	full coverage is still sparse for some pairs
lexicalized or unclear cases	*ngai / ngaih* 'need / love / listen', *honkhia / honkhiat* 'deliver / bring out'	these forms are visible and should remain documented	present evidence does not yet settle clean stem-pair status

3.1.4 Grammatical environments for alternants

Form I is clearest in straightforward finite predication, while Form II is especially visible where clause structure is non-final or nominalized. The temporal linker *ciangin* 'when' and the day-frame *ni-in* 'on the day / when' frequently host Form II in controlled examples. Clause-linking *kipan* 'from / since' and purposive *nadingin* 'in order to' likewise show constructions where Form II is prominent.

Nominalized *-na* 'nominalizer' and attributive *mi* 'person / one who' environments remain central for identifying Form II distribution. This is why forms such as *theihna* and *neih mi* 'have.II person / one who has' are informative for stem alternation even when they are not bare finite predicates.

Negative clauses are informative but not sufficient as a stand-alone diagnostic. Current evidence contains both Form I and Form II under negation, so this section treats negation as one environment among several rather than as a universal trigger.

3.1.5 Relation to prefix/agreement

Stem alternation and prefix/agreement describe different layers of verbal morphology. In *ka-nei* '1SG-have', the prefix *ka-* 'first-person prefix' contributes person marking, while *nei* is the stem shape relevant here. In contrast, nominal or attributive material such as *neih mi* 'have.II person / one who has' shows a stem-shape alternant that belongs to stem alternation, not to prefix routing.

This section therefore uses prefix-bearing forms only where they clarify stem shape. The broader agreement-before-verbal-host and possession-before-nominal-host analysis remains in the prefix/agreement chapter.

3.1.6 Relation to TAM and directionals

Stem alternation frequently co-occurs with TAM and directional morphology, but those systems are not reduced to stem choice. In Genesis 2:17, *na ne* and *na nek ni-in* show stem contrast alongside irrealis *ding* 'prospective / irrealis' in the same verse. The alternation is not explained by *-ding* 'prospective / irrealis' alone; it is tied to clause environment.

Directional and stacked verbal material show the same caution. Forms such as *sawlkhiat* occur in broader verbal complexes where directionality and derivation are also active. This section treats only the stem-shape evidence and leaves full TAM and directional analysis to their dedicated chapters.

3.1.7 Formal examples

The examples below illustrate secure contrasts first, then a caveated extension with Gospel support.

(3.80) *Pasian ìn túa khuavak hòih hì, cí-ìn à mú hì.*
God ERG DIST light good DECL say-QUOT 3SG see.I DECL
'God saw the light, that it was good.' (Genesis 1:4)

(3.81) *Lot ìn àmaute à mùh ciang-ìn, àmaute à dawn dìng-ìn dìng à.*
LOT ERG 3PL.PRO 3SG see.II then-ERG 3PL.PRO 3SG top IRR-ERG IRR 3SG
'When Lot saw them, he rose to meet them.' (Genesis 19:1)

(3.82) *Àhìh hàng-ìn à phà lè à sía thèih-ná sing-kung gah pèn nà*
be.3SG.REL because-ERG 3SG branch and 3SG evil know.II-NMLZ tree branch TOP 2SG
né kèi dìng hì.
eat NEG IRR DECL
'But you shall not eat of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.' (Genesis 2:17)

(3.83) *Bàng hàng hìam cìh lèh túa nà nèk nì-ìn nà sí dìng hì.*
like reason Q say.NOM and DIST 2SG eat.II day-ERG 2SG die IRR DECL
'For in the day that you eat of it, you will surely die.' (Genesis 2:17)

(3.84) *Tù-ìn Sarai ciing à, tá néi lò hì.*
now-ERG SARAI barren 3SG child have NEG DECL
'Now Sarai was barren; she had no child.' (Genesis 11:30)

(3.85) *David' nèih mì thahatte' mīn-tè.*
DAVID.POSS have-NOM person strong-PL.POSS name-PL
'The names of David's mighty men.' (2 Samuel 23:8)

(3.86) *Nà khuavak lè nà thù-màn hòng sawlkhia ìnlà.*
2SG light and 2SG word-reason 3→1 send.forth and.then
'Send out your light and your truth.' (Psalms 43:3)

(3.87) *Nòtè ìn sum-bawm, ip, lè khedap keng lò-ìn kòng sawlkhiat lái-ìn*
2PL.PRO ERG money-bag cover and shoe only NEG-ERG 1SG→3 send.forth midst-ERG
kī-tāng-sap-ná nà néi ùh hìam?
REFL-force-call-NMLZ 2SG have 2/3PL Q
'When I sent you without purse, bag, or sandals, did you lack anything?' (Luke 22:35)

3.1.8 Dictionary-facing implications

Stem alternants should be represented as paired lexical entries where evidence is controlled, rather than as unrelated headwords. The strongest pairwise dictionary treatment is currently supported for *mu / muh* 'see', *ne / nek* 'eat', and *nei / neih* 'have'. Pairs such as *za / zak*, *pia / piak*, and *nusia / nusiat* can be represented with visible caveats, while constructionally mixed pairs remain flagged until conditioning evidence is stronger.

This keeps lexical representation aligned with grammar evidence: one lexical verb, multiple stem shapes, and explicit notes on where each shape is best supported.

3.1.9 Deferred questions

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- The full verb-stem paradigm is not yet settled across the entire verbal lexicon.
- The historical origin of individual alternation types is not resolved here.
- Tonal alternations are not fully established in the present stem evidence.
- Complete conditioning environments are still uneven across lexical families.

- Interaction with the full TAM inventory remains only partially mapped.
- Interaction with the full directional system remains only partially mapped.
- Full lexical coverage of all reported stem pairs is still under review.

This section therefore treats only controlled stem-shape evidence and its immediate grammatical distribution.

3.2 Verb paradigms

The current verb-paradigm evidence is strongest for finite predicate frames such as *kanei* 'I have', *na si ding hi* '2SG die IRR DECL', and *a en uh hi* '3SG look.at PL DECL', while negation-heavy, TAM-heavy, stem-alternation, and object-prefix rows remain boundary material.

3.2.1 Overview of basic finite verb paradigms in Tedim

This section is a finite-predicate-frame and person-marked-predicate first slice within the broader verb-paradigm domain. It focuses on the safest finite clause anchors and keeps adjacent domains explicit as boundaries.

The strongest starting anchors are *ka nei hi* '1SG-have DECL', *na si ding hi* '2SG die IRR DECL', *a suak hi* '3SG become DECL', and *a en uh hi* '3SG look.at PL DECL'. These support finite-frame analysis without expanding into chapter-scale verbal morphology.

Surface orthography is kept in prose and inventory forms (for example *ka nei hi*), while segmented analysis is kept in segmentation tiers and parse-oriented discussion (for example *ka-nei* '1SG-have').

This section is not a complete verbal paradigm system, not a full TAM chapter, not a full negation chapter, not a full stem-alternation chapter, not a full agreement chapter, not a full object-prefix chapter, not a full transitivity chapter, and not a full voice chapter.

3.2.2 Basic finite paradigm inventory

Category	Anchor forms	Current status	Why kept narrow
finite-frame anchors	*ka nei hi*, *a en uh hi*	promoted core	clearest clause-level finite frames
person-marking anchors	*na si ding hi*, *a suak hi*, *ka nei kei hi*	promoted core	safest person-marked finite predicates
supporting paradigm rows	*nei / neih*	supporting	useful lexeme-family support, but not a full stem table
negation boundary material	*ta nei lo hi*	boundary	belongs mainly with negation analysis
TAM boundary material	*lutthei ding uh hi*	boundary	belongs mainly with TAM/modal stacking analysis
stem-alternation boundary material	*mu / muh*	boundary	belongs mainly with Form I/Form II analysis
object-prefix boundary material	*hong bia*, *kong koih*	boundary	belongs mainly with participant-prefix analysis
analyzer-gap or blocked material	*i pai*; `-pah / -pak / -lawh`; report-table *ka pai* artifacts	blocked or deferred	not yet safe for finite-paradigm claims

3.2.3 Safest finite predicate frame

The most stable frame in this first slice is a person-marked predicate followed by clause-final *hi* in declarative contexts. In this section, *hi* is treated as a clause-final element in selected finite frames, not as an independent account of the full sentence-final system.

(3.88) *Àhì zòng-ìn à teek khit-ìn àmàh tàwh tá-pà khàt kà néi hì.*
be.3SG although-ERG 3SG master COMPL-ERG 3SG.PRO COM child-male one 1SG have DECL
'Yet when she was old, I have a son by him.' (Genesis 21:7)

Matthew 27:36 provides the Gospel comparandum for the same finite frame.

(3.89) *Jesuh à ēn ùh hì.*
JESUH 3SG look 2/3PL DECL
'They watched Jesus.' (Matthew 27:36)

Together these rows show a finite frame that is useful for grammar-facing description even before a full paradigm grid is attempted.

3.2.4 Safest person-marked finite predicates

The clearest person-marked finite examples currently available show second-, third-, and first-person subject-marking patterns in controlled clauses.

(3.90) *Bàng hàng hìam cìh lèh túa nà nèk nì-ìn nà sí dìng hì.*
like reason Q say.NOM and DIST 2SG eat.II day-ERG 2SG die IRR DECL
'For in the day that you eat of it, you will surely die.' (Genesis 2:17)

Genesis 26:13 adds a third-person finite predicate row.

(3.91) *à hau màhmàh khàt à sùak hì.*
3SG rich very one 3SG wither DECL
'He became very rich.' (Genesis 26:13)

John 4:17 supplies the Gospel first-person row.

(3.92) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:vp-person-john4: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Nu-méi ìn, pasal kà néi kèi hì" à cí hì.
woman ERG husband 1SG have NEG DECL 3SG say DECL

'The woman said, "I have no husband."' (John 4:17)

These rows are enough for a narrow person-marked finite-predicate claim, while still leaving larger person-prefix architecture to dedicated sections.

3.2.5 A small set of paradigm-friendly verb anchors

For this first slice, the safest lexical anchors are *nei* 'have' and *suak* 'become', with *en* 'look at' as supporting finite-frame evidence. This keeps the section finite-frame oriented instead of trying to normalize every verb class at once.

3.2.6 Boundary with negation and TAM

Finite-frame evidence intersects negation and TAM quickly. Rows such as *ta nei lo hi* and *lutthei ding uh hi* remain visible, but they are treated as boundary material here so the established negation and TAM sections remain authoritative for those analyses. The promoted rows *na si ding hi* and *ka nei kei hi* are kept because their finite-frame and person-marking value is clear, while TAM/negation interpretation remains boundary-routed.

3.2.7 Boundary with stem alternation

The *mu / muh* 'see' family remains a key boundary. It is important for paradigms, but the Form I/Form II distribution and caveats are handled in the dedicated stem-alternation section.

3.2.8 Boundary with object-prefix / inverse-like material

Participant-oriented object-prefix material remains outside the core finite table in this section. The person-sensitive prefix contrasts are already treated in the dedicated hong/kong section and stay boundary-controlled here.

3.2.9 Boundary with analyzer-gap and report-table-only material

Analyzer-gap material and report-table-only artifacts remain blocked or deferred in this first slice. Inclusive report paradigms (*i pai*) and artifact-prone rows such as report-table *ka pai* (*kap-ai* segmentation) are kept visible as limits rather than promoted as settled grammar facts.

Clause-final *hi* alignment is likewise kept narrow here: this section uses *hi* only for the selected finite frames above, while broader treatment remains in the sentence-final particles section and in TAM/negation overlap discussions.

3.2.10 Deferred material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- Full person-prefix paradigms, including clusivity and plural routing, remain for dedicated sections.
- Full TAM and modal stacking remains outside this finite-frame slice.
- Full negation architecture remains outside this finite-frame slice.
- Full stem alternation, voice-like behavior, and object-prefix selection remain outside this finite-frame slice.
- Raw report counts or report-table templates are not used as grammar facts by themselves.

3.2.11 Summary

The strongest defensible claim remains modest: Tedim has stable finite predicate frames and a small set of clear person-marked finite anchors that can already be described in grammar-facing prose. This section is therefore a finite-predicate-frame/person-marked first slice, and it keeps TAM, negation, stem alternation, object-prefix, and analyzer-gap issues explicit as boundaries rather than treating them as solved paradigm coverage.

3.3 Prefix / agreement

The current prefix-routing evidence is strongest for host-sensitive contrast between *kanei* 'I have' and *kainn* 'my house', where *ka-nei* '1SG-have' patterns as verbal agreement and *ka-inn* '1SG.POSS-house' patterns as nominal possession, while *hongmu* 'see me / come-see' and *kongmu* 'I see you / 1SG-see.2' remain boundary material.

3.3.1 Overview of prefixal person marking

Tedim has prefixal person-marking material that attaches to different kinds of hosts, and the same prefix morpheme behaves differently depending on the host. This section treats one carefully controlled routing contrast: the prefix *ka-* 'first-person prefix' appears before verbal hosts as agreement (as in *ka-nei* '1SG-have') and before nominal hosts as possession (as in *ka-inn* '1SG.POSS-house'). This controlled anchor does not pretend to solve the full person-prefix paradigm. It documents what the evidence shows about how prefixal material is routed by host type, and where that evidence meets boundary domains that are handled elsewhere (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

3.3.2 Prefix inventory and routing

Form or pattern	Function	Host type	Evidence level	Notes
ka-nei / *kanei*	first-person agreement prefix	verbal host	core	clearest verbal-agreement anchor; *ka-* 'first-person' + *nei* 'have'
ka-inn / *kainn*	first-person possessive prefix	nominal host	core	clearest nominal-possession anchor; *ka-* 'first-person' + *inn* 'house'
a-inn / *ainn*	third-person possessive prefix	nominal host	core with caveat	part of wider *a-* family; shared with verbal and relative-clause contexts
a- family	third-person marking	mixed hosts	boundary	verbal agreement, nominal possession, and relative-clause material overlap here
hong- / *kongmu*	participant-oriented marking	verbal host	boundary	participant-oriented venitive or inverse-like behavior; selection conditions unsettled
ki-	reflexive or middle-like marking	verbal host	boundary	belongs with reflexive/middle analysis and valency; distinct from ordinary agreement
i- series	inclusive/exclusive-like marking	mixed	boundary	belongs with pronoun/clusivity section rather than prefix routing
apostrophe possession markers	NP-final possessive marking	nominal host	boundary	belongs with broader possession and possessor-syntax sections

3.3.3 Agreement before verbal hosts

Before a verb, prefixal material marks agreement with the subject. The clearest anchor is *ka-nei* 'I have' (segmented as *ka-* '1SG' + *nei* 'have', yielding '1SG-have'), where the first-person prefix combines with the verbal root. This gives a regular segmentation where the prefix is distinct from the verbal host.

(3.93)

Àhì	*zòng-ìn*	*à*	*teek*	*khit-ìn*	*àmàh*	*tàwh*	*tá-pà*	*khàt*	*kà*	*néi*	*hì.*
be.3SG	although-ERG	3SG	master	COMPL-ERG	3SG.PRO	COM	child-male	one	1SG	have	DECL

'Yet when she was old, I have a son by him.' (Genesis 21:7)

The form *kanei* 'I have' (without internal segmentation) appears commonly in the Bible. The analysis rests on the verbal host, not on the prefix alone. A Gospel example appears in John 4:17.

(3.94) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:pref-kanei-john4: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Nu-méi	*ìn,*	*pasal*	*kà*	*néi*	*kèi*	*hì"*	*à*	*cí*	*hì.*
woman	ERG	husband	1SG	have	NEG	DECL	3SG	say	DECL

'The woman said, "I have no husband."' (John 4:17)

3.3.4 Possession before nominal hosts

Before a noun, prefixal material marks possession. The clearest anchor is *ka-inn* 'my house' (segmented as *ka-* '1SG.POSS' + *inn* 'house', yielding '1SG.POSS-house'), where the first-person prefix combines with the noun. This gives a regular segmentation for possessive routing.

(3.95)

Tá	*nong*	*pía*	*kèi*	*à,*	*kà*	*ínn*	*sùng-à*	*à*	*sùak*	*sila*	*ìn*	*kèima*	*gàmh*	*à*
child	2→1	give	NEG	3SG	1SG	house	inside-3SG	3SG	wither	servant	ERG	1SG.self	land.II	3SG
lùah	*dìng*	*hì*	*tá*	*hì.*										
carry	IRR	DECL	child	DECL										

'You gave me no child, and a male servant from my house will inherit me.' (Genesis 15:3)

The form *kainn* 'my house' (without internal segmentation) is common in the Bible, and this section treats it as evidence for possessive routing before nominal hosts. A Gospel example appears in Luke 7:6.

(3.96)

Topa	*àw,*	*kà*	*ínn-àh*	*nong*	*pái*	*nàdìngìn*	*kèi*	*kī-lawm*	*zò*	*lò*	*kà*	*híh*
Lord	voice	1SG	house-LOC	2→1	go	PURP.ERG	NEG	REFL-worthy	south	NEG	1SG	PROX
màn-ìn	*hòng*	*pái*	*dah*	*hoh*	*ìn.*							
reason-ERG	3→1	go	put	today	ERG							

'Lord, I am not worthy for you to come under my roof.' (Luke 7:6)

3.3.5 Agreement versus possession routing

The same first-person prefix material shows host-sensitive routing: *ka-* appears as agreement before the verb *nei*, but as possession before the noun *inn*. This controlled contrast anchors the present account. It does not settle whether the full person-prefix paradigm is now complete, and it does not pretend to provide a full possessive or agreement chapter.

3.3.6 The a- family and third-person marking

Third-person material uses the prefix *a-* 'third-person prefix', but the *a-* family remains boundary material because it overlaps multiple domains. The form *a-inn* and the combined form *ainn* 'his/her house' show third-person possession before a noun, paralleling *ka-inn* 'my house' for first person. However, the same prefix *a-* also appears in verbal-agreement contexts and in relative-clause material, as shown below.

The form *a bawl mi* 'one who made' (person who made) demonstrates the *a-* family's use in relative-clause structure. Clause-linking material such as *ahih* 'it is / which is' shows the same prefix family appearing in non-agreement roles. Here *a* heads a relative phrase, and the same morpheme appears in both agreement and relative slots.

(3.97)

Túa	*tàwh*	*à*	*kibang-ìn*	*pāk-nam-tui*	*à*	*bāwl*	*mì*	*peuhmah*	*àmà*
DIST	COM	3SG	be.alike-CVB	ointment	3SG	make	person	whosoever	3SG.POSS
mite'	*kìang*	*pàn-ìn*	*kī-khen-khìa*	*dìng*	*hì.*				
person-PL.POSS	beside	ABL-ERG	REFL-divide-AWAY	IRR	DECL				

'Whoever makes perfume like it shall be cut off from his people.' (Exodus 30:38)

Matthew 13:41 provides another Gospel context with the same *a bawl mi* material.

(3.98) *Mì-hìng Tá-pà ìn à vàn-tùng mì-tè hòng sawl dìng à, àmà ukna*
person-kind child-male ERG 3SG sky-on person-PL 3→1 send IRR 3SG 3SG.POSS rule.NMLZ
sùng-àh à ōm migilo-tè lè mì à màwh nàdìngìn à bāwl mì khèmpeuh
inside-LOC 3SG exist enemy-PL and person 3SG sin PURP.ERG 3SG make person all
kai-khàwm-ìn.
gather-together-ERG

‘The Son of Man will send his angels, and they will gather all who cause sin.’ (Matthew 13:41)

Because the *a-* family has uses in verbal agreement, nominal possession, and relative-clause material, this section keeps *a-* material marked as boundary. The present evidence does not yet settle a single finished account of the *a-* family.

3.3.7 Relation to pronouns

The newly normalized pronoun section treats independent pronouns such as *kei* ‘I/me’, *nang* ‘you.SG’, *amah* ‘he/she/it’, *note* ‘you.PL’, and *amaute* ‘they’ as free-standing forms. Prefixal person marking is treated here, not in the pronoun section. The two domains remain distinct: independent pronouns are full noun-phrase heads, while prefixes attach to hosts. Clusivity forms such as *eite* ‘we (incl.)’, *kote* ‘we (excl.)’, and *i-* ‘first-person plural possessive’ series material (including forms like *ipai* ‘we go / inclusive go’) are not widened into this prefix-routing section; they remain with the pronoun/clusivity analysis where the evidence is controlled.

3.3.8 Participant-oriented hong- and kong- boundary

The prefixes *hong-* ‘participant-oriented venitive-like’ and *kong-* ‘participant-oriented directive-like’ are part of the same prefixal domain, but their exact selection conditions remain unsettled. Forms like *hongmu* ‘SAP-oriented see / venitive support’ and *kongmu* ‘I see you (1→2)’ appear to mark participant-oriented, venitive-like, or inverse-like behavior, but this section keeps them as boundary material rather than claiming a complete object-prefix or inverse account.

(3.99) *Kèimah ìn nòtè’ híh khèmpeuh kòng mú khín hì, Topa ìn kòng cí*
1SG.PRO ERG 2PL.PRO.POSS PROX all 1SG→3 see.I IMM DECL Lord ERG 1SG→3 say
hì.
DECL

‘I have seen all these things, says the Lord.’ (Jeremiah 7:11)

A Gospel example appears in Matthew 25:37 with *hong-* in a similar participant-oriented context.

(3.100) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:pref-hongmu-matt25: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Topa àw, cí-kin nà gil-kial hòng mú-ìn àn hòng pía kà hì ùh hìam?
Lord voice say-half 2SG bowels 3→1 see-ERG 3PL.POSS 3→1 give 1SG DECL 2/3PL Q

‘Lord, when did we see you hungry and give you food?’ (Matthew 25:37)

The contrast between *kong-mu* ‘I see you’ and *hong-mu* ‘you (sg) see me (speaker-as-participant)’ is visible, but the full hong-/kong- system remains outside the present scope.

3.3.9 Reflexive and middle ki- boundary

The prefix *ki-* ‘reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like’ is kept separate from ordinary person-marking agreement. It behaves like a prefix, but it marks valency change or reflexive/reciprocal relations rather than simple subject agreement. This section treats *ki-* as boundary material that overlaps with derivational and clause-structure analysis rather than as a regular person prefix. The form *kipan* 'from / begin (reflexive)' is a representative example of this boundary domain.

(3.101) *Túa hùn à ki-pan-ìn mì-tè ìn Topa bía-ìn à mīn làwh dìng kī-pan*
DIST time 3SG from person-PL ERG Lord worship-ERG 3SG name PERF IRR REFL-begin
tá ùh hì.
child 2/3PL DECL
'From that time people began to call on the name of the Lord.' (Genesis 4:26)

A Gospel example appears in Matthew 4:17 with the same *ki-pan* material.

(3.102) *Túa hùn à kī-pan Jesuh ìn thù-hìlh dìng kī-pan à.*
DIST time 3SG REFL-begin JESUH ERG word-teach IRR REFL-begin 3SG
'From that time Jesus began to preach.' (Matthew 4:17)

The reflexive/middle behavior of *ki-* is evident, but a full reflexive/middle account belongs with derivation/valency and clause-structure analysis rather than with person-prefix agreement here.

3.3.10 Apostrophe possession and broader possession syntax

Possessive noun phrases with apostrophe-like markers such as *Topa' inn* 'the Lord's house' (literally 'Lord apostrophe house') are treated as boundary material. This section does not reopen the full possession or possessor-syntax analysis; that belongs to the dedicated NP structure/possession section. The present scope is limited to showing how the first-person prefix *ka-* marks possession before nominal hosts. ### Deferred questions

Several areas remain outside this section's scope.

- The full person-prefix paradigm is not settled by the single controlled *ka-* anchor. Other person and number prefixes remain to be analyzed.
- The *a-* family has uses across agreement, possession, and relative-clause domains that do not yet reduce to a single finished account.
- Inclusive/exclusive material such as *i-* 'first-person plural possessive', *eite*, and *kote* belongs to the completed pronoun/clusivity section rather than to prefix routing.
- Object-prefix and inverse-like selection conditions for *hong-* and *kong-* remain unsettled.
- Reflexive and middle functions of *ki-* are analyzed separately under derivation/valency and clause structure.
- Apostrophe possession, broader possessor syntax, and full NP-internal possession structure are treated in the NP structure/possession section.
- Raw occurrence counts are not treated as grammar facts without constructional control.

The safest conclusion is a host-sensitive routing contrast: prefixal material marked with first person appears as agreement *ka-nei* before verbal hosts and as possession *ka-inn* before nominal hosts. Boundary forms such as *ainn*, *a bawl mi*, *ahih*, *hong-*, *kong-*, *ki-*, and apostrophe possession remain explicit so the section maintains constructional control and avoids premature widening into unfinished domains.

3.4 Hong / kong object-prefix or inverse-like

The current *hong* 'come / venitive' and *kong* '1→2 / direct-like' evidence is strongest for a narrow participant-oriented prefix contrast: *hongbia* 'worship me' and *kongpia* 'give to you' are the cleanest paired Gospel rows, *kongkoih* 'place you' adds an OT anchor, and *hongmu* 'see me' / *kongmu* 'I see you' remain supportive but not diagnostic.

3.4.1 Overview of hong and kong object-prefix or inverse-like marking

hong 'come / venitive' remains mixed: some rows look inverse-like, while others are clearly deictic, motion, or formulaic. *kong* '1→2 / direct-like' is the cleaner side of the contrast. The section keeps the clearest rows separate from deictic motion, speech-formula rows, and lexicalized or unclear material.

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is narrow: Tedim has a small participant-oriented prefix domain, but this is not a full agreement chapter and not a full inverse-system chapter. The core comparison comes from a paired Gospel row, supported by a second OT *kong* anchor and by cautious *hongmu* 'SAP-oriented see' / *kongmu* 'I see you' support rows.

3.4.2 Current hong and kong inventory

Form	Proposed parse	Source	Current grammar-facing status	Diagnostic status	Boundary issue
hongbia	*hong-bia*	Matthew 4:9	promoted core	object-prefix_diagnostic	clearest hong-side row
kongpia	*kong-pia*	Matthew 4:9	promoted core	object-prefix_diagnostic	clearest kong-side row
kongkoih	*kong-koih*	Genesis 41:41	promoted core	object-prefix_diagnostic	OT kong anchor
hongmu	*hong-mu*	Matthew 25:37	supporting	compatible_not_diagnostic	useful but mixed
kongmu	*kong-mu*	Jeremiah 7:11	supporting	compatible_not_diagnostic	speech-formula overlap nearby
hongzui	*hong-zui*	Matthew 8:22	supporting	compatible_not_diagnostic	imperative / directive support
hongsawl	*hong-sawl*	Matthew 13:41	boundary material	deictic_venitive_boundary	sending / deictic overlap
hongpai	*hong-pai*	Exodus 1:1	boundary material	deictic_venitive_boundary	motion / venitive
hongbei	*hong-bei*	Genesis 1:5	boundary material	deictic_venitive_boundary	temporal motion
hongsuahna	*hong-suah-na*	Matthew 1:18	boundary material	lexicalized_or_unclear	nominalized / formulaic
kongci	*kong-ci*	Jeremiah 7:11	boundary material	lexicalized_or_unclear	speech formula
konggenkik	*kong-gen-kik*	Matthew 2:13	boundary material	lexicalized_or_unclear	speech sequencing
hong-an-huan-sak	*hong-an huan-sak*	Otsuka 2009:23	blocked	blocked	analyzer-gap row
kong-bawl-sak	*kong-bawl-sak*	Otsuka 2009:30	blocked	blocked	analyzer-gap row

3.4.3 Safest hong and kong rows

(3.103)

Kà	*mái-àh*	*kun-ìn*	*kèi*	*hòng*	*bía*	*lecin*	*híh-tè*	*khèmpeuh*	*nàngmà*	*tùngàh*
1SG	face-LOC	bow-ERG	NEG	3→1	worship	offend	PROX-PL	all	2SG.self	on-LOC

kòng	*pía*	*dìng*	*hì,*	*à*	*cí*	*hì.*
1SG→3	give	IRR	DECL	3SG	say	DECL

'If you worship me, I will give you all these things.' (Matthew 4:9)

The cleanest paired Gospel comparison is *hongbia* 'worship me' versus *kongpia* 'give to you' in Matthew 4:9. That same verse makes the contrast visible in one clause: *hongbia* is the clearest hong-side diagnostic, and *kongpia* is the clearest kong-side diagnostic.

Genesis 41:41 adds *kongkoih* 'place you' as a second OT anchor.

(3.104) *Egypt gàm khèmpeuh à ùk dìng-ìn nàng kòng kòih khin-zò hì.*
EGYPT land all 3SG rule IRR-ERG 2SG.PRO 1SG→3 put COMPL-COMPL DECL
'I have placed you over all the land of Egypt.' (Genesis 41:41)

Together, these rows are enough to support a narrow participant-oriented prefix pocket without claiming a full system.

3.4.4 Support but not diagnostic rows

The familiar *hongmu* 'see you (SAP-oriented)' and *kongmu* 'I see you' rows remain useful but not decisive. They show that participant orientation is real, but they do not by themselves settle whether every *hong* token is object-prefixal rather than venitive/deictic.

Matthew 25:37 support row

(3.105) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:hk-support-matt25: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Topa àw, cí-kin nà gil-kial hòng mú-ìn àn hòng pía kà hì ùh hìam?
Lord voice say-half 2SG bowels 3→1 see-ERG 3PL.POSS 3→1 give 1SG DECL 2/3PL Q

'Lord, when did we see you hungry and give you food?' (Matthew 25:37)

In this quoted clause, the speaker group is first-person plural and the addressee is second person. The clause-level participant configuration is therefore 1PL→2SG, but the two *hong* tokens are better treated here as SAP-oriented/venitive support rather than as clean person-prefix diagnostics. Both tokens are glossed the same way.

Jeremiah 7:11 support row

(3.106) *Kèimah ìn nòtè' híh khèmpeuh kòng mú khín hì, Topa ìn kòng cí hì.*
1SG.PRO ERG 2PL.PRO.POSS PROX all 1SG→3 see.I IMM DECL Lord ERG 1SG→3 say DECL
'I have seen all these things, says the Lord.' (Jeremiah 7:11)

Matthew 8:22 (*Nangmah in kei hong zui in*) remains a useful supporting row for inverse-like *hong* with explicit *nangmah* and *kei*, but imperative venitive overlap keeps it below the promoted diagnostic tier.

3.4.5 Boundary with deictic / venitive hong

Motion-heavy rows such as *hongpai* and *hongbei* stay boundary material and should not be promoted as object-prefix diagnostics. Overlap rows such as *hongsawl* also remain on this boundary side.

3.4.6 Boundary with lexicalized or unclear rows

Formulaic, nominalized, and speech-formula rows stay boundary-controlled rather than being promoted as object-prefix diagnostics.

3.4.7 Boundary with transitivity, valency, and pronoun/agreement overlap

Rows that mainly expose clause type, verb class, or person-marking overlap stay boundary-controlled. This slice does not widen into a full agreement chapter or a full inverse chapter.

3.4.8 Deferred material

The literature-backed inverse claims remain visible in the background sources, but this slice keeps the domain narrow and leaves the broader system for later review.

3.4.9 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim has a narrow participant-oriented prefix pocket. *hong* remains mixed between venitive/deictic and inverse-like uses, while *kong* is the cleaner direct-like / 1→2 side. Keep the paired diagnostics (*hongbia*, *kongpia*) and the OT *kongkoih* anchor central, treat *hongmu*, *kongmu*, and *hongzui* as supporting, and leave deictic, lexicalized, and speech-formula rows boundary-only.

Raw report counts do not decide the analysis.

3.5 Transitivity

The current transitivity evidence is strongest for simple intransitive anchors such as *sih* 'die' and *suak* 'become', and for transitive anchors such as *hawl* 'seek / steer' and *en* 'look at / see', while stem families, derivational predicates, and case- or prefix-heavy rows remain boundary material.

3.5.1 Overview of transitivity contrasts

This section treats a controlled part of Tedim transitivity: simple intransitive and transitive predicate anchors plus selected boundary material. The clearest present anchors are *sih* 'die', *suak* 'become', *hawl* 'seek / steer', and *en* 'look at / see', while stem families such as *mu / muh* 'see', derivation-heavy forms such as *piangsak* 'cause to be born / create', and case- or prefix-heavy rows remain explicit boundaries.

That is enough for a narrow grammar-facing claim. It does not yet establish a full verb-class inventory or a complete argument-structure chapter.

3.5.2 Current transitivity inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
sih	simple intransitive predicate	*Haran si hi*, *a numei zong a si hi*	supported	cleanest death-predicate anchor
suak	change-of-state intransitive predicate	*a hau mahmah khat a suak hi*, *tua gam a sia suak ding hi*	supported with caution	broader lexical range remains open
hawl	transitive predicate with a direct object	*a leeng a hawl uh hi*	supported with caution	printable example range is narrower than the report gloss
en	perception verb with a transitive profile	*a bawlsate khempeuh en a*, *Jesuh a en uh hi*	supported	clearer OT/Gospel support than *hawl*
mu / muh	perception family at the stem-alternation boundary	*Topa' maipha mu hi*, *aksi a muh uh ciangin*	boundary material	overlaps Form I / Form II alternation
za / zak, *nei / neih*, *ngai / ngaih*	stem-family or labile-looking material	report-level verb-family rows	boundary material	belongs with stem alternation and labile behavior
piangsak, *pia(k)sak*	derivation-heavy transitivity	*piangsak*, *pia(k)sak*	boundary material	overlaps derivation / valency
pia, *gen*, *tom*	argument-structure-sensitive predicates	ditransitive or comitative rows	boundary material	depends strongly on case and complement structure

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
hong, *ki-*	prefix-heavy or voice-like material	intransitive and prefixal report rows	boundary material	overlaps prefix/agreement and voice-like analysis

The table keeps the first contrast compact. A grammar-facing section should show the clearest predicate types now, while leaving the larger problems of stem alternation, derivation, case, and prefixal structure visible as boundaries rather than flattening them into one verb-class system.

3.5.3 Intransitive predicates

The cleanest intransitive anchor is *sih* 'die'. It supports a simple one-participant predicate without immediately forcing broader case, derivational, or prefixal analysis into the section. *Suak* 'become' adds a second intransitive line and shows that the section is not limited to death predicates alone.

(3.107) *Haran sí hì*
HARAN die DECL
'Haran died' (Genesis 11:28)

(3.108) *à nu-méi zòng à sí hì*
3SG woman also 3SG die DECL
'the woman also died' (Matthew 22:27)

(3.109) *à hau màhmàh khàt à sùak hì*
3SG rich very one 3SG wither DECL
'he became very rich' (Genesis 26:13)

(3.110) *túa gàm à sía sùak dìng hì*
DIST land 3SG evil wither IRR DECL
'that kingdom will become ruined' (Matthew 12:25)

These examples support a narrow intransitive side: *sih* gives a plain intransitive event predicate, while *suak* gives a change-of-state predicate. They do not by themselves define the whole intransitive inventory, but they are strong enough for a controlled first contrast.

3.5.4 Transitive predicates

The transitive side stays equally narrow. Among the report-backed simple rows, *hawl* 'seek / steer' remains the least theory-heavy anchor, but its currently printable evidence is not as balanced as the rest of the section. *En* 'look at / see' therefore serves as the clearer supporting transitive row with matched Old Testament and Gospel examples.

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this exact *hawl* row, so the section keeps a single Old Testament example here and lets *en* 'look at / see' carry the balanced transitive support.

(3.111) *Uzza lè Ahio ìn à leeng à hawl ùh hì*
UZZA and AHIO ERG 3SG chariot 3SG seek 2/3PL DECL
'Uzza and Ahio drove the cart' (1 Chronicles 13:7)

(3.112) *Pasian ìn à bāwl-sá-tè khèmpeuh ēn à*
God ERG 3SG make-flesh-PL all look 3SG
'God looked at all that he had made' (Genesis 1:31)

(3.113) *Jesuh à ēn ùh hì*
JESUH 3SG look 2/3PL DECL
'they watched Jesus' (Matthew 27:36)

Taken together, these rows support a practical transitive side without claiming that all Tedim transitives behave alike. *Hawl* remains useful because it keeps a simple object-taking predicate in view, while *en* supplies the better balanced formal support.

3.5.5 The narrow intransitive / transitive contrast

The practical contrast is therefore modest. *Sih* 'die' and *suak* 'become' support the intransitive side, while *hawl* 'seek / steer' and *en* 'look at / see' support the transitive side.

That is enough for a first grammar-facing contrast, but it is not yet a complete verb-class system. The section distinguishes a small set of stable anchors rather than claiming that every Tedim predicate can already be assigned to a single settled transitivity class.

3.5.6 Boundary with stem alternation and labile behavior

The clearest boundary beyond the core anchors is *mu / muh* 'see'. This family matters because it shows that transitivity quickly meets the Form I / Form II system, and it therefore cannot be treated as ordinary class evidence without reopening the stem-alternation chapter. The same caution applies to *za / zak* 'hear / listen', *nei / neih* 'have', and *ngai / ngaih* 'need / love / listen'.

(3.114) *Noah ìn Topa' mái-phà mú hì*
NOAH ERG Lord.POSS face-good see.I DECL
'Noah found favor with the Lord' (Genesis 6:8)

(3.115) *Túa aksi à mùh ùh cìang-ìn*
DIST star 3SG see.II 2/3PL then-ERG
'when they saw the star' (Matthew 2:10)

This pair is useful precisely because it stops short of a class claim. It shows why transitivity and stem alternation must be discussed together at the boundary, while still leaving the larger alternation system outside the present section.

3.5.7 Boundary with derivation / valency

The derivational boundary is represented most clearly by *piangsak* 'cause to be born / create' and *pia(k)sak* 'give-CAUS / cause to give'. These forms are important, but they are poor core anchors for a first transitivity section because their argument profile cannot be separated cleanly from the causative and valency-changing uses of *-sak* 'causative / benefactive'.

That is why the present section keeps them visible only as adjacent evidence. They belong to transitivity, but they belong just as directly to the derivation / valency domain.

3.5.8 Boundary with case marking and argument structure

Predicates such as *pia* 'give', *gen* 'say', and *tom* 'meet / accompany' are likewise better treated as boundary material than as first-line transitivity anchors. Their interpretation depends heavily on recipient, complement, or comitative structure, so they quickly become questions about case marking and broader argument structure rather than about a simple intransitive/transitive contrast.

For the same reason, this section does not try to turn ditransitive and complement-taking predicates into a full argument-structure chapter. It keeps them visible, but not central.

3.5.9 Boundary with prefix/agreement and voice-like material

Some report rows also overlap with prefixal analysis. *Hong* 'come / venitive' remains mixed between lexical motion and prefix-heavy verbal structure, while *ki-* 'reflexive / middle / passive-like' belongs with the broader voice-like boundary rather than with a simple predicate-class list.

The section therefore leaves prefix/agreement-heavy material to its own domain. A narrow transitivity section should not absorb pronominal routing, venitive morphology, or reflexive and middle-like structure just because those issues touch verbal argument patterns.

3.5.10 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *hawl* 'seek / steer' remains useful, but the currently printable *hawl* evidence is not as Gospel-balanced as the rest of the section.
- *mu / muh* 'see', *za / zak* 'hear / listen', *nei / neih* 'have', and *ngai / ngaih* 'need / love / listen' remain stem-family and labile boundary material rather than core anchors.
- *piangsak* 'cause to be born / create' and *pia(k)sak* 'give-CAUS / cause to give' remain derivation-heavy predicates.
- *pia* 'give', *gen* 'say', and *tom* 'meet / accompany' remain dominated by case and complement structure.
- *hong* 'come / venitive' and *ki-* 'reflexive / middle / passive-like' remain prefix-heavy or voice-like boundary material.
- The section therefore stays smaller than a full verb-class chapter or a full argument-structure account.

3.5.11 Summary

The safest current conclusion is that Tedim supports a narrow intransitive / transitive contrast that can already be stated in grammar-facing prose. *Sih* 'die' and *suak* 'become' anchor the intransitive side, while *hawl* 'seek / steer' and *en* 'look at / see' anchor the transitive side. At the same time, stem alternation, derivation / valency, case-sensitive predicates, and prefix-heavy material remain visible as boundaries, so the section stays controlled rather than expanding into a full verb-class chapter.

3.6 VP structure / suffix stacking

The current VP-structure evidence is strongest for a small checked set of suffix stacks such as *bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR', directional-plus-irrealis sequences, modal-plus-irrealis strings, and derivational stacks whose ordering can be discussed without forcing a full verb-template chapter.

3.6.1 Overview of VP structure and suffix stacking

The safest current claim is that Tedim allows a small but real set of multi-suffix verbal complexes and clause-internal stacking patterns, without requiring a full verb-template chapter. The clearest checked anchors are *bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR', attested *taisakzo ding* 'put to flight / flee-CAUS-COMPL-IRR', directional material such as *a kilaktoh ding hun* 'the time for him to be taken up', modal strings such as *khiathei ding om lo* 'there is no one who can interpret it', and derivational stacks such as *ciahsakkik* 'send back' and *paikhiatsak* 'cause to go out'.

This section therefore keeps its descriptive scope controlled. It describes the clearest stack types that can already be stated in grammar-facing prose, while keeping the boundaries with TAM, directionals, negation, derivation, and clause linkage explicit.

3.6.2 Current VP stacking inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
bawlzoding	completive plus irrealis after a verbal stem	*bawlzoding*	supported with caveat	analyzer gloss remains noisier than the ordering evidence
V-*zo ding*	aspect before irrealis	*taisakzo ding*	supported with caveat	derivational material often enters the same string
DIR + *ding*	directional material before irrealis in a larger verbal complex	*a kilaktoh ding hun*	supported with caveat	quickly overlaps clause structure
khia-ta	directional plus completive boundary	*khia-ta*	boundary material	TAM and directional analysis remain intertwined
khiathei ding om lo	ability plus irrealis plus negation	*mang a khiathei ka hi kei hi*, *lutthei ding uh hi*	supported with caveat	already reaches clause-sized modal-negation material
ciahsakkik	causative plus iterative or return morphology	*hong ciahsakkik un*, *a guak ciahsakkik uh hi*	supported with caveat	derivational *-sak* remains central
paikhiatsak	directional plus causative morphology	*hong paikhiatsak ciangin*	boundary material	sits between directionals and derivation
dingin	clause-bound irrealis or purposive linker	*a khen dingin*, *maksim dingin*	boundary material	better treated with clause linkage than with a compact VP inventory

The table keeps *khia-ta* 'out-PFV' and *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' visible as boundary rows rather than as core stacking anchors. That matters because a grammar-facing section should show where VP-structure evidence stops being simple, not only where it begins.

3.6.3 Aspect plus irrealis stacking

Bawlzoding 'make-COMPL-IRR' is the central checked anchor because it keeps the ordering question in view without forcing a full paradigm. The best attested formal Old Testament example for this order is *taisakzo ding* 'put to flight / flee-CAUS-COMPL-IRR', where completive *-zo* 'already / completive' appears before *ding* 'prospective / irrealis'. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this exact construction, so the section keeps the compact Old Testament anchor and lets the later subsections show how the same right-edge order continues into Gospel material.

(3.116) *tái-sakzo* *dìng*
bright-CAUS.COMPL IRR
'put ten thousand to flight' (Deuteronomy 32:30)

This row does not settle every detail of the middle suffixes, and it does not replace the checked *bawlzoding* anchor. It is useful because it shows the same broad order in attested text: verbal stem material, then completive material, then irrealis.

3.6.4 Directional and TAM boundary in the verbal complex

Directional material can stand inside larger verbal complexes, but the present evidence does not collapse directionals and TAM into one solved suffix template. Genesis 20:13 gives *paikhiatsak* 'cause to go out', where *-khia* 'outward' remains visible inside a causative stack. Luke 9:51 gives *a kilaktoh ding hun* 'the time for him to be taken up', where upward *-toh* 'upward' stands before *ding* 'irrealis / prospective'. The boundary clue *khia-ta* 'out-PFV' belongs in the same zone, but it remains safer here as prose evidence than as a core formal anchor.

(3.117)	*hòng*	*pái-khìa-sàk*	*cìang-ìn*
	3→1	go-out-CAUS	then-ERG

'when he caused me to go out' (Genesis 20:13)

(3.118)	*à*	*kī-làk-tòh*	*dìng*	*hùn*
	3SG	REFL-take-UP	IRR	time

'the time for him to be taken up' (Luke 9:51)

These examples are not identical constructions, but together they show why VP structure has to remain boundary-aware: directional morphology can appear inside larger complexes, yet the surrounding ordering is still sensitive to TAM, derivation, and clause structure.

3.6.5 Ability, irrealis, and negation at the VP boundary

Ability material frequently participates in longer strings rather than standing alone. Genesis 41:16 uses *khiathei* 'interpret-ABIL' under negation, while Matthew 7:21 uses *lutthei ding* 'enter-ABIL-IRR' in a projected event. The stronger clause-sized boundary row *khiathei ding om lo* 'there is no one who can interpret it' shows why the section must stop short of a full account of negative modal syntax.

(3.119)	*máng*	*à*	*khìat-thèi*	*kà*	*hì*	*kèi*	*hì*
	dream	3SG	interpret-ABIL	1SG	DECL	NEG	DECL

'I cannot interpret a dream' (Genesis 41:16)

(3.120)	*lút-thèi*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*hì*
	enter-ABIL	IRR	2/3PL	DECL

'they will be able to enter' (Matthew 7:21)

This pair shows a stable local point: *-thei* can be followed by further material such as negation or *-ding*, so ability belongs inside VP-structure discussion. It also shows why the present section should not be widened into a full modal chapter.

3.6.6 Derivational stacking and valency overlap

Derivational stacking is clearly real, but it is not reducible to suffix order alone. *Ciahsakkik* 'send back' provides the cleanest matched pair now available, with an Old Testament row and a Gospel row. The same area also keeps *bawlsakthei* 'make-CAUS-ABIL' and *paikhiatsak* 'go-out-CAUS' visible, which is why derivation and valency remain unavoidable boundaries for the present section.

(3.121)	*hòng*	*ciah-sàk-kík*	*ùn*
	3→1	return-CAUS-ITER	IMP.PL

'send me back' (Genesis 24:54)

(3.122)	*à*	*guak*	*ciah-sàk-kík*	*ùh*	*hì*
	3SG	back	return-CAUS-ITER	2/3PL	DECL

'they sent him back empty' (Mark 12:3)

Because *-sak* is central in both examples, this subsection is best read as a boundary zone between VP structure and derivation / valency. The examples are strong enough to show real stacking, but they do not by themselves justify a full derivational template.

3.6.7 Clause-linking boundary with *dingin*

Dingin 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' is important because it shows how quickly a stacking-looking form becomes clause linkage. Genesis 1:14 uses *a khen dingin* 'for dividing', and Matthew 1:19 uses *maksim dingin* 'to dismiss quietly'. Those rows are helpful because they keep right-edge irrealis material visible, but they are safer as clause-linking evidence than as core VP suffixes.

This is also why the present section does not treat every *ding*-plus-following-material sequence as the same construction. Some rows belong to local VP stacking, while others already belong to purposive or clause-linking structure.

3.6.8 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR' remains the central checked anchor, but its exact internal semantics are still noisier than its ordering value.
- *khia-ta* 'out-PFV' remains a TAM-directional boundary row rather than a core formal example here.
- *khiathei ding om lo* 'there is no one who can interpret it' and related strings reach clause-sized modal-negation structure too quickly.
- *bawlsakthei* 'make-CAUS-ABIL' and *paikhiatsak* 'go-out-CAUS' show why derivational stacks need separate treatment.
- *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' is kept at the clause-linkage boundary rather than inside a full VP template.
- The section does not attempt a full suffix slot template, a full derivation chapter, or a full account of sentence-final material.

3.6.9 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim permits a small but real set of multi-suffix verbal complexes. *Bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR' remains the central checked anchor, while *taisakzo ding*, *lutthei ding*, *ciahsakkik*, and *a kilaktoh ding hun* show how aspect, modality, directionals, and derivation can stack in attested material. At the same time, the boundaries with TAM, directionals, negation, derivation / valency, and clause linkage remain visible, so the section stays controlled rather than turning into a full verbal template chapter.

3.7 TAM / aspect / modal

The current TAM evidence is strongest for a small checked set of aspectual and modal anchors such as *-ta* 'completive / change-of-state', *-zo* 'already / completive', *-gige* 'habitually / always', *-ding* 'prospective / irrealis', *-thei* 'can / be able', and *-kik* 'again / back'.

3.7.1 Overview of TAM / aspect / modal marking

The safest current claim is that Tedim shows a controlled set of aspectual and modal anchors that can already be described in grammar-facing prose, without pretending that the whole verbal paradigm is settled. The present section therefore stays with compact suffixal or particle-like material rather than a full account of clause type, sentence-final particles, negation, or verb-phrase stacking.

The clearest anchors in this section are *-ta* 'completive / change-of-state', *-zo* 'already / completive', *-gige* 'habitually / always', *-zel* 'continuative / keep doing', *-ding* 'prospective / irrealis', *-thei* 'can / be able', *-kik* 'again / back', and *-ngei* 'ever / experiential'. Several wider questions remain visible around these forms, but they are kept explicit as boundaries rather than folded into a single large TAM chapter.

3.7.2 Current TAM inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-ta	completive or change-of-state aspect	*kihta uh hi*, *nungta zaw hi*	supported with caveat	clause-final *ta hi* remains separate
-zo	completive or endpoint reached	*ka bawlzo hi*, *a zuizo uh hi*	supported with caveat	bare *zo* still overlaps sentence-final material
-gige	habitual or regularly repeated action	*en gige hi*, *vil gige uh a*	well supported	orthography may separate the habitual element
-zel	continuative or repeated continuation	*hopih zel hi*	supported with caveat	wider continuative and lexicalized uses remain open
-ngei	experiential or 'ever' aspect	*a paingei bangin*	supporting evidence	many other rows cluster with negation or *nawn*
-ding	prospective or irrealis marking	*na si ding hi*, *kiphuak ding hi*	well supported	clause-bound *dingin* remains separate
-thei	ability or possibility	*khiathei ka hi kei hi*, *lutthei ding uh hi*	supported with caveat	negation and irrealis often stack with it
-kik	repetition or return	*na ciahkik matengin*, *a ciahkik uh hi*	well supported	return and motion readings still need constructional care

The table keeps *-ngei* 'ever / experiential' visible even though its cleanest formal example is narrower than the habitual and irrealis pairs. That matters because a grammar-facing inventory should show both the secure anchors and the places where the evidence is still thinner.

3.7.3 Perfect, completive, and change-of-state material

-ta 'completive / change-of-state' is safest where a result state or completed change remains attached to a compact verbal host. *-zo* 'already / completive' likewise works best inside tight verbal material rather than as a clause-final particle. The section therefore starts from short verbal rows and keeps broader sentence-final issues for a later boundary discussion.

(3.123) *kih-tà* *ùh* *hì*
abhor-PFV 2/3PL DECL
'they were afraid' (Exodus 1:12)

(3.124) *nùng-tà* *zàw* *hì*
life-PFV more DECL
'lives rather' (Matthew 4:4)

(3.125) *kà* *bāwl-zò* *hì*
1SG make-COMPL DECL
'I have made it' (Exodus 34:27)

(3.126) *à* *zúi-zò* *ùh* *hì*
3SG follow-COMPL 2/3PL DECL
'they followed it' (Matthew 7:14)

Taken together, these rows support a modest aspectual claim: Tedim can mark completed or result-state readings in compact verbal material. They do not license every orthographic *ta* or *zo* token as settled TAM evidence, and they do not erase the clause-final boundary that remains visible elsewhere in the grammar.

3.7.4 Habitual, continuative, and experiential aspect

-gige 'habitually / always' is the most even habitual anchor in the current controlled evidence. *-zel* 'continuative / keep doing' is also visible, but its neatest checked row is still Old Testament-led. *-ngei* 'ever / experiential' belongs in the same zone, although the clearest compact formal row at present is the Gospel phrase *paingei* 'go-EXP'.

(3.127) *à* *pái-ngèi* *bàng-ìn*
3SG go-EXP like-ERG
'as was his custom' (Luke 4:16)

(3.128) *ēn* *gìgè* *hì*
look HAB DECL
'keeps watching' (Psalms 33:15)

(3.129) *vil* *gìgè* *ùh* *à*
watch HAB 2/3PL 3SG
'they kept watching' (Luke 20:20)

(3.130) *Topa* *ìn* *Moses* *ho-pìh* *zèl* *hì*
Lord ERG MOSES greet-APPL scatter DECL
'the Lord kept speaking with Moses' (Exodus 33:11)

The paired *-gige* rows show that habitual meaning is not confined to one testament. The *-zel* row is included because it keeps continuative aspect visible inside the same section, while *paingei* shows that experiential *-ngei* is real even though many other *ngei* examples sit closer to negated or "ever again" environments.

3.7.5 Prospective and irrealis marking

-ding 'prospective / irrealis' is productive enough to mark future-like or projected events in ordinary clauses. At the same time, many wider report hits are clause-bound forms such as *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis', so the section starts with simpler predicates and leaves purposive or clause-linking material for the boundary note below.

(3.131) *nà* *sí* *dìng* *hì*
2SG die IRR DECL
'you will die' (Genesis 2:17)

(3.132) *Emmanuel* *kī-phuak* *dìng* *hì*
EMMANUEL REFL-utter IRR DECL
'will be called Emmanuel' (Matthew 1:23)

These examples are enough for a controlled grammar-facing statement that *-ding* marks prospective or irrealis meaning in ordinary verbal or predicate structure. They are not enough to settle the full relation between *-ding*, purpose clauses, and broader clause linkage.

3.7.6 Ability and modal marking

-thei 'can / be able' often appears as a close verb-plus-modal sequence rather than as a fully separate lexical verb. The Gospel data provide the cleanest clause-level positive anchor, while Old Testament rows often show the same modal material under negation or inside quoted discourse.

(3.133) *máng à khìat-thèi kà hì kèi hì*
dream 3SG interpret-ABIL 1SG DECL NEG DECL
'I cannot interpret a dream' (Genesis 41:16)

(3.134) *lút-thèi dìng ùh hì*
enter-ABIL IRR 2/3PL DECL
'they will be able to enter' (Matthew 7:21)

The subsection therefore keeps two points in view at once. First, *-thei* really does mark ability or possibility. Second, the Old Testament row already shows how quickly the modal anchor meets negation, which is why the present section stays narrower than a full modal chapter.

3.7.7 Repetition and return marking

-kik 'again / back' regularly marks repeated or return-oriented events. The present section keeps that claim modest: the suffix is real and productive enough to discuss, but it is not expanded here into a full motion-verb chapter or a full discourse account of repetition.

(3.135) *nà ciah-kík matengin*
2SG return-ITER until
'until you return' (Genesis 3:19)

(3.136) *à ciah-kík ùh hì*
3SG return-ITER 2/3PL DECL
'they returned' (Matthew 2:12)

The Old Testament and Gospel rows line up closely enough to support a stable grammar-facing statement that *-kik* belongs in the repetitive or return-marking zone. Broader motion semantics still have to be handled construction by construction.

3.7.8 Boundary with negation and sentence-final particles

The present section does not reopen the negation or sentence-final chapters. That boundary matters most around *-thei* 'can / be able', which often appears in strings such as *khiathei ding om lo* 'there is no one who can interpret it', where ability, irrealis, and negation belong to one clause-sized complex rather than to a single neat suffix slot.

The same caution applies to *-ta* 'completive / change-of-state' and *-zo* 'already / completive'. Compact verbal rows are safe enough to discuss here, but clause-final *ta hi* and bare *zo* remain better treated as boundary material with sentence-final particles than as already-settled TAM categories.

3.7.9 Boundary with directionals and VP structure

Directional and TAM material can stack, but the present section keeps that interaction explicit rather than solved. The row *khia-ta* 'out-PFV' shows why a tidy aspect label can quickly become a directional-plus-TAM problem, while *bawlzoding* 'make-COMPL-IRR' and *bawlsakthei* 'make-CAUS-ABIL' show why fuller suffix ordering belongs with verb-phrase structure rather than with the compact inventory above.

Clause-bound *dingin* 'for... to / clause-bound irrealis' belongs at the same boundary. It is important evidence for the wider system, but it turns prospective marking into clause linkage too quickly to serve as the core anchor for the present section.

3.7.10 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *pailai* ‘go-midst / prospective form’ still overlaps lexical *lai* too heavily for the present section.
- *dingin* ‘for... to / clause-bound irrealis’ and similar purpose-like rows remain clause-linkage material.
- *mangngilh ta hi* ‘has forgotten’ keeps clause-final *ta hi* visible without making it the model for completive aspect.
- *khiathei ding om lo* ‘there is no one who can interpret it’, *khia-ta* ‘out-PFV’, *bawlzoding* ‘make-COMPL-IRR’, and *bawlsakthei* ‘make-CAUS-ABIL’ remain overlap material rather than core anchors.
- *-nawn* ‘again / any longer’ and *-khin* ‘already / after completion’ are not expanded here.

3.7.11 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim already shows a small but real TAM, aspect, and modal profile through compact anchors. *-ta*, *-zo*, *-gige*, *-zel*, *-ngei*, *-ding*, *-thei*, and *-kik* can all be discussed now, but only if their boundaries with sentence-final particles, negation, directionals, and wider VP structure remain visible. That is why the section stays controlled: it offers a usable core inventory without pretending that the full verbal system has already been normalized.

3.8 Directionals

The current directional evidence is strongest for post-verbal forms such as *-khia* ‘outward’, *-khiat* ‘away’, *-toh* ‘upward’, *-sawn* ‘toward’, and *-suk* ‘downward’, while deictic prefixes remain separate.

3.8.1 Overview of directional expressions

The safest current claim is that this section treats a cautious subset of post-verbal directional morphology and directional-looking verbal derivatives, rather than the whole Tedim deictic system. The clearest anchors are *-khia* ‘outward’, *-khiat* ‘away’, *-toh* ‘upward’, *-sawn* ‘toward’, and *-suk* ‘downward’. Forms such as *hotkhiatna* ‘salvation’ and *kahtohna* ‘going up’ show that the same morphology also appears inside nominalized material, while pre-verbal deictic markers such as *va-* ‘away’ and *hong-* ‘toward the deictic center’ remain better handled as a separate subsystem (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017; Otsuka and Kurabe).

The section therefore keeps its descriptive scope modest. It focuses on forms that are transparent enough for grammar-facing prose now, while leaving broader motion-verb lexicon, deictic prefixing, and full verb-phrase stacking for later treatment.

3.8.2 Current directional inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-khia	outward or outward-result direction	*pokhia*	well supported	should not be generalized from every orthographic *khia* sequence
-khiat	away or out-of-domain direction	*nawhkhiat*	supported with caveat	analyzer-label caution remains relevant
-khiat-na	nominalized away morphology	*hotkhiatna*	boundary material	not equivalent to a simple finite directional verb
-toh	upward direction	*kilaktoh*, *a kilaktoh ding hun*	supported with caveat	blocked *paitoh* overlap prevents a blanket UP reading

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-toh-na	nominalized upward morphology	*kahtohna*	boundary material	nominalization keeps the directional segment visible without yielding a simple finite predicate
-sawn	toward or toward-directed transfer	*piasawn*, *nausawn*	cautious support	easy hits drift into kinship-heavy or lexicalized domains
-suk	downward direction	*paisuk*	supported with caveat	still represented by a narrow checked set
-lam	sideward or direction-side material	*tawplam*	boundary material	too noun-like for a clean verbal directional analysis
paitoh pattern	blocked overlap control	*paitoh*	excluded as a directional anchor	lexicalized accompany/comitative reading blocks a simple upward analysis

The table also keeps *-lam* 'sideward / toward a side' and *paitoh* 'go-accompany' visible as boundary material rather than as core anchors. That boundary work matters because a grammar-facing section should show where directional evidence stops being clean, not only where it starts.

3.8.3 Outward and away direction

The clearest outward and away examples stay conservative. *Pokhia* 'grow out' shows outward orientation, while *nawhkhiat* 'drive out / hurry away' keeps away-directed *-khiat* visible in a compact verbal form. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Old Testament anchors.

(3.137) *po-khìa*
grow-out
'grew out' (Genesis 2:5)

(3.138) *nawh-khìat*
hurry-away
'drove them out' (Deuteronomy 9:4)

The same away morphology also surfaces in *hotkhiatna* 'salvation', but that form is nominalized and therefore belongs at the boundary between directional morphology and deverbal nominalization rather than as a second finite anchor.

3.8.4 Upward direction and directionals in the verb phrase

Current evidence is strongest for *-toh* 'upward'. Numbers 9:17 gives the clearest compact Old Testament anchor.

(3.139) *kī-làk-tòh*
REFL-take-UP
'was taken up' (Numbers 9:17)

Luke 9:51 then shows the same upward material inside a larger verbal sequence:

(3.140) *à* *kī-làk-tòh* *dìng* *hùn*
3SG REFL-take-UP IRR time
'the time for him to be taken up' (Luke 9:51)

The Gospel row matters for more than source balance. It shows directional material after the verbal core and before *ding* 'irrealis / prospective', which supports a modest verb-phrase claim without turning this section into a full stacking analysis. At the same time, *paitoh* 'go-accompany' remains the necessary blocked control, and *kahtohna* 'going up' keeps upward morphology visible in nominalized form rather than in a simple finite predicate.

3.8.5 Toward direction with *-sawn*

Piasawn 'give toward' is the clearest checked Old Testament row.

(3.141) *pía-sàwn*
give-toward
'extend to us' (Ezra 9:9)

Luke 20:31 provides a Gospel comparandum in *nausawn* 'elder-sibling-toward':

(3.142) *nà-u-sàwn*
2SG-elder.sibling-toward
'took her in turn as an elder brother' (Luke 20:31)

The Luke example is still kinship-heavy, so it remains a supporting comparandum rather than the main anchor. Even so, it confirms that toward-oriented *-sawn* material belongs in the present section, while wider kinship and lexicalization issues still require caution.

3.8.6 Downward direction with *-suk*

Paisuk 'go down' gives the clearest checked downward row. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction, so the section keeps the compact Old Testament anchor. This construction is rare in the controlled evidence, so one example is used here and broader source balancing remains outside the present account.

(3.143) *pái-sùk*
go-DOWN
'came down' (Genesis 11:5)

The row is compact, analyzable, and grammatically useful. It shows that downward *-suk* is part of the directional profile, but it does not justify a larger claim about every downward-looking verb in the language.

3.8.7 Deictic boundary

Several directional meanings in Tedim are better described from the deictic center than from post-verbal suffixes alone. The literature discusses pre-verbal *va-* 'away' and *hong-* or *ong-* 'toward the speaker / venitive' as a separate subsystem (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017; Otsuka and Kurabe). The present section does not merge those markers with the post-verbal forms above, because the checked examples here are strongest for post-verbal or post-stem material rather than for a full deictic paradigm.

This also keeps the present section distinct from the demonstrative system. Directional perspective is clearly relevant, but the forms treated here are verbal rather than demonstrative.

3.8.8 TAM and VP-structure boundary

The present section also stops short of a full account of TAM or serial-like verbal sequencing. The upward Gospel row *a kilaktoh ding hun* 'the time for him to be taken up' shows that a directional element can stand before *ding* 'irrealis / prospective', but that single pattern is not enough to settle the full order of aspect, direction, TAM, and clause linkage.

Likewise, noun-like forms such as *hotkhiatna* 'salvation' and *kahtohna* 'going up' show why some directional-looking material belongs with nominalization or broader verb-phrase structure rather than with a simple inventory of finite directional suffixes.

3.8.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *tawplam* 'toward the side / at the edge' keeps *-lam* visible, but the form is still too noun-like for a clean verbal directional claim.
- *paitoh* 'go-accompany' remains a blocked overlap row rather than upward evidence.
- *uilut*, *paiphei*, *cip*, and *tang* are still too noisy or too weakly supported for the present account.
- The section does not attempt a full lexicon of motion verbs, a full deictic paradigm, or a full suffix-order analysis.

3.8.10 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim directionals are currently best described through a small checked set of post-verbal forms. *-khia* 'outward', *-khiat* 'away', *-toh* 'upward', *-sawn* 'toward', and *-suk* 'downward' are all visible, but only *-toh* and *-sawn* currently show balanced Old Testament and Gospel formal examples in this section. The rest remains explicitly delimited by nominalization, deictic, or verb-phrase boundaries rather than expanded into a full directional chapter.

3.9 Derivation / valency

The current derivation and valency evidence is strongest around *-sak* 'causative / benefactive', especially *paisak* 'cause to go' and *muhsak* 'show / make see', while *-pih* 'with / accompanying', *ki-* 'reflexive / middle / passive-like', and heavier suffix stacks remain boundary material.

3.9.1 Overview of derivation and valency change

This section treats a controlled part of Tedim derivation and valency-changing morphology rather than the whole derivational system. The clearest present anchors are *-sak* 'causative / benefactive', especially *paisak* 'cause to go' and *muhsak* 'show / make see', while *-pih* 'with / accompanying', *ki-* 'reflexive / middle / passive-like', and heavier suffix stacks such as *ciahsakkik* 'send back', *bawlsakthei* 'can cause to make', and *paikhiatsak* 'cause to go out' remain explicit boundaries.

The goal is therefore modest. It is enough to show that Tedim has a productive causative use of *-sak* 'causative / benefactive', a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use centered on *muhsak* 'show / make see', and several nearby constructions that should not yet be folded into the same account.

3.9.2 Current derivation / valency inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
Form I + *-sak*	productive causative	*paisak*	supported	safest core claim

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
Form II + *-sak*	benefactive or applicative-like extension	*muhsak*	supported with caution	higher-level suffix analysis remains open
paisak	cause to go	*Israel mite paisak in*, *ka kiangah hong paisak un*	supported	may interact with motion semantics
muhsak	show / make see	*ka hong muhsak thu khempeuh*, *na mit khua hong bangci muhsak ahi hiam*	supported with caution	exact benefactive versus applicative label remains open
paipih	go with / accompany	*paipih*	boundary material	*-pih* still overlaps comitative and benefactive readings
ki- forms	reflexive, middle, or passive-like material	*kisep*, *kigen*	boundary material	needs a separate account
ciahsakkik, *bawlsakthei*, *paikhiatsak*	derivation-heavy stacking	*hong ciahsakkik un*, *bawlsakthei*, *hong paikhiatsak ciangin*	boundary material	overlaps VP structure and suffix stacking
piangsak	lexicalized causative-looking verb	*piangsak*	boundary material	belongs with transitivity as well as derivation

The table keeps *paipih* 'go with / accompany', *kisep* 'REFL-work / do by oneself', *kigen* 'be said / it is said', and *piangsak* 'cause to be born / create' visible without turning them into solved core categories. A controlled section should show where the evidence is strongest and where it still shifts into neighboring domains.

3.9.3 Causative *-sak*

The form *paisak* 'cause to go' shows a productive causative use of *-sak* 'causative / benefactive'. The clearest current point is practical rather than maximal: Form I plus *-sak* regularly supports a straightforward causative reading, and *paisak* gives that pattern in a compact and transparent way.

The pair below keeps that point grounded in both Old Testament and Gospel material. In Exodus the form is an imperative meaning 'let the people go', while in Mark it again licenses motion toward the speaker.

(3.144) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:deriv-paisak-exod10: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Israel	*mì-tè*	*pái-sàk*	*ìn*
ISRAEL	person-PL	go-CAUS	ERG

'let the people of Israel go' (Exodus 10:7)

(3.145)

kà	*kìang-àh*	*hòng*	*pái-sàk*	*ùn*
1SG	beside-LOC	3→1	go-CAUS	IMP.PL

'let them come to me' (Mark 10:14)

These examples do not require a full derivational paradigm. They are enough to support the narrower point that *paisak* keeps a productive causative use clearly visible in ordinary discourse.

3.9.4 Benefactive and applicative-like *-sak*

The form *muhsak* 'show / make see' supports a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use of *-sak* 'causative / benefactive'. This subsection keeps the wording cautious on purpose: the evidence is strong enough to separate *muhsak* from the plain causative line, but it does not yet force a final theoretical choice about exactly how many suffix senses should be recognized.

The formal examples again show the same row across Old Testament and Gospel material. Habakkuk presents *muhsak* in a reporting context, while John uses it in a question about restored sight.

(3.146)	*Nangmah*	*kà*	*hòng*	*mùh-sak*	*thù*	*khèmpeuh*
	2SG.PRO	1SG	3→1	see.II-BENF	word	all

'everything that I have shown you' (Habakkuk 2:2)

(3.147)	*nà*	*mìt*	*khùa*	*hòng*	*bangci*	*mùh-sak*	*àhì*	*hìam*
	2SG	eye	town	3→1	how	see.II-BENF	be.3SG	Q

'how did he open your eyes' (John 9:26)

This pair is best treated as a distinct *-sak* line rather than as a simple paraphrase of the causative examples above. At the same time, the section stays smaller than a full applicative chapter and avoids turning one well-supported row into a complete system claim.

3.9.5 The practical split within *-sak*

The practical descriptive split is therefore modest. Form I plus *-sak* supports causative use, while Form II plus *-sak* supports a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use.

That contrast is enough for a controlled grammar account, but the final theoretical status of the split remains open. It may prove best to describe these patterns as two readings within one suffixal domain, or as two tightly related derivational uses that should still be separated in description.

For the present account, the important point is simply that *paisak* 'cause to go' and *muhsak* 'show / make see' should not be flattened into the same gloss line. The contrast is real even if the larger suffix theory remains under discussion.

3.9.6 Boundary with *-pih*

The nearest boundary beyond *-sak* is *-pih* 'with / accompanying'. The form *paipih* 'go with / accompany' is transparent enough to keep in view, but its function still overlaps comitative, benefactive, and applicative readings too strongly for this section to promote it as a second core derivational anchor.

The same boundary also includes *mipihte* 'companions / associated people', which looks *pih*-based but is noun-centered rather than a clear verbal valency pattern. That is why the present section names *-pih* as an adjacent domain without turning it into a separate applicative chapter.

3.9.7 Boundary with *ki-*

The prefix *ki-* 'reflexive / middle / passive-like' likewise remains outside the present core account. The clearest future anchor is still *kisep* 'REFL-work / do by oneself', while *kigen* 'be said / it is said' shows the more agent-defocused or passive-like side of the same domain.

Both forms matter because they show that valency change in Tedim is not confined to suffixes alone. Even so, the present section does not absorb reflexive, middle, passive-like, or prefixal structure into a narrow *-sak* discussion.

3.9.8 Boundary with VP stacking

The overlap with VP structure is easiest to see in derivation-heavy stacks. *Ciahsakkik* ‘send back’ is the clearest matched pair, and it shows why derivational morphology and suffix ordering must sometimes be discussed together without being collapsed into one chapter. The same boundary keeps *bawlsakthei* ‘can cause to make’ and *paikhiatsak* ‘cause to go out’ visible as nearby stacked forms.

(3.148) *hòng ciah-sàk-kík ùn*
3→1 return-CAUS-ITER IMP.PL
‘send me back’ (Genesis 24:54)

(3.149) *à guak ciah-sàk-kík ùh hì*
3SG back return-CAUS-ITER 2/3PL DECL
‘they sent him back empty’ (Mark 12:3)

These examples are useful precisely because they stop short of a larger template claim. They show that derivational material can participate in bigger suffix strings, while still leaving the full architecture of those strings to the VP section.

3.9.9 Boundary with transitivity

Some causative-looking verbs remain better treated as transitivity-adjacent lexical items than as first-line derivational evidence. *Piangsak* ‘cause to be born / create’ is the clearest current example: it is too important to ignore, but too lexicalized to carry the same descriptive weight as *paisak* ‘cause to go’.

This is why the present section does not try to settle every transitivity question inside the *-sak* domain. Productive causative morphology and lexicalized transitive verbs meet here, but they should not yet be treated as one solved class.

3.9.10 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *paisak* ‘cause to go’ and *muhsak* ‘show / make see’ are the clearest current anchors, but they do not exhaust the derivational system.
- *paipih* ‘go with / accompany’ and *mipihte* ‘companions / associated people’ keep the *-pih* boundary visible without settling its broader function.
- *kisep* ‘REFL-work / do by oneself’ and *kigen* ‘be said / it is said’ show that *ki-* needs a separate reflexive, middle, and passive-like treatment.
- *ciahsakkik* ‘send back’, *bawlsakthei* ‘can cause to make’, and *paikhiatsak* ‘cause to go out’ belong to the derivation-VP boundary rather than to a compact suffix list.
- *piangsak* ‘cause to be born / create’ remains adjacent evidence at the edge of transitivity and lexicalization.
- The section therefore stays with a narrow *-sak* account instead of expanding into a full derivational morphology or valency-changing chapter.

3.9.11 Summary

The safest conclusion is that Tedim already shows a controlled derivation / valency contrast centered on *-sak* ‘causative / benefactive’. *Paisak* ‘cause to go’ supports a productive causative use, *muhsak* ‘show / make see’ supports a distinct benefactive or applicative-like use, and derivation-heavy stacks such as *ciahsakkik* ‘send back’ show how quickly the same material meets VP structure. The broader systems of *-pih*, *ki-*, and lexicalized transitivity remain visible, but they remain outside the present account.

3.10 ki- reflexive / reciprocal / middle

The current *ki-* evidence is strongest for reciprocal *ki-gawm* 'join together' and subject-affected *ki-lak-toh* 'be taken up', while passive-like *kigen* 'be said / be told' and lexicalized forms such as *kipan* 'begin / from' remain explicit boundary material.

3.10.1 Overview of *ki-* reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like marking

This section isolates *ki-* 'reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like' so that voice-like evidence is no longer scattered across unrelated chapters. The first claim is deliberately narrow: reciprocal *ki-gawm* 'join together' and subject-affected *kilaktoh* 'be taken up' are the clearest currently promoted constructions.

The forms *kisep* 'REFL-work / do by oneself' and *kigen* 'be said / be told' remain useful but cautious support because lexicalization risk remains real. This section therefore does not claim a full voice chapter, a full transitivity chapter, a full prefix/agreement chapter, a full derivation chapter, or a full VP-slot template.

3.10.2 Current *ki-* inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
ki-gawm	reciprocal predicate	spouse-pair and dual-participant clauses	supported core	reciprocal evidence does not settle all *ki-* behavior
kilaktoh	middle or subject-affected predicate	"be taken up" rows	supported with caution	overlaps directionals and VP stacking
kigen	passive-like or agent-defocused reporting	"be told / cannot be told" rows	supported with caution	analyzer glossing is partly lexicalized
kisep	reflexive or self-directed support row	"work done" rows	supporting candidate	can be lexicalized in procedural discourse
kipan	lexicalized or frozen *ki-* form	begin/from sequences	boundary material	not a safe reflexive core claim
ki-phuak, *ki-piak-na*	*ki-* with derivational or VP layering	naming and nominalized-event rows	boundary material	overlaps TAM, nominalization, and valency
report-only *kibawl* counts	discovery-only inventory	count-heavy report tables	blocked	count totals are not constructional proof

3.10.3 Safest reflexive / reciprocal / middle-like evidence

Reciprocal *ki-gawm* 'join together' is the strongest starting point because participant structure is explicit and parallel across Old Testament and Gospel examples.

(3.150)

à	*zi*	*tàwh*	*kī-gawm*	*à,*	*àmau*	*tegel*	*pum*	*khàt*	*à*	*bàng*	*ùh*	*hì.*
3SG	wife	COM	REFL-seize	3SG	3PL.PRO	both	body	one	3SG	like	2/3PL	DECL

'He is joined with his wife, and the two become one body.' (Genesis 2:24)

Matthew 19:5 provides the Gospel counterpart with the same reciprocal predicate.

(3.151)

à	*zi*	*tàwh*	*kī-gawm*	*dìng*	*à,*	*àmau*	*tegel*	*pumkhat*	*à*	*bàng*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*hì.*
3SG	wife	COM	REFL-seize	IRR	3SG	3PL.PRO	both	body	3SG	like	IRR	2/3PL	DECL

'He will be joined with his wife, and the two will become one body.' (Matthew 19:5)

Subject-affected *kilaktoh* 'be taken up' supplies the cleanest middle-like support now available, while still keeping directional and VP overlap visible.

(3.152) *kī-làk-tòh*
REFL-take-UP
'was taken up' (Numbers 9:17)

Luke 9:51 gives the Gospel counterpart for the same subject-affected construction.

(3.153)

à	*kī-làk-tòh*	*dìng*	*hùn*
3SG	REFL-take-UP	IRR	time

'the time for him to be taken up' (Luke 9:51)

3.10.4 Passive-like or agent-defocused evidence

Passive-like or agent-defocused *kigen* 'be said / be told' is useful, but it must remain cautious because lexicalized reporting uses are common.

(3.154) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:ki-pass-kigen-gen27: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Rebekah	*tùngàh*	*ki-gēn*	*hì.*
REBEKAH	on-LOC	conversation	DECL

'The words were told to Rebekah.' (Genesis 27:42)

Matthew 2:10 keeps the same *kigen* line in a Gospel clause with modal negation.

(3.155)

à	*lungdam-ná*	*ùh*	*ki-gēn*	*théi*	*lò*	*hì.*
3SG	rejoice-NMLZ	2/3PL	conversation	know	NEG	DECL

'their joy could not be told.' (Matthew 2:10)

3.10.5 Lexicalized or frozen *ki-* boundary

Forms such as *kipan* 'begin / from' remain boundary material in this section. They are important for coverage, but they do not justify promotion into the core reflexive/reciprocal/middle claim.

(3.156)

Túa	*hùn*	*à*	*ki-pan-ìn*	*mì-tè*	*ìn*	*Topa*	*bía-ìn*	*à*	*mīn*	*làwh*	*dìng*	*kī-pan*
DIST	time	3SG	from	person-PL	ERG	Lord	worship-ERG	3SG	name	PERF	IRR	REFL-begin
tá	*ùh*	*hì.*										
child	2/3PL	DECL										

'From that time people began to call on the name of the Lord.' (Genesis 4:26)

Matthew 4:17 gives the Gospel counterpart with the same lexicalized begin/from profile.

(3.157)

Túa	*hùn*	*à*	*kī-pan*	*Jesuh*	*ìn*	*thù-hìlh*	*dìng*	*kī-pan*	*à.*
DIST	time	3SG	REFL-begin	JESUH	ERG	word-teach	IRR	REFL-begin	3SG

'From that time Jesus began to preach.' (Matthew 4:17)

3.10.6 Boundary with derivation, VP stacking, transitivity, and prefix/agreement

The forms *ki-phuak* 'be called' and *ki-piak-na* 'REFL-give-NMLZ' show that *ki-* rapidly crosses into derivation, nominalization, TAM layering, and VP stacking. The same is true for overlap with transitivity and prefix/agreement boundaries. For that reason, these rows remain boundary material rather than new core evidence in this first section.

3.10.7 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *ki-gawm* and *kilaktoh* support a controlled first claim, but they do not settle the full voice system.
- *kisep* and *kigen* remain cautious support rows with lexicalization risk.
- *kipan* remains lexicalized or frozen boundary material.
- *ki-* plus derivational, TAM, and VP-heavy material remains boundary material.
- Raw report counts are not treated as grammar facts without constructional control.

3.10.8 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is a narrow one: reciprocal *ki-gawm* and subject-affected *kilaktoh* provide clear first anchors for a dedicated *ki-* section, while passive-like *kigen*, supporting *kisep*, lexicalized *kipan*, and derivation/VP overlaps remain explicit boundaries.

3.11 -pih comitative applicative

The current *-pih* evidence is strongest for verbal comitative applicative forms such as *paipih* 'go with / accompany', *nekpih* 'eat with', and *tunpih* 'arrive with / bring with', while nominal *-pih* forms such as *innkuanpihte* 'family members' remain explicit boundary material.

3.11.1 Overview of verbal *-pih* comitative applicative

This section isolates verbal *-pih* as a comitative applicative suffix so that its function is no longer treated only as a boundary note within the derivation/valency account. The first claim is deliberately narrow but now empirically stabilized: verbal *-pih* is best treated as a Stem 2 / Form II selecting suffix that introduces or indexes a comitative participant or comitative object.

Verbal *-pih* must be kept distinct from nominal *-pih* meaning 'member / group member', which is documented independently by Henderson (1965) and illustrated in forms such as *innkuanpihte* 'family members' and *mipihte* 'group members / companions'. This section does not claim a full applicative chapter, a full valency chapter, a full derivational morphology chapter, a full VP-slot template, or a complete comitative system. It also does not treat every frequent *-pih* form as equally diagnostic for stem alternation: *nekpih* is currently the clearest internal diagnostic, while *paipih* and *paikhiatpih* require morphophonological caution around *pai / paih*.

3.11.2 Current *-pih* inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
paipih	comitative motion applicative	*paipih* in bring/lead contexts	supported core with stem caveat	strong functional evidence, but *pai / paih* diagnostics remain unresolved
nekpih	comitative eating applicative	*nekpih* in eat-together contexts	supported	strongest current stem-diagnostic row (*ne / nek*)
tunpih	comitative arrival applicative	*tunpih* in arrive/bring contexts	supported with caution	compatible with Stem 2 claim but not independently diagnostic
hopih	comitative encounter applicative	*hopih* in meet/greet contexts	supporting boundary material	high-frequency but stem base is unclear (*ho*/*hop*)

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
ompih	comitative dwelling applicative	*ompih* in stay/dwell contexts	boundary material	stative semantics interact with TAM and possessive analysis
hehpih	favor/grace lexical family	*hehpih* and *hehpihna* grace/mercy contexts	boundary material	lexicalized grace-family semantics; not a clean stem diagnostic
innkuanpihte	household member (NOMINAL)	Noah's household-member plural	boundary material	nominal -pih "group member" (Henderson); must not be treated as verbal applicative
mipihte	group member / companion plural (NOMINAL)	"his group members" contexts	boundary material	nominal -pih "group member" (Henderson); boundary only
paikhiatpih	go-out-with directional stack	bring out with + directional	boundary material	directional -khiat stacked before -pih; VP-stacking boundary
nominal *-pih* forms generally	member / group-member suffix	*innkuanpih*, *mipihte*, *kho-pih*	boundary material	different origin or domain from verbal applicative; cannot be conflated

3.11.3 Verbal *-pih* as comitative applicative

The clearest current evidence for verbal *-pih* as a comitative applicative is *paipih* 'go with / accompany / bring'. The form is transparent and highly productive across the corpus, and it is consistent with the Otsuka (2011) analysis of *-pih* as a comitative applicative that attaches to Form II / Stem 2 verbs and introduces a new core argument representing either a comitative participant or a comitative object.

In Genesis the form appears as God bringing the woman to the man, introducing the woman as the accompanying participant.

(3.158) *mipa kìang-àh túa nù à pái-pìh hì.*
man beside-LOC DIST female 3SG go-APPL DECL
'[God] brought her to the man.' (Genesis 2:22)

The same form *paipih* appears in the Gospels in a motion-to-wilderness context where the Holy Spirit leads Jesus.

(3.159) *Khá Sìangtho ìn gàm-lak-àh Jesuh à pái-pìh hì.*
NEG.PERF holy ERG land-midst-LOC JESUH 3SG go-APPL DECL
'The Holy Spirit led Jesus into the wilderness.' (Matthew 4:1)

These two examples are enough to establish *paipih* as a productive verbal comitative applicative form. They do not, by themselves, prove the full stem-selection rule, because the exact *pai / paih* stem relation remains morphophonologically difficult in current section evidence.

3.11.4 Form II / Stem 2 restriction

The Form II restriction is established primarily by literature evidence. Otsuka (2011) states that comitative *-pih* attaches only to Form II verbs, and ZNC (2017/2018) independently documents this with explicit grammaticality contrasts.

The current section uses a split diagnostic logic rather than one undifferentiated claim:

- **Diagnostic row:** *nekpih*, because *ne / nek* is independently stabilized as a Form I / Form II pair in the stem-alternation section.
- **Compatible but not independently diagnostic rows:** *tunpih* and *ompih*.
- **Morphophonological-boundary rows:** *paipih* and *paikhiatpih*, because *pai / paih* remains unresolved in current section evidence and may involve non-realization of stem-final *h* before *-pih*.

The safest statement is therefore strong but bounded: Stem 2 selection is the best-supported analysis, but the corpus alone does not prove that rule equally for every *-pih* form.

This note is not a claim to have verified the restriction exhaustively. A human reviewer should check whether any counter-example exists in the wider corpus.

3.11.5 Transitive verb contexts

The comitative applicative also attaches to transitive verbs, as shown by *nekpih* 'eat together with'. In a Proverbs context the form appears in a purposive, clause-bound irrealis construction where the speaker invites the addressee to share a meal.

(3.160) *Kà nèk-pìh dìng-ìn nàng kà hòng zòng à, tù-ìn kòng mú pet-màh hì.*
1SG eat-with IRR-ERG 2SG.PRO 1SG 3→1 also 3SG now-ERG 1SG→3 see.I find-exactly DECL
'I came looking for you, to eat together with me.' (Proverbs 7:15)

The Gospel counterpart shows the same *nekpih* in an invitation clause where Jesus is the comitative participant.

(3.161) *Farisi mì khàt ìn àn nèk-pìh dìng-ìn Jesuh à sam hì.*
FARISI person one ERG 3PL.POSS eat-with IRR-ERG JESUH 3SG open DECL
'A Pharisee invited Jesus to eat with him.' (Luke 11:37)

Both rows show *nekpih* in purposive or clause-bound irrealis environments (*ding-in*), matching the grammar-facing treatment already used in TAM, clause-linkage, and VP-structure boundary discussions.

3.11.6 Motion verbs and comitative objects

Otsuka (2011) distinguishes two types of comitative argument introduced by *-pih*: a comitative participant (a person who goes along) and a comitative object (a thing that is brought along). The form *tunpih* 'arrive with / bring with / come with' illustrates both types.

In Genesis 8 the dove arrives with a freshly plucked olive leaf as comitative object.

(3.162) *oliv teh à tukkhiat thàk khàt à mú-kàh pet-ìn hòng tun-pìh hì.*
olive measure 3SG pluck.off new one 3SG see-mouth pluck-leaf 3→1 arrive-APPL DECL
'[the dove] arrived with a freshly plucked olive leaf in its beak.' (Genesis 8:11)

In Matthew 9 the same form *tunpih* introduces a comitative participant (the paralytic brought to Jesus).

(3.163) *Mì pàwl-khàt ìn khùt-lè-khe-zàw mì khàt à lupna pheek tàwh hòng*
person some-one ERG hand-and-foot-more person one 3SG bed bed COM 3→1
pua-ìn Jesuh kìang à hòng tun-pìh ùh hì.
carry.on.back-ERG JESUH beside 3SG 3→1 arrive-APPL 2/3PL DECL
'Some people brought a paralytic to Jesus.' (Matthew 9:2)

The contrast between these two rows keeps both comitative object and comitative participant uses visible without forcing a single analysis of all *tunpih* occurrences.

3.11.7 Boundary with nominal *-pih*

Nominal *-pih* meaning 'member / group member' must remain a visible boundary in any grammar-facing account of verbal *-pih*. Henderson (1965) documents this suffix with examples such as *a inkuan-pih te* 'his family members', *ka kho-pih* 'my village-mate', and *na sang-pih* 'your school-mate'. The corpus contains over a hundred occurrences of *innkuanpihte* 'family members' and *mipihte* 'group members', all in clearly nominal contexts.

No rows from this nominal domain have been promoted as verbal applicative evidence. The homophony is real and the synchronic relationship between the two *-pih* forms remains an open question in the literature.

3.11.8 Boundary with directionals, VP stacking, and *-pih* interactions

The form *paikhiatpih* 'bring out with' shows *-pih* stacked after the directional suffix *-khiat* 'away / out'. ZNC (2017/2018) also documents *pai-pih-suk* 'walk down along with', and Otsuka (2011) notes that *-pih* and the relinquitive *-san* can co-occur. These stacked forms are important for completeness but they remain boundary material in this first account.

Similarly, the high-frequency forms *hopih*, *hehpih*, and *ompih* appear extensively in the corpus in contexts that may involve lexicalized interaction, grace/mercy vocabulary, or stative-comitative readings. These rows remain supporting or boundary material: they are useful for distribution and coverage, but they are not treated as primary stem diagnostics.

3.11.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several areas remain outside this account.

- *paipih*, *nekpih*, and *tunpih* are the clearest promoted forms, but they play different diagnostic roles for stem alternation.
- *hopih*, *hehpih*, *ompih*, *ciahpih*, and *tenpih* appear frequently but their precise applicative vs lexicalized status remains unresolved.
- Stem 2 selection remains the best-supported rule, but *paipih* and *paikhiatpih* remain morphophonological-boundary rows for that rule.
- Nominal *innkuanpihte* and *mipihte* remain boundary material and must not be promoted as verbal evidence.
- Stacked directional forms such as *paikhiatpih* remain boundary material pending VP-slot analysis.
- The potential benefactive reading of *-pih* (noted by Otsuka as a possible secondary sense) is not promoted and remains an open question.
- Raw report counts are not grammar facts without constructional and stem-diagnostic control.
- The comitative system as a whole — including *-khawm* 'together' and case-marked comitative strategies — lies outside the present narrow account.

3.11.10 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is a narrow but concrete one: Tedim has a verbal *-pih* comitative applicative suffix best analyzed as Stem 2 selecting. *Nekpih* provides the clearest section-internal diagnostic support for that stem claim; *paipih* and *tunpih* remain strong functional evidence, with *paipih* explicitly caveated as a morphophonological-boundary row around *pai / paih*. Nominal *-pih* 'member / group member' remains a separate boundary category, and stacked directional or VP-heavy forms remain outside the present core claim.

3.12 Nominalization

The current nominalization evidence is strongest for productive deverbal *-na* 'nominalizer', with *bawlna* 'making / creation' as a compact anchor, while *-pa* 'agentive / person' and *-mi* 'person / one who' material remains explicit boundary evidence.

3.12.1 Overview of nominalization in this section

This section treats a controlled part of Tedim nominalization centered on productive deverbal *-na* ‘nominalizer’. It keeps agentive or person-head material and nominalized relative-clause material as boundaries so the discussion remains grammar-facing without turning into a full nominalization, relative-clause, or derivational chapter.

3.12.2 Current nominalization inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
-na	deverbal nominalizer	*theihna*, *ciaptehna*	well supported	broader nominalization inventory remains open
bawlna	deverbal nominal from *bawl*	lexical anchor in running prose	supported with caveat	needs wider textual distribution work
bawl-na	segmented deverbal nominal	morpheme-level analysis	supported with caveat	segmentation is clearer than full paradigm scope
-pa	agentive or person-head nominalization	*lawmpa*, *bawlpa*	boundary material	overlaps lexicalized and title-like uses
-mi	person-head or relative-linked nominalization	*a hong pai mi*, *a bawl mi*	boundary material	overlaps relative-clause analysis
omna	nominalized clause-like form	*omna mun* patterns	boundary material	overlaps clause linkage and NP structure
muhna-ah	nominalization plus case-like marking	*Pasian’ muhna-ah*	boundary material	overlaps case marking and clause linkage
kumpipa	lexicalized title-like form	royal title contexts	boundary material	not a transparent productive *-pa* pattern
Topa	title-like lexical form	reverential title contexts	boundary material	cannot be treated as a productive *-pa* derivation

3.12.3 Deverbal nominalization with *-na*

The suffix *-na* ‘nominalizer’ forms deverbal nouns and remains the safest productive anchor in the current evidence. The form *bawlna* ‘making / creation’ with segmentation *bawl-na* ‘make-NMLZ’ is the clearest compact anchor for this function, even though a full paradigm is still outside the present account.

The same morphology appears in stable textual examples such as *theihna* ‘knowledge’ and *ciaptehna* ‘record / writing’. Together they support a grammar-facing claim for productive deverbal nominalization without forcing a full inventory of all nominal outcomes.

(3.164)	*à*	*phà*	*lè*	*à*	*sía*	*thèih-ná*	*sing-kung*	*gah*
	3SG	branch	and	3SG	evil	know.II-NMLZ	tree	branch

‘the fruit of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil’ (Genesis 2:17)

(3.165) *Abraham' suan David, David' suan Jesuh Khrih' khang ciapteh-ná híh bàng àhì hì.*
ABRAHAM.POSS plant DAVID DAVID.POSS plant JESUH KHRIH.POSS generation receive-NMLZ PROX like be.3SG DECL
'This is the record of the genealogy of Jesus Christ, son of David, son of Abraham.' (Matthew 1:1)

3.12.4 Nominalization and stem alternation

Nominalized contexts connect directly to Form II evidence in stem alternation, especially where forms such as *theihna* 'knowledge' keep a nominalizer on a stem family that also participates in Form I/Form II contrasts. This is useful as constructional evidence, but it does not reopen a full stem-alternation chapter here.

The key point is local: nominalized environments help explain why Form II-like material remains visible in nominalized stems, while broader stem-class claims still depend on the stem-alternation section.

(3.166) *à phà lè à sía thèih-ná sing-kung*
3SG branch and 3SG evil know.II-NMLZ tree
'the tree of the knowledge of good and evil' (Genesis 2:9)

(3.167) *nà lakkhiat thèih-ná dìng-ùn*
2SG snatch know.II-NMLZ IRR-PL.IMP
'so that you may be able to remove it' (Matthew 7:5)

3.12.5 Agentive or person-head nominalization boundary

Agentive and person-head material is visible through *-pa* 'agentive / person' and *-mi* 'person / one who', including forms such as *bawlpa* 'maker / doer' and *hong pai mi* 'one who came'. The current evidence supports discussing these forms as boundaries, but not promoting them to the core nominalization system yet.

This caution matters because *-pa* patterns are easily mixed with lexicalized titles, while *-mi* patterns are often indistinguishable from person-head relative constructions.

(3.168) *Túa cìang-ìn à lawm-pá ìn dawng-ìn.*
DIST then-ERG 3SG worthy-NMLZ.AG ERG receive-ERG
'Then his companion answered.' (Judges 7:14)

(3.169) *À lawm-pá Josef pèn à màn-ìn à gamta núam mì khàt àhìh màn-ìn*
3SG worthy-NMLZ.AG JOSEF TOP 3SG reason-ERG 3SG send.away want person one be.3SG.REL reason-ERG
'Because Joseph her husband was a righteous man' (Matthew 1:19)

3.12.6 Nominalized relatives and clause-derived nominalization boundary

Forms such as *omna* 'place / being / existence' and *a bawl mi* 'one who made' belong to the overlap between nominalization and relative-clause structure. They are important for analysis, but they remain boundary material in this section.

The same is true for *a hong pai mi* 'one who came': it is structurally informative, but it is safer to coordinate with clause linkage than to treat it as a settled nominalization subtype here.

(3.170) *bìak-ná à pía dìng-ìn à hòng pái mì khèmpeuh ìn túa beel-tè zang-ìn*
worship-NMLZ 3SG give IRR-ERG 3SG 3→1 go person all ERG DIST pan-PL side-CVB
'all who come to offer sacrifice will use those pots' (Zechariah 14:21)

(3.171) *kà kìang-àh à hòng pái mì peuhmah kà hawlkhia kèi dìng hì.*
1SG beside-LOC 3SG 3→1 go person whosoever 1SG drive.out NEG IRR DECL
'I will never cast out anyone who comes to me.' (John 6:37)

3.12.7 Nominalization plus case boundary

Nominalization-plus-case forms such as *muhna-ah* 'in seeing / in the sight of' are well attested but structurally mixed. They show nominalization and case-like morphology in the same form, so they belong partly with case marking and partly with clause linkage.

For that reason, this section treats them as boundary evidence rather than as a core nominalization subtype.

(3.172) *Tù-ìn Pasian' mùh-ná-àh léi-tùng sía à.*
now-ERG God.POSS see.II-NMLZ-LOC land-on evil 3SG
'Now the earth was corrupt in the sight of God.' (Genesis 6:11)

(3.173) *kèima mùh-ná-àh thàt ùn.*
1SG.self see.II-NMLZ-LOC kill IMP.PL
'kill them before me.' (Luke 19:27)

3.12.8 Lexicalized and title-like boundary material

Title-like forms such as *kumpipa* 'king' and *Topa* 'Lord' are important to keep visible because they look segmentable but behave as lexicalized items in many contexts. Treating them as straightforward productive *-pa* nominalizations would overstate what the controlled evidence currently supports.

These rows therefore remain lexicalized boundary material in the present account.

(3.174) *Filistia mite' kùmpì-pà Abimelek' ōm-ná Gerar-àh Isaac pái hì.*
FILISTIA person-PL.POSS king-male ABIMELEK.POSS exist-NMLZ GERAR-LOC ISAAC go DECL
'Isaac went to Gerar, where Abimelech king of the Philistines lived.' (Genesis 26:1)

(3.175) *Topa' mùh-ná-àh àmàh mì-lìan khàt hì dìng hì.*
Lord.POSS see.II-NMLZ-LOC 3SG.PRO person-great one DECL IRR DECL
'He will be great in the sight of the Lord.' (Luke 1:15)

3.12.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *bawlna* and *bawl-na* support a controlled deverbal core, but they do not by themselves settle the full nominalization paradigm.
- *-pa*, *bawlpa*, *-mi*, and *hong pai mi* remain boundary material until lexicalized-title and relative-clause overlap is clearer.
- *omna* and *a bawl mi* 'person who' remain boundary forms shared with clause linkage and relative structure.
- *muhna-ah* remains a boundary form shared with case marking and clause linkage.
- *kumpipa* and *Topa* remain lexicalized or title-like rows rather than transparent productive derivations.
- Bare *na* remains noisy and should not be promoted without stronger controlled evidence.
- Raw occurrence counts are not treated as grammar facts without constructional control.

3.12.10 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim has productive deverbal nominalization with *-na* 'nominalizer', with *bawlna* 'making / creation' and *bawl-na* 'make-NMLZ' as compact anchors. Agentive and person-head material, nominalized relative patterns, nominalization-plus-case forms, and lexicalized title-like forms remain explicit boundaries so the section stays controlled.

3.13 *mi*-headed and nominalized relative-like constructions

The current relative-like evidence is narrow: the head noun *mi* 'person' in the clearest source-resolved pattern is the main diagnostic, *omte* 'those who exist' remains supporting, and *omna* 'place / being / existence' plus *muhna-ah* 'in the sight' remain boundary material. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used, so the first slice stays OT-heavy and cautious.

3.13.1 Overview

This section treats a narrow relative-like domain: the clearest source-resolved pattern is *mi* 'person', while *omte* 'those who exist' is only supporting, and nominalized *omna* 'place / being / existence' plus case-marked *muhna-ah* 'in the sight' stay boundary material. The scope is intentionally modest, and no equally clean Gospel example is currently used for the first slice.

3.13.2 Relative-like inventory

Form or pattern	Source	Head / head-like element	Relative clause span	Current status	Boundary issue
a bawl mi	Exodus 30:38	*mi* (person)	*a bawl*	promoted diagnostic	*a-* also marks ordinary 3SG agreement
omte	Genesis 2:1	none (headless/free)	*om-te*	supporting diagnostic	headless/free relative vs plural nominalization
a om lai	report-only	*lai* (place)	*a om*	report-only	source unresolved
a gen thu	report-only	*thu* (matter)	*a gen*	report-only	source unresolved
omna	Genesis 4:16	nominalized place frame	*om-na*	boundary material	nominalization overlap
muhna-ah	Genesis 6:11	nominalized sight frame	*muh-na-ah*	boundary material	nominalization + case overlap
ciangin	Genesis 1:3	none	*ciang-in*	boundary material	ordinary subordination
dingin	Genesis 1:14	none	*ding-in*	boundary material	purposive / clause-bound irrealis
bawlin	Genesis 11:4	none	*bawl-in*	boundary material	same-subject clause-linkage
semin	Deuteronomy 10:20	none	*sem-in*	boundary material	same-subject clause-linkage
ahih ciangin	Genesis 1:21	none	*ahih ciang-in*	boundary material	support-only clause-linkage

3.13.3 *mi*-headed relatives

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction, so the first slice stays OT-only.

(3.176) *pāk-nam-tui* *à* *bāwl* *mì* *peuhmah*
ointment 3SG make person whosoever
'whoever makes any like it' (Exodus 30:38)

The form *a bawl mi* shows a person-noun *mi* (person) modified by a prenominal predicate *a bawl* (3SG makes). The prefix *a-* is ordinary third-person singular agreement, not a unique relativizer; in prenominal position before a head noun, it yields a relative-like reading. The head noun *mi* is the understood subject of the relative predicate. The report documents 22 tokens of this pattern, all with the same prenominal structure.

3.13.4 Plural relative-like support

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used here, so the support row stays OT-only.

(3.177)	*à*	*sùng-à*	*ōm-tè*	*khèmpeuh*
	3SG	inside-3SG	exist-PL	all

‘all that was in it’ (Genesis 2:1)

The form *omte* combines *om* ‘exist / be’ with plural *-te*. The reading is still ambiguous between a headless/free relative and a plural nominalization, so this remains support rather than a core diagnostic.

3.13.5 Nominalization boundary

omna ‘place of being / presence’ remains boundary material here. It is source-resolved in Genesis 4:16, but the *-na* analysis belongs with the nominalization section rather than with the relative-clause core.

Form	Source	Why boundary
omna	Genesis 4:16	nominalization overlap; keep with *-na*

3.13.6 Case-marked nominalization boundary

muhna-ah ‘in the sight of’ remains boundary material here. It is source-resolved in Genesis 6:11, but the case-marked *-na* form belongs with nominalization plus case interaction rather than with the relative-clause core.

Form	Source	Why boundary
muhna-ah	Genesis 6:11	nominalization + case overlap

3.13.7 Ordinary subordination and clause-linkage boundary

These forms stay outside the relative-clause core.

Form	Source	Why boundary
ciangin	Genesis 1:3	ordinary temporal subordination
dingin	Genesis 1:14	purposive / clause-bound irrealis
bawlin	Genesis 11:4	same-subject clause-linkage, stabilized elsewhere
semin	Deuteronomy 10:20	same-subject clause-linkage, stabilized elsewhere
ahih ciangin	Genesis 1:21	support-only different-subject-like linkage

3.13.8 Deferred material

a om lai and *a gen thu* remain report-only rows because no specific Bible verse has been resolved for them yet. They stay in the inventory, but they are not printed as formal examples.

3.13.9 Summary

The current evidence supports a cautious grammar-facing claim about *mi*-headed relative-like constructions, with *omte* as support and nominalized/case-marked forms kept separate. The *a-* prefix remains ambiguous between relativizer and ordinary 3SG agreement.

3.14 Clause linkage

The current clause-linkage evidence is strongest for temporal subordination with *ciangin* ‘when’, marked clause-finally as *tua ciangin* ‘then / when’, while purposive material with *dingin* ‘in order to’, same-subject converb construction with *ngenin* ‘pray-CVB’, different-subject marking with *ahih ciangin* ‘when’, and relative clauses including *a bawl mi* ‘person who’ remain explicit boundary material.

3.14.1 Overview of clause linkage in this section

This section treats controlled temporal subordination with *ciangin* ‘when’ as the core clause-linkage anchor. Purposive marking with *dingin* ‘in order to’, same-subject converb construction with *ngenin* ‘pray-CVB’, different-subject temporal linkage with *ahih ciangin* ‘when’, prenominal relative clauses with *a bawl mi* ‘person who’, and nominalization-plus-case forms with *muhna-ah* ‘in seeing / in the sight’ remain explicit boundaries. The section stays narrow without attempting a full complex-sentence, switch-reference, relative-clause, or nominalized-clause chapter.

3.14.2 Core temporal subordination: ciangin

The suffix *ciangin* ‘when’ is the safest productive anchor for clause linkage and forms temporal subordinate clauses. The form *tua ciangin* ‘then / when’ with segmentation *tua ciang-in* ‘that when-ERG’ is the clearest compact anchor for temporal subordination, and it appears consistently across Bible texts.

The same morphology appears in patterns such as *ahih ciangin* ‘when it was’ where a relative marker *ahih* precedes the subordinator, showing how temporal linkage interacts with relative-clause structure. Together they support a grammar-facing claim for controlled temporal subordination without forcing a full inventory of all subordination outcomes.

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current status	Boundary issue
ciangin	temporal subordination	clause-final temporal marker	supported core	broader clause-linkage inventory remains open
tua ciangin	controlled temporal subordination	compact clause-linking anchor	supported core	same *-in* suffix appears in other contexts
ciang-in	segmented form	morpheme analysis	supported core	*-in* suffix has broader uses

The following example illustrates temporal subordination with the clearest Old Testament anchor:

(3.178)

Pasian	*ìn,*	*khuavak*	*ōm*	*hèn”*	*cí*	*hì;*	*túa*	*cìang-ìn*	*khuavak*	*ōm*	*pah*	*hì.*
God	ERG	light	exist	JUSS	say	DECL	DIST	then-ERG	light	exist	do.so	DECL

‘And God said, ”Let there be light:” and there was light.’ (Genesis 1:3)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

3.14.3 Purposive or clause-bound irrealis boundary: dingin

Dingin ‘in order to’ is relevant to clause linkage because it marks purposive or clause-bound irrealis use, but it remains partly shared with the TAM system. At the current maturity level, *dingin* is visible only as a caveated boundary row: it helps show that clause linkage interacts with purposive and irrealis marking, but it does not yet justify a broader clause-linkage or TAM rewrite.

The grammar claim stays cautious on purpose. The form *dingin* with segmentation *ding-in* ‘IRR-ERG’ shows the same *-in* ‘ergative / agentive’ suffix as temporal *ciangin*, but the theoretical status of *-in* across these contexts remains open.

(3.179) *Pasian ìn, sun lè zān à khen dìng-ìn vantung-àh khuavak-tè ōm hèn;*
God ERG basket and break 3SG divide IRR-ERG heaven-LOC light-PL exist JUSS
‘And God said, ”Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night...”’ (Genesis 1:14)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

3.14.4 Same-subject converb linkage boundary: VERB-in and ngenin

Same-subject clause chaining is marked by the converb suffix *-in* ‘converbial / linking’ on the first verb. The pattern is notated as *VERB-in* ‘converb’ (e.g., *ngenin* ‘pray-CVB’), indicating that the subject of the linked clause is identical to the subject of the following main clause. The form *ngenin* ‘pray-CVB’ is the clearest anchor example.

This material remains boundary-only in the present account because the exact status of *-in* as converb, subordinator, or broader linker still needs clearer theoretical control. Treating same-subject chaining as a settled part of clause linkage would require closing the converb-versus-subordination question first.

(3.180) *Egypt gàm khèmpeuh à kial cìang-ìn, àn ngen-ìn mì-tè Faro’ tùngàh kiko ùh hì.*
EGYPT land all 3SG hunger then-ERG 3PL.POSS net-IN person-PL FARO.POSS on-LOC cry.out 2/3PL DECL
‘And when all the land of Egypt was famished, the people cried to Pharaoh for bread...’ (Genesis 41:55)

No equally clean Gospel example of same-subject converb construction is currently used for this boundary row.

3.14.5 Different-subject temporal linkage boundary: ahih ciangin

Different-subject temporal linkage uses *ahih ciangin* ‘when / when it was’ where a relative marker *ahih* precedes the temporal subordinator *ciangin*. This construction marks temporal clauses with different subjects from the main clause.

The construction is important structurally, but it remains boundary material because different-subject linkage still overlaps with relative-marker use and pronominal material. The form *ahih* functions as a relative marker (glossed as a third-person plural or relative form) rather than as a dedicated different-subject marker.

(3.181) *Túa àhìh cìang-ìn Pasian ìn tùi-pì ganhing gol-pì-tè lè àmau nām ciatin tùi-pì sùng-àh tampi.*
DIST be.3SG.REL then-ERG God ERG water-big animal creature-great-PL and 3PL.PRO nation each.kind.ERG water-big inside-LOC many
‘And God created great whales, and every living creature that moveth, which the waters brought forth...’ (Genesis 1:21)

No equally clean Gospel example of different-subject temporal linkage with *ahih ciangin* is currently used for this construction.

3.14.6 Prenominal relative-clause boundary: a bawl mi

The prenominal relative clause uses the relativizer prefix *a-* to mark a relative verb, with the head noun following. The form *a bawl mi* 'person who makes' is the clearest anchor, showing how relative clauses with human head nouns are formed.

This material remains boundary-only because relative clauses still interact with prefix/agreement and nominalization material. Settling relative-clause structure requires clearer boundary control with the prefix system.

(3.182) *pāk-nam-tui à bāwl mì peuhmah*
ointment 3SG make person whosoever
'whoever makes any like it' (Exodus 30:38)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

3.14.7 Nominalized relative and clause-like form boundary: omna

The form *omna* 'place / being / existence' is a nominalized relative or clause-derived form. It appears in patterns like *omna mun* where it marks a location or predication related to a nominalized clause.

This material belongs to the overlap between nominalization and relative-clause structure. Settling *omna* as a nominalized relative would require fuller boundary control with the nominalization section, which is why it remains explicitly boundary material here.

3.14.8 Nominalization-plus-case boundary: muhna-ah

Forms such as *muhna-ah* 'in seeing / in the sight of' combine nominalization with locative case-like morphology. The form shows nominalizer *-na* 'nominalizer' plus locative *-ah* 'locative / goal-like', creating sight-expressions used in temporal or spatial adjuncts.

This material is structurally mixed because it belongs partly with case marking and partly with clause linkage. For that reason, this section treats it as boundary evidence rather than as a core clause-linkage subtype.

(3.183) *Tù-ìn Pasian' mùh-ná-àh léi-tùng sía à.*
now-ERG God.POSS see.II-NMLZ-LOC land-on evil 3SG
'Now the earth was corrupt in the sight of God.' (Genesis 6:11)

A Gospel parallel shows the same nominalization-plus-case boundary in a different context:

(3.184) *kèima mùh-ná-àh thàt ùn.*
1SG.self see.II-NMLZ-LOC kill IMP.PL
'kill them before me.' (Luke 19:27)

3.14.9 Deferred and boundary material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- *ciangin* and *tua ciangin* support a controlled temporal subordination core, but they do not by themselves settle the full clause-linkage paradigm or resolve whether subordinators form a unified system.
- *dingin* remains a boundary row until the irrealis and purposive layers are clearer.
- *VERB-in* and *ngenin* remain boundary material until the converb-versus-subordination distinction is theoretically settled.
- *ahih ciangin* 'when / when it was' remains a boundary form shared with relative-marker and pronominal material.
- *a bawl mi* and *omna* remain boundary forms shared with relative-clause and nominalization structure.
- *muhna-ah* remains a boundary form shared with case marking and nominalization.

- *leh* ‘if / when / conditional’ remains outside because sentence-final-particle, coordinator, and subordinator analyses still overlap.
- *hangin* ‘because / causal’ and *bangin* ‘like / as / comparative’ remain broader report-inventory rows rather than the first safe clause-linkage anchors.
- full switch-reference system claims remain deferred.
- full relative-clause system claims remain deferred.
- broader discourse-level linkage remains outside this controlled sentence-level slice.
- Raw occurrence counts are not treated as grammar facts without constructional control.

3.14.10 Summary

The safest grammar-facing conclusion is that Tedim has controlled evidence for temporal subordination with *ciangin* ‘when’, with *tua ciangin* ‘then / when’ as a compact anchor showing clause-final temporal marking. Purposive material with *dingin*, same-subject converb construction with *ngenin*, different-subject marking with *ahih ciangin*, relative clauses with *a bawl mi*, nominalized relatives with *omna*, and nominalization-plus-case forms with *muhna-ah* remain explicit boundaries so the section stays controlled.

3.15 Same-subject and different-subject clause linkage

The current clause-linkage evidence is narrow: same-subject *bawlin* ‘make-CVB’ and *semin* ‘serve-CVB’ are secure, *bawlin* is printed as a trimmed excerpt because Genesis 11:4 is crowded with boundary *-in* tokens, *semin* is kept in full because the Deuteronomy chain is already compact, the report-level *VERB-in* ‘converb’ label is only a comparison term, *ahih ciangin* ‘when / when it was’ is support only, and ordinary *ciangin* ‘when’, *dingin* ‘in order to / clause-bound irrealis’, *ngenin* ‘pray-CVB’, *a bawl mi* ‘person who’, *omna* ‘place / being / existence’, and *muhna-ah* ‘in seeing / in the sight’ stay boundary-controlled. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

3.15.1 Overview of the current evidence

The report calls this domain switch reference, but the safer grammar-facing label is same-subject and different-subject clause linkage. The secure core is same-subject converb-like linkage; *ahih ciangin* remains support only; ordinary *ciangin*, purposive *dingin*, blocked *ngenin*, and relative / nominalized material stay boundary-controlled. No full switch-reference system is claimed.

Current display inventory

Form or pattern	Bible source	Target token	Nearby *-in* control	Display status	Subject relation
bawlin	Genesis 11:4	*bawl-in*	*amaute in* = ERG; *nadingin* = PURP/ERG; *a dawn in* = ERG; *lamin* = directional; target converb isolated in the excerpt	promoted; trimmed excerpt	same
semin	Deuteronomy 10:20	*sem-in*	*beel-in* = boundary/unresolved; repeated *na* = 2SG agreement (not a target *-in*)	promoted; full verse justified	same

Form or pattern	Bible source	Target token	Nearby *-in* control	Display status	Subject relation
ahih ciangin	Genesis 1:21	*ciang-in*	*Pasian in* = ERG; *ahih* = relative marker; no dedicated DS *-in*	support only; table row only	ambiguous
ngenin	Genesis 41:55	*ngen-in*	*ciang-in* = temporal boundary; analyzer split *net-IN* / *pray-CVB*	blocked; table row only	unrecoverable
ciangin	Genesis 1:3	*ciang-in*	*Pasian in* = ERG	boundary row only	not diagnostic
dingin	Genesis 1:14	*ding-in*	*Pasian in* = ERG; *vantung-ah* = locative	boundary row only	not diagnostic
a bawl mi	Exodus 30:38	n/a	relative-marker *a-* and head noun boundary	boundary row only	not diagnostic
omna	Genesis 4:16	n/a	nominalized clause boundary	boundary row only	not diagnostic
muhna-ah	Genesis 6:11	n/a	nominalization-plus-case boundary	boundary row only	not diagnostic

Promoted same-subject evidence *bawlin* 'make-CVB' is the clearest same-subject anchor because the same *eite* 'we.INCL' controller continues into the following *bawl ni* clause. The verse is trimmed for display so the target *bawl-in* is not buried under other boundary *-in* tokens.

(3.185) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:sr-bawlin-gen11p4: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

.	*khùa-pì*	*khàt*	*bāwl-ìn.*	*eite'*	*minthan*	*nàdìng*	*khàt*	*bāwl*	*nì.*
village-big	one	make-CVB	1PL.PRO.POSS	bless	PURP	one	make	day	

'... let us build us a city... and let us make us a name...' (Genesis 11:4)

The full verse contains nearby boundary *-in* tokens (*amaute in*, *nadingin*, *a dawn in*, *lamin*), but they are not the target converb.

semin 'serve-CVB' is the other secure same-subject anchor. The current verse keeps the same *note* controller across the clause chain, and *beel-in* is boundary material rather than a second converb anchor.

(3.186)

Topa	*nòtè'*	*Pasian*	*nà*	*zah-tàk*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*à,*	*àmà*	*nà*	*sèm-ìn,*	*àmàh*
Lord	2PL.PRO.POSS	God	2SG	fear-true	IRR	2/3PL	3SG	3SG.POSS	2SG	serve-CVB	3SG.PRO

beel-ìn,	*àmà*	*mīn*	*tàwh*	*nà*	*ki-ciam*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*hì.*
pan-ERG	3SG.POSS	name	COM	2SG	covenant	IRR	2/3PL	DECL

'Thou shalt fear the LORD thy God; him shalt thou serve, and to him shalt thou cleave, and swear by his name.' (Deuteronomy 10:20)

The person glossing stays *2SG* for *na* to match the prefix/agreement slice, and the verse is kept in full because the same-subject chain is already compact enough to read cleanly.

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

Support-only and boundary material *ahih ciangin* stays support only. It is source-resolved, but the construction is temporally framed and does not independently prove a dedicated different-subject marker.

Ordinary *ciangin* remains the temporal subordinator; *dingin* remains purposive / clause-bound irrealis material; *ngenin* stays blocked because the analyzer export splits *net-IN* and *pray-CVB*. Relative-clause and nominalization material (*a bawl mi*, *omna*, *muhna-ah*) stays outside the core subject-tracking claim.

Deferred material This section does not claim a full switch-reference system, full subordination chapter, full relative-clause chapter, full converb chapter, or full discourse system.

4 Clause type, discourse-facing material, and expressive morphology

4.1 Negation

The current negation evidence supports a three-way core around *lo* 'NEG' for ordinary clause negation, *loh* 'dependent / derived NEG' in dependent environments, and *kei* 'NEG / prohibitive NEG' in prohibitives and irrealis-heavy negative contexts.

4.1.1 Overview of negation in Tedim

Tedim negation is not reducible to *lo* 'NEG' alone. The current controlled evidence supports at least three major zones: ordinary clause-level negation with *lo* 'NEG', dependent or derived negation with *loh* 'dependent / derived NEG', and *kei* 'NEG / prohibitive NEG' in prohibitives and other irrealis-heavy negative environments (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017).

4.1.2 Negation inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
lo	clause-level NEG	*thusim lo hi*	core	not the whole system
lo hi	NEG DECL	*kigen thei lo hi*	core	overlaps with sentence-final declarative material
loh	dependent / derived NEG	*zuih loh nadingin*	core	not a free alternant of ordinary *lo*
loh ding-a	NEG.DEP IRR-LOC/FUNC	*nek loh ding-a*	core	overlaps with TAM and purposive linkage
kei	NEG / prohibitive NEG	*su kei in*	core	also appears outside strict prohibitives
kei in	NEG IMP.SG	*pau kei in*	core	imperative-only shape
kei un	NEG IMP.PL	*kihta kei un*	core	imperative-only shape
om lo hi	not exist / be absent	*tui om lo hi*	core	existential boundary with possession

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
nei lo hi	not have	*aana nei lo hi*	core	possession boundary
nawn lo	no longer / not again	*om nawn lo hi*	core	constructional, not a new basic negator
thei lo	cannot / not know	*thei lo hi*	core	ability overlaps with modal subsystem
theih loh	dependent inability / not being able	*sep theih loh*	core	dependent form overlaps with linkage
kuamah	nobody	*kuamah mu lo*	core with filtering	needs licensing context
bangmah	nothing	*bangmah om lo hi*	core with filtering	has non-NPI uses such as *tua bangmah hi-in*

4.1.3 Clause-level negation with *lo*

Lo 'NEG' is the safest ordinary clause-level negator, and *lo hi* 'NEG DECL' is common in straightforward predicate negation.

Genesis 4:5 gives a compact clause-level OT anchor.

(4.187) *Kain lè àmà pìak-ná thusim lò hì.*
KAIN and 3SG.POSS give.to-NMLZ parable NEG DECL
'he had not respect for Cain and his offering.' (Genesis 4:5)

Matthew 2:10 gives a Gospel comparandum in the same clause-level zone.

(4.188) *Túa aksi à mùh ùh cìang-ìn à lungdam-ná ùh ki-gēn théi lò hì.*
DIST star 3SG see.II 2/3PL then-ERG 3SG rejoice-NMLZ 2/3PL conversation know NEG DECL

'their joy could not be told.' (Matthew 2:10)

4.1.4 Dependent and derived negation with *loh*

Loh 'dependent / derived NEG' is distinct from ordinary *lo*, and the pattern *loh ding-a* 'NEG.DEP IRR-LOC/FUNC' and related purposive shapes are central in dependent negation.

Genesis 3:11 gives the OT dependent-negation anchor.

(4.189) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-loh: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Nà nèk lòh dìng-à kòng thupiak singgah né khá nà hì hìam?
2SG eat.II NEG-NOM IRR-LOC 1SG→3 commandment hang eat NEG.PERF 2SG DECL Q

'that thou shouldest not eat?' (Genesis 3:11)

Matthew 5:19 gives a Gospel dependent-negation comparandum.

(4.190) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-loh-matt5-19: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Midang-tè	*ìn*	*zòng*	*à*	*zùih*	*lòh*	*nàdìngìn*	*à*	*gēn*	*mì-tè*	*pèn*
other.person-PL	ERG	also	3SG	follow-NOM	NEG-NOM	PURP.ERG	3SG	speak	person-PL	TOP
mì	*néu-pèn*	*hì*	*dìng*	*ùh*	*hì.*					
person	small-TOP	DECL	IRR	2/3PL	DECL					

'those who teach others not to keep them will be called least.' (Matthew 5:19)

4.1.5 *kei* in prohibitives and irrealis-heavy negation

Kei 'NEG / prohibitive NEG' is central in prohibitives, especially *kei in* 'NEG IMP.SG' and *kei un* 'NEG IMP.PL', and it also appears in broader irrealis-heavy negative environments.

Genesis 22:12 gives the core OT prohibitive anchor.

(4.191)

Tangval-pà	*sù*	*kèi*	*ìn.*	*Àmà*	*tùngàh*	*bangmah*	*híh*	*kèi*	*ìn.*
youth-father	tear	NEG	ERG	3SG.POSS	on-LOC	nothing	PROX	NEG	ERG

'Do not strike the boy; do not do anything to him.' (Genesis 22:12)

Mark 1:25 gives a compact Gospel prohibitive comparandum.

(4.192)

Pau	*kèi*	*ìn;*	*híh*	*mipa*	*sùng*	*pàn-ìn*	*pái-khìa*	*ìn.*
PAU	NEG	ERG	PROX	man	inside	ABL-ERG	go-exit	ERG

'Be silent, and come out of him.' (Mark 1:25)

4.1.6 Ordinary plural negative predicates are not automatically prohibitive

The pattern *V lo uh* is not automatically a prohibitive. Genesis 2:25 *maizum lo uh hi* 'they were not ashamed' is an ordinary declarative plural negative predicate, not a directive, and Gospel clauses such as Matthew 13:17 *mu lo uh* show the same non-prohibitive negative profile.

4.1.7 Negative existence and absence

Negative existence and absence are commonly expressed with *om lo hi* 'not exist / be absent' and *nei lo hi* 'not have'.

Genesis 37:24 gives an OT existential-negation anchor.

(4.193) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-om-lo-gen37-24: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Khu	*sùng-àh*	*tùi*	*ōm*	*lò*	*hì.*
smoke	inside-LOC	water	exist	NEG	DECL

'there was no water in the pit.' (Genesis 37:24)

John 14:30 gives a Gospel possession-negation comparandum.

(4.194)

Àmàh	*ìn*	*kèima*	*tùngàh*	*à-ana*	*néi*	*lò*	*hì.*
3SG.PRO	ERG	1SG.self	on-LOC	3SG-child.PL	have	NEG	DECL

'he has no claim on me.' (John 14:30)

4.1.8 Cessative *nawn lo*

Nawn lo ‘no longer / not again’ is best treated as a constructional negation pattern, not as a separate basic negator.

Genesis 8:12 gives the OT cessative anchor.

(4.195) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-nawn-lo-gen8-12: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Túa	*vachuang*	*hòng*	*ciah-kík*	*nàwn*	*lò*	*hì.*
DIST	?	3→1	return-ITER	CONT	NEG	DECL

‘the dove did not return again.’ (Genesis 8:12)

Matthew 28:6 gives a Gospel cessative comparandum.

(4.196)

Àmàh	*ōm*	*nàwn*	*lò*	*hì.*
3SG.PRO	exist	CONT	NEG	DECL

‘he is no longer here.’ (Matthew 28:6)

4.1.9 Ability and inability

The ability pair *thei lo* ‘cannot / not know’ and *theih loh* ‘not being able / dependent inability’ is a productive part of negation, and the dependent form should not be collapsed into ordinary clause-level *thei lo*.

Genesis 27:23 gives a compact OT ability-negation anchor.

(4.197)

Àmàh	*ìn*	*théi*	*lò*	*hì.*
3SG.PRO	ERG	know	NEG	DECL

‘he did not recognize him.’ (Genesis 27:23)

John 9:4 gives a Gospel dependent-ability comparandum.

(4.198) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:neg-theih-loh-john9-4: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Kuamah	*ìn*	*nà*	*à*	*sep*	*thèih*	*lòh*	*zān*	*hùn*	*hòng*	*tùng*	*dìng*	*hì.*
nobody	ERG	2SG	3SG	work	know.II	NEG-NOM	break	time	3→1	on	IRR	DECL

‘night is coming when no one can work.’ (John 9:4)

4.1.10 Negative polarity items

The forms *kuamah* ‘nobody’ and *bangmah* ‘nothing’ are included here only with filtered, manually checked negative-licensing contexts; raw exact-string counts overgenerate, and *bangmah* has non-NPI uses such as *tua bangmah hi-in* ‘likewise / in that way’.

Exodus 2:12 gives a filtered OT *kuamah* example.

(4.199)

Kuamah	*mú*	*lò*	*àhìh*	*màn-ìn*	*Egypt*	*mipa*	*thàt-ìn*	*sehnel*	*sùng-àh*	*à*
nobody	see.I	NEG	be.3SG.REL	reason-ERG	EGYPT	man	kill-CVB	wilderness	inside-LOC	3SG

seel	*hì.*
hide	DECL

‘he saw that there was no man, and hid the Egyptian in the sand.’ (Exodus 2:12)

Matthew 22:46 gives a filtered Gospel *kuamah* comparandum.

(4.200)

Kuamah	*ìn*	*àmà*	*thù-dot-ná*	*kam-khàt*	*beek*	*dawng*	*théi*	*lò*	*ùh*	*hì.*
nobody	ERG	3SG.POSS	word-ask-NMLZ	word-one	only	receive	know	NEG	2/3PL	DECL

‘no one could answer him a word.’ (Matthew 22:46)

4.1.11 Deferred material

Several issues remain outside the present account. The present section does not reopen a full TAM chapter, a full clause-linkage chapter, a full imperative-mood chapter, or a full polarity-licensing typology; it only marks the boundaries needed to keep *lo*, *loh*, *kei*, negative existence, ability-negation, and filtered NPIs in a coherent grammar-facing description.

4.2 Interrogatives

The current interrogative evidence is strongest for clause-final *hiam* 'question particle' and WH + *hiam* content questions, with core *bang* 'what', *kua* 'who', *bangci* 'how', and *banghangin* 'why', while *bang hiam cih* 'what ... saying', *bangmah* 'nothing', *bangin* 'as / how', and the comparison-particle forms *maw* 'question/comparison particle', *ham* 'question/comparison particle', and *em* 'question/comparison particle' stay at the boundary.

4.2.1 Overview of interrogatives in Tedim

This section treats clause-final *hiam* 'question particle' and selected WH + *hiam* content questions. It keeps *bang* 'what', *kua* 'who', *bangci* 'how', and *banghangin* 'why' at the core, while *bang hiam cih* 'what... saying', *bangmah* 'nothing', *bangin* 'as / how', and the comparison-particle forms *maw* 'question/comparison particle', *ham* 'question/comparison particle', and *em* 'question/comparison particle' stay at the boundary.

The inventory below keeps the set compact. Raw counts are not treated as grammar facts here.

Interrogative inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
hiam	question particle	Genesis 24:23; Matthew 6:25	stable	clause-final yes/no marker
bang	what	Exodus 16:15; Matthew 6:31	stable with caveat	overlaps with *bangmah* 'nothing' and *bangin* 'as / how'
kua	who	Genesis 48:8; Matthew 16:15	stable with caveat	analyzer sometimes tags *kua* as *NUM*
bangci	how	Genesis 3:13; Matthew 12:26	stable	should not be flattened into generic *bang*
banghangin	why	Genesis 4:6; Matthew 6:28	stable with caveat	should not be merged with formulaic *Bang hang hiam cih leh*
bang hiam cih	what… saying / embedded-question boundary	Exodus 16:15; Luke 23:34	boundary	complements under *thei lo* or speech frames
Bang hang hiam cih leh	because / for this reason	Genesis 3:20	blocked	formulaic reason frame, not ordinary question evidence
langnih a hiam namsau	two-edged sword	Revelation 1:16	blocked	lexical *hiam*, not interrogative *hiam*
a hiam ciat uh	each of them	2 Kings 11:11	blocked	lexical *hiam*, not interrogative *hiam*

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
bangmah	nothing	Genesis 9:21	boundary	negative-indefinite rather than interrogative *bang*
bangin	as / how	Genesis 1:7; Exodus 14:30	boundary	manner/comparison/clause-linkage use
maw	question/comparison particle	report-backed comparison material	deferred	comparison-particle analysis not yet set out
ham	question/comparison particle	report-backed comparison material	deferred	comparison-particle analysis not yet set out
em	question/comparison particle	report-backed comparison material	deferred	comparison-particle analysis not yet set out

Clause-final *hiam* 'question particle' Clause-final *hiam* is the safest yes/no question marker in the current evidence. It also appears with some WH questions, but the independent-clause pattern is the clearest place to start.

(4.201) **[REVIEW PREVIEW WARNING: ex:int-hiam-gen24-23: Bible reference mapped, but slice example is not a direct verse span; analyzed slice wording]**

Nà	*pà*	*ínn-àh*	*kòtè*	*giah*	*nàdìng*	*à*	*áwng*	*dìng*	*hìam*
2SG	father	house-LOC	1PL.PRO	camp	PURP	3SG	open	IRR	Q

'Is there room in your father's house for us to stay?' (Genesis 24:23)

Matthew 6:25 gives a Gospel yes/no question with the same clause-final *hiam* pattern, so the distribution is not confined to a single narrative window.

(4.202)

Nuntak-ná	*pèn*	*àn*	*sàng-ìn*	*thù-pì-zàw*	*à,*	*pumpi*	*pèn*	*pùan*	*sàng-ìn*
live-NMLZ	TOP	3PL.POSS	high-ERG	word-big-more	3SG	body	TOP	cloth	high-ERG

thù-pì-zàw	*hì*	*lò*	*àhì*	*hìam?*
word-big-more	DECL	NEG	be.3SG	Q

'Is not life more important than food, and the body more important than clothing?' (Matthew 6:25)

WH + *hiam* content questions The content-question pattern is WH + *hiam*. The forms below are the current core WH inventory in this section. *Bang* 'what' and *kua* 'who' are the simplest members of the set; *bangci* 'how' and *banghangin* 'why' show that the same question marker can attach to different semantic relations.

***bang* 'what'** *Bang* is the clearest what-question word. It can appear in a very short clause or inside a longer question frame.

(4.203)

Bàng	*àhì*	*hìam?*
like	be.3SG	Q

'What is it?' (Exodus 16:15)

Matthew 6:31 shows *bang* in a longer Gospel question frame.

(4.204) *Bàng né dìng à, bàng dawn dìng à, bàng silh dìng ì-hí hìam?*
like eat IRR 3SG like top IRR 3SG like clothe IRR 1PL.INCL-be Q
‘What shall we eat, what shall we drink, and what shall we wear?’ (Matthew 6:31)

***kua* ‘who’** *Kua* is the core who-question word. The analyzer sometimes tags it as *NUM*, but that export label does not change the clause-level reading.

(4.205) *Híh-tè kua àhì hìam?*
PROX-PL who be.3SG Q
‘Who are these?’ (Genesis 48:8)

Matthew 16:15 gives a Gospel counterpart with the same question word.

(4.206) *Túa ahihleh nòtè ìn kèi kua hì hòng cí nà hì ùh hìam?*
DIST if 2PL.PRO ERG NEG who DECL 3→1 say 2SG DECL 2/3PL Q
‘But who do you say that I am?’ (Matthew 16:15)

***bangci* ‘how’** *Bangci* stays visible as *bangci* rather than being flattened into generic *bang*. It is the clearest manner-question item in the current evidence.

(4.207) *Bangci à hi-cí gàm-tat nà hì hìam?*
how 3SG PROX-say land-rule 2SG DECL Q
‘How have you acted thus?’ (Genesis 3:13)

Matthew 12:26 keeps the same *bangci* pattern visible in Gospel material.

(4.208) *Túa màh bàng-ìn Satan lè Satan kī-hawlkhia lè-ùh à ukna bangci*
DIST EMPH like-ERG SATAN and SATAN REFL-drive.out and-PL.IMP 3SG rule.NMLZ how
kip thèih dìng àhì hìam?
firm know.II IRR be.3SG Q
‘How then can Satan cast out Satan?’ (Matthew 12:26)

***banghangin* ‘why’** *Banghangin* remains a reason-question item. The segmented form is slightly noisy, but the clause-level reading is still clear.

(4.209) *bàng hàng-ìn nà mái sía àhì hìam*
like because-ERG 2SG face evil be.3SG Q
‘Why is your countenance fallen?’ (Genesis 4:6)

Matthew 6:28 is a Gospel counterpart with the same reason-question pattern.

(4.210) *Bàng hàng-ìn pùan-silh dìng lùng-himawh nà hì ùh hìam?*
like because-ERG cloth-wrap IRR heart-fear 2SG DECL 2/3PL Q
‘Why are you anxious about clothing?’ (Matthew 6:28)

Embedded-question boundary *Bang hiam cih* ‘what... saying’ belongs at the embedded-question boundary, not in the independent-clause pattern. The current evidence shows this most clearly where *thei lo* ‘do not know’ governs the embedded question.

(4.211) *bàng hìam cìh théi lò ùh hì*
like Q say.NOM know NEG 2/3PL DECL
‘They did not know what it was.’ (Exodus 16:15)

Luke 23:34 shows the same boundary in a Gospel frame.

(4.212) *Pà àw, àmaute ìn bàng híh ì-hí hìam cìh théi lò ùh*
father voice 3PL.PRO ERG like PROX 1PL.INCL-be Q say.NOM know NEG 2/3PL
àhìh màn-ìn à màwh-ná ùh nà mái-sàk ìn
be.3SG.REL reason-ERG 3SG err-NMLZ 2/3PL 2SG face-CAUS ERG
'Father, forgive them, for they know not what they are doing.' (Luke 23:34)

Blocked false friends and non-interrogative *hiam* *Bang hang hiam cih leh* 'because / for this reason' is a formulaic reason frame, not an ordinary question. *Langnih a hiam namsau* 'two-edged sword' (Revelation 1:16) and *a hiam ciat uh* 'each of them' (2 Kings 11:11) are lexical *hiam* controls. *Bangmah* 'nothing' (Genesis 9:21) and *bangin* 'as / how' (Genesis 1:7; Exodus 14:30) are boundary forms rather than core interrogatives.

Deferred comparison particles *Maw* 'question/comparison particle', *ham* 'question/comparison particle', and *em* 'question/comparison particle' remain deferred. The current evidence is enough to keep them visible, but not enough to build a separate comparison-particle account.

Deferred material Several issues remain outside the present account.

4.3 Sentence-final particles

The current sentence-final evidence is strongest for controlled clause-final uses of *ahi hi* 'be.3SG DECL / it was', *lo hi* 'NEG DECL', *hen* 'jussive / optative', *in* 'imperative / second-person singular imperative boundary', and *un* 'plural imperative', while *hiam* 'question particle', *aw* 'vocative / exclamative boundary', *tahen* 'deferred jussive-looking form', *ta* 'perfective / change-of-state boundary', and *zo* 'completive boundary' remain overlap or deferred material.

4.3.1 Overview of sentence-final particles in Tedim

This section treats a small controlled set of sentence-final or clause-final material: *hi* 'declarative', *ahi hi* 'be.3SG DECL / it was', *lo hi* 'NEG DECL', *hen* 'jussive / optative', *in* 'imperative / second-person singular imperative boundary', and *un* 'plural imperative'. It keeps *hiam* 'question particle', *aw* 'vocative / exclamative boundary', *tahen* 'deferred jussive-looking form', *ta* 'perfective / change-of-state boundary', and *zo* 'completive boundary' as overlap or deferred material. The section does not present the whole mood, aspect, TAM, negation, or interrogative system.

4.3.2 Sentence-final particle inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
hi	declarative	Genesis 1:13; Matthew 1:1	supported with caveat	discussed through *ahi hi*, not as unrestricted bare *hi*
ahi hi	be.3SG DECL / it was	Genesis 1:13; Matthew 1:1	stable with caveat	bundles copular *ahi* and clause-final *hi*
lo hi	NEG DECL	Genesis 4:5; Matthew 2:10	stable with caveat	overlaps with the negation system
hen	jussive / optative	Genesis 1:3; Matthew 6:9	stable with caveat	not expanded into a full mood chapter

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
in	imperative / second-person singular imperative boundary	Genesis 6:14; Luke 23:34	supported with caveat	analyzer export overlap with case-like `ERG/FUNC`
un	plural imperative	Psalms 100:1; Matthew 3:3	stable	imperative plural form, often near vocative material
hiam	question particle	Genesis 48:8	boundary	handled in interrogatives, not reanalyzed here
aw	vocative / exclamative boundary	Psalms 100:1; Matthew 1:20	boundary	vocative and lexical overlap
tahen	deferred jussive-looking form	Genesis 9:25; Luke 9:60	deferred	fused *tahen* vs split *ta hen* and export noise
ta	perfective / change-of-state boundary	Genesis 40:23; Matthew 14:15	deferred boundary	TAM overlap and noisy export
zo	completive boundary	Genesis 1:28	deferred boundary	lexical/export ambiguity remains visible

4.3.3 Declarative *hi* with copula overlap

Clause-final *hi* is safest here when discussed through *ahi hi* 'be.3SG DECL / it was'. The section therefore keeps copular overlap explicit and does not treat every *hi* token as a settled sentence-final declarative marker.

(4.213) *àhì* *hì*
be.3SG DECL
'it was' (Genesis 1:13)

Matthew 1:1 gives a Gospel counterpart in the same copula-plus-declarative frame.

(4.214) *híh* *bàng* *àhì* *hì*
PROX like be.3SG DECL
'it is thus / this is how it is' (Matthew 1:1)

4.3.4 Negative-plus-declarative *lo hi*

Lo hi 'NEG DECL' is treated as a negation-plus-declarative overlap point. This section keeps the overlap visible and does not reopen the full negation account.

(4.215) *thusim* *lò* *hì*
parable NEG DECL
'it was not accepted' (Genesis 4:5)

Matthew 2:10 gives a Gospel clause with the same *lo hi* pattern.

(4.216) *ki-gēn* *théi* *lò* *hì*
conversation know NEG DECL
'it cannot be fully told' (Matthew 2:10)

4.3.5 Optative or jussive *hen*

Hen 'jussive / optative' is included for controlled optative-like clause-final usage. The section keeps this narrow and does not widen it into a full mood system.

(4.217) *Khuavak* *ōm* *hèn*
light exist JUSS
'let there be light' (Genesis 1:3)

Matthew 6:9 gives a Gospel jussive prayer frame with the same clause-final *hen*.

(4.218) *nà* *mīn* *sìangtho* *kī-zahtak* *hèn*
2SG name holy REFL-honor JUSS
'hallowed be your name' (Matthew 6:9)

4.3.6 Imperative *in* and *un*

In 'imperative / second-person singular imperative boundary' and *un* 'plural imperative' are both visible in controlled clauses. For *in*, the case-like analyzer/export overlap remains explicit. For *un*, the clause-final imperative plural use is cleaner.

(4.219) *teembaw* *khàt* *bāwl* *ìn*
ark one make ERG
'make an ark' (Genesis 6:14)

Luke 23:34 keeps the same imperative boundary with *in* in Gospel speech.

(4.220) *à* *màwh-ná* *ùh* *nà* *mái-sàk* *ìn*
3SG err-NMLZ 2/3PL 2SG face-CAUS ERG
'forgive their sin' (Luke 23:34)

Psalms 100:1 provides the current controlled Old Testament plural-imperative *un* anchor.

(4.221) *ging-sàk* *ùn*
sound-CAUS IMP.PL
'make a joyful noise' (Psalms 100:1)

Matthew 3:3 gives a Gospel plural-imperative counterpart with clause-final *un*.

(4.222) *lam-pì* *tāng-sàk* *ùn*
road give-CAUS IMP.PL
'make his paths straight' (Matthew 3:3)

4.3.7 *Hiam* as interrogatives overlap

Hiam 'question particle' remains a cross-reference boundary with interrogatives. The clause *Hihte kua ahi hiam?* (Genesis 48:8) stays useful as overlap control, but this section does not reopen independent *hiam* analysis.

4.3.8 *Aw* as vocative or exclamative boundary

Aw 'vocative / exclamative' remains boundary material here. *Gam khempeuh aw* 'all lands!' (Psalms 100:1) and *David suan Josef aw* 'Joseph, son of David!' (Matthew 1:20) show vocative force, but they do not yet justify a broader sentence-final mood claim.

4.3.9 *Tahen*, *ta*, and *zo* as deferred TAM-overlap material

Tahen 'deferred jussive-looking form' remains unresolved because fused *tahen* and split *ta hen* material are still noisy in the current evidence. *Ta* 'perfective / change-of-state boundary' remains boundary material where clause-final *ta hi* overlaps TAM. *Zo* 'completive boundary' remains deferred where lexical/export ambiguity is still visible.

4.3.10 Deferred material

Several issues remain outside the present account.

- Broader interactions among sentence-final particles, clause type, and discourse structure remain outside this section.
- The present section does not settle the full relation between sentence-final material and TAM or negation.
- Further treatment of rare or noisy clause-final forms remains deferred until cleaner controlled evidence is available.

4.4 Coordinators

The current coordinators evidence is strongest for NP coordination with *le* 'and (NP coordinator)', while *leh* 'if / when', sequential *a* 'sequential linker with 3SG/FUNC overlap', and *mawh* 'deferred disjunction material' remain boundary or deferred material, and *Ahih hangin* 'but / however' plus *ahih kei leh* 'otherwise / if not' remain caveated connector patterns.

4.4.1 Overview of coordinators in Tedim

This section keeps coordination narrowly constructional. *le* 'and (NP coordinator)' is the clean noun-phrase anchor, while *leh* 'if / when' and sequential *a* 'sequential linker with 3SG/FUNC overlap' stay boundary-controlled. *mawh* 'deferred disjunction material' remains deferred. *Ahih hangin* 'but / however' and *ahih kei leh* 'otherwise / if not' are treated as caveated connector material (Henderson, 1965; Cing, 2017). This section does not present a full coordination, subordination, converb, or discourse system.

4.4.2 Coordinator inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
le	NP coordination	*vantung le leitung*; *Van le lei*	core	limited to clean NP coordination claims
leh	conditional / boundary linker	*veilam na lak leh kei taklamah ka pai ding hi*	boundary	do not flatten conditional *leh* into simple clause conjunction
a	sequential linker	*luang a tua mun panin gun hong kikhenin*	boundary	export overlap with agreement/function *a*
mawh	disjunction / alternative-question row	*mawh*	deferred	current controlled row is lexical/analyzer-noise material

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
Ahih hangin	adversative connector	*Ahih hangin*; *Ahih hangin kuamah in dawng lo hi*	supported with caveat	internally analyzable as *ahih* + *hang-in*
ahih kei leh	conditional-adversative connector	*ahih kei leh*; *tua ahih kei leh*	supported with caveat	not a simple coordinator; overlaps conditional and negation material

4.4.3 NP coordination with *le*

The clearest NP coordination anchor is *vantung le leitung* ‘heaven and earth’, where *le* links two noun phrases without clause-linkage ambiguity.

Genesis 1:1 supplies the OT anchor.

(4.223) *vàn-tùng lè léi-tùng*
sky-on and land-on
‘heaven and earth’ (Genesis 1:1)

Matthew 24:35 gives a Gospel comparandum with the same NP-coordination profile.

(4.224) *Vàn lè léi*
sky and buy
‘heaven and earth’ (Matthew 24:35)

4.4.4 Conditional and boundary *leh*

Leh ‘if / when’ is kept as boundary material here rather than as a generalized simple clause coordinator.

Genesis 13:9 keeps a controlled conditional window visible.

(4.225) *véi-lam nà lāk lèh kèi taklam-àh kà pái dìng hì*
faint-direction 2SG among and NEG right-LOC 1SG go IRR DECL
‘if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right’ (Genesis 13:9)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

The same row keeps an export caution visible: *kei* is glossed as *NEG* in this selected span even though the wider context is first-person future movement.

4.4.5 Sequential *a* and agreement false friends

Sequential *a* ‘sequential linker with 3SG/FUNC overlap’ remains caveated boundary evidence only.

Genesis 2:10 keeps one sequential window visible.

(4.226) *luang à túa mùn pàn-ìn gun hòng kikhen-ìn*
flow 3SG DIST place ABL-ERG river 3→1 separate-CVB
‘and from thence it was parted’ (Genesis 2:10)

No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

The false-friend control *a piangsak* '3SG/FUNC + create' shows why raw *a* harvesting is unsafe in coordinator analysis.

4.4.6 Deferred *mawh* material

mawh 'disjunction material (currently deferred)' remains deferred in this section because the controlled row still exports lexical material (*sin / V*) rather than a clean disjunction or alternative-question construction.

Report-only schematic strings such as *mi mawh ganhing mawh* and *pai ding mawh om ding mawh* are not promoted as grammar evidence here.

4.4.7 Adversative *Ahih hangin*

Ahih hangin 'but / however' is the current adversative connector anchor, while still carrying an internal-analysis caution.

Genesis 3:4 supplies the OT anchor.

(4.227) *Àhìh* *hàng-ìn*
be.3SG.REL because-ERG
'but' (Genesis 3:4)

Mark 3:4 gives a Gospel comparandum with the same connector.

(4.228) *Àhìh* *hàng-ìn* *kuamah* *ìn* *dawng* *lò* *hì.*
be.3SG.REL because-ERG nobody ERG receive NEG DECL
'but no one answered.' (Mark 3:4)

4.4.8 Conditional-adversative *ahih kei leh*

ahih kei leh 'otherwise / if not' remains conditional-adversative boundary material and should not be flattened into simple coordination.

Exodus 12:3 gives the OT boundary anchor.

(4.229) *àhìh* *kèi* *lèh*
be.3SG.REL NEG and
'otherwise / if not' (Exodus 12:3)

Matthew 11:3 gives a Gospel comparandum in the same conditional-adversative frame.

(4.230) *túa* *àhìh* *kèi* *lèh*
DIST be.3SG.REL NEG and
'or else / if not' (Matthew 11:3)

4.4.9 Deferred material

Several issues remain outside the present account. This section does not reopen *ciangin* 'when', broader *hangin* 'because', temporal or causal subordination, or full converb chaining. Sentence-final particles and broader discourse-organization domains likewise remain outside this account.

4.5 Reduplication

The current reduplication evidence is strongest for full-reduplication intensification with *mahmah* 'very, truly' and support from *taktak* 'truly, certainly', while distributive *peuhpeuh* 'each~each / every, each', syntactic *ni ni* 'day day / day by day', and forms such as *leuleu* 'ITER~ITER / gradually' remain secondary, boundary, or deferred material.

4.5.1 Overview of reduplication in Tedim

This section gives a narrow grammar-facing account of reduplication in Tedim. The core evidence is strongest for intensifier-like full reduplication with *mahmah* 'very, truly' and support from *taktak* 'truly, certainly'. Secondary distributive material with *peuhpeuh* 'each~each / every, each' is kept visible but does not lead the analysis.

The section keeps the analysis deliberately small. It distinguishes core evidence from boundary and deferred material, and it does not treat reduplication as a complete derivational, TAM/aspect, VP-structure, expressive-morphology, or dictionary-entry system.

Reduplication inventory

Form or pattern	Rough function	Example context	Current grammar-facing status	Boundary issue
mahmah / *mah~mah*	full-reduplication intensifier	*pha mahmah hi*	core anchor	none at the current evidence level
taktak / *tak~tak*	full-reduplication intensifier support	*Esau taktak na hi hiam?*	support	context-sensitive lexical contribution remains
peuhpeuh / *peuh~peuh*	distributive or free-choice-like reduplication	*khat peuhpeuh*	secondary evidence	quantifier-adjacent behavior remains explicit
ni ni	syntactic X X repetition	temporal adverbial sequencing	boundary material	syntactic/adverbial interpretation dominates current evidence
leuleu	iterative or continuative-looking repetition	*pai leuleu-in*	boundary material	overlaps TAM/aspect and VP-structure domains
gengen, *kawikawi*, *theithei*	verbal, expressive, or adverbial-modal-looking rows	report-visible forms with mixed behavior	deferred	lexicalized-looking or report-only behavior remains unresolved
bangbang, *bekbek*, *zenzen*, *tuamtuam*	report-only reduplicative-looking rows	table-only rows	deferred	no clean controlled examples are currently promoted

Full reduplication as intensification *mahmah* is the main full-reduplication intensifier anchor.

Its controlled segmentation is *mah~mah*, with gloss/function *EMPH~EMPH / very, truly*.

The worked example *pha mahmah hi* remains central in this section, with gloss 'good very DECL'.

(4.231) *hòih sá màhmàh hì*
good flesh very DECL
'it was very good' (Genesis 1:31)

Matthew 2:3 gives a Gospel comparandum for the same intensifier pattern.

(4.232) *lamdang-sá* *màhmàh*
different-INTNS very
'very alarmed / greatly troubled' (Matthew 2:3)

Taktak is the closest support row for the same intensifying pattern.

Its controlled segmentation is *tak~tak*, with gloss/function *TRUE~TRUE / truly, certainly*.

(4.233) *Esau tak-tak nà hì hìam?*
ESAU great~REDUP 2SG DECL Q
'Are you really Esau?' (Genesis 27:24)

Matthew 27:54 gives a Gospel support row for the same *taktak* pattern.

(4.234) *Pasian' Tá-pà tak-tak màh àhì hì*
God.POSS child-male great~REDUP EMPH be.3SG DECL
'Truly this was the Son of God' (Matthew 27:54)

These rows support a narrow claim: full reduplication can mark intensification. They do not by themselves define the full reduplication system.

Secondary distributive reduplication *Peuhpeuh* remains secondary distributive evidence, with controlled segmentation *peuh~peuh* and gloss/function *EACH~EACH / every, each*.

(4.235) *Nà khàt peuhpeuh Topa à dìng-ìn hàk-sá lúa àhì hìam?*
2SG one every Lord 3SG IRR-ERG difficult-PAST exceed be.3SG Q
'Is anything too hard for the Lord?' (Genesis 18:14)

Matthew 10:11 supplies a Gospel comparandum for secondary distributive use.

(4.236) *khùa khàt peuhpeuh nà tun ùh cìang-ìn*
town one every 2SG arrive 2/3PL then-ERG
'whichever town you enter' (Matthew 10:11)

This construction remains secondary because it stays close to quantifier or free-choice behavior. It is relevant to reduplication but not promoted as the main anchor.

Boundary and deferred material *Ni ni* 'day day / day by day' remains syntactic or adverbial boundary material. No equally clean Gospel example is currently used for this construction.

Leuleu 'ITER~ITER / gradually' remains TAM/aspect or VP-boundary material; Acts 28:13 (*pai leuleu-in*) is retained as prose-only boundary evidence rather than as a core formal example.

Gengen 'speak~speak / saying repeatedly', *kawikawi* 'side~side / all around', *theithei* 'KNOW~KNOW / adverbial-modal boundary', *bangbang* 'kind~kind / various', *bekbek* 'only~only', *zenzen* 'completely', and *tuamtuam* 'various kinds' remain boundary-controlled or deferred. These rows are lexicalized-looking or report-only in the current evidence and are not promoted as core grammar evidence here.

Several issues remain outside the present account. This section does not present a full reduplication, derivation, TAM/aspect, VP-structure, expressive-morphology, or dictionary-entry system.

4.6 Broader discourse

A fuller treatment of discourse structure is not yet included in this draft.

4.7 Analyzer-gap caution

Several cross-cutting morphological issues remain unresolved and are not yet integrated into this draft.

References

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